MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS MAGAZINE

JULY 2026



- Detailed release for all exams
- Static GK points included
- Category-wise Compilation
- Live Table of Content

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Important Days

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Date	Day	Theme
July	Sarcoma Awareness Month	
1 July	National Doctor's Day	Behind the Mask: Who Heals the Healers?
1 July	National Chartered Accountants Day	
1 July	GST Day (Goods & Services Tax)	
1 July	National Postal Worker Day	
2 July	World UFO Day	
2 July	World Sports Journalists Day	
3 July	International Plastic Bag Free Day	
4 July	International Day of Cooperatives	Cooperatives for a peaceful world
5 July	World Badminton Day	Raise A Racket
6 July	World Zoonoses Day	One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses
6 July	World Rural Development Day	Financing the First Mile
7 July	Global Forgiveness Day	
7 July	World Kiswahili Language Day	
7 July	World Bioproduct Day	
10 July	Global Energy Independence Day	
10 July	National Fish Farmers day	
11 July	World Population Day	Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people – today and for the future
11 July	World Horse Day	
12 July	Paper Bag Day	
12 July	Malala Day	
12 July	International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms	
12 July	International Day of Hope	A Universal Need in Uncertain Times

14 July	Bastille Day or French National Day	
15 July	World Youth Skills Day	Skills for a Shared Future
16th July	Artificial Intelligence (AI) Appreciation Day	
16 July	World Snake Day	
17 July	World Day for International Justice	
18 July	Nelson Mandela International Day	
18 July	World Listening Day	
20 July	International Chess Day	Celebrate, create, and make a difference
20 July	International Moon Day	
22 July	National Flag Day	
22 July	National Mango Day	
22 July	Pi Approximation Day	
22 July	World Brain Health Day	Brain Health: Access for All
23 July	**National Broadcasting Day**	
24 July	Income Tax Day	
25 July	World Embryologists Day	
25 July	International Day for Judicial Well-being	Justice begins with well-being
Date	Day	Theme
25 July	World Drowning Prevention Day	Unite To Turn The Tide
26 July	Kargil Vijay Diwas	
26 July	International Day for the Conservation of the Mangrove Ecosystem	Healthy Mangroves for Sustainable Blue Economy and Climate Resilience
28 July	World Nature Conservation Day	
28 July	World Hepatitis Day	Hepatitis: Let's break it down
29 July	International Tiger Day	
30 July	World Day against Trafficking in Persons	Trapped Behind the Scam
30 July	International Day of Friendship	

31 July	World Ranger Day	Rangers: Guardians of a Changing Planet
31 July	National Mutt Day	
31 July	National Avocado Day	

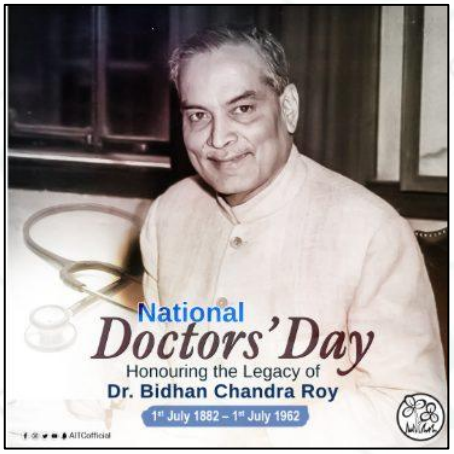
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July - Sarcoma Awareness Month



- **Sarcoma is a family of cancers that originate in the bones and soft tissues such as fat, muscles, blood vessels, nerves, and deep skin tissues.**
- A sarcoma typically appears as a painless lump or swelling that may increase in size over time.
- Sarcomas are primarily divided into two main categories: soft tissue sarcomas and bone sarcomas.

1 July – National Doctor's Day

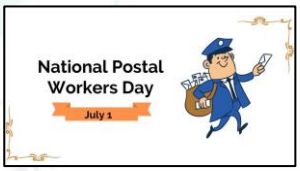


- Celebrated in India since 1991
- Honouring the legendary and renowned doctor Bidhan Chandra Roy (01 July 1882 - 01 July 1962) - was a well-known doctor, educator, freedom fighter, social worker, and politician.
- **Theme: Behind the Mask: Who Heals the Healers?**
- He was also the chief minister of West Bengal for 14 years, from 1948 to 1962.
- In February 1961, he received the highest Indian civilian award, "BHARAT RATNA".
- He was also the personal physician of Mahatma Gandhi.
- In the year 1976, the B.C. Roy National Award was established in his memory to recognize the eminent person working in the areas of medicine, science, public affairs, philosophy, arts, and literature.

1 July – National Chartered Accountants Day

- **Also known as CA Day, is an annual celebration held in July to honour the founding of the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) in 1949 through a parliamentary act.**

1 July – National Postal Worker Day



- While National Postal Day in India is observed on October 10th, National Postal Worker Day is a separate celebration focused specifically on the individuals working in the postal service

1 July GST Day (Goods & Services Tax)



- The launch of Goods & Services Tax (GST) on 01st July 2017, marked a historic achievement in India's reform journey.
- The principle of "One Nation, One Tax" has now become a reality, helping India move towards an integrated tax system.
- Over the past nine years, GST has strengthened India's vision of 'Ek Bharat - Shreshtha Bharat'.
- **Goods and Services Tax (GST) is a comprehensive indirect tax levied on the supply of goods and services across India.**
- **GST was introduced through the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016 and**

implemented from 1 July 2017.

GST Reform – GST 2.0

- The 56th GST Council meeting approved major structural reforms referred to as GST 2.0, focusing on rate rationalisation and simplification.

New Rate Structure

- Two primary slabs: 5% and 18%
- Removal of earlier 12% and 28% slabs
- 40% special de-merit rate for sin goods and select luxury items

2 July - World UFO Day



- Unidentified Flying Objects (UFOs)
- July 2 marks the anniversary of the 1947 Roswell incident.
- It took place in New Mexico, USA when a mysterious object crashed close to Roswell in July 1947.

2 July - World Sports Journalists Day

- World Sports Journalists Day was first celebrated in 1994, marking the 70th anniversary of the International Sports Press Association (AIPS), founded in 1924 during the Summer Olympics in Paris.

3 July International Plastic Bag Free Day



- Aim: To reduce the use of single-use plastic bags that inspired other parts of the world to participate in Plastic Bag Free Day

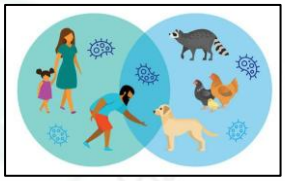
4 July International Day of Cooperatives

- The International Day of Cooperatives is celebrated annually on the first Saturday of July
- The 2026 theme : "Cooperatives for a peaceful world"

5 July World Badminton Day

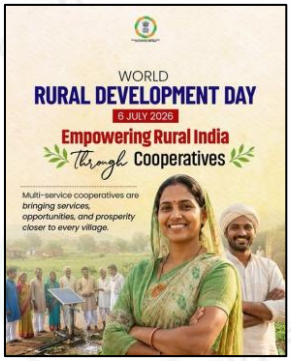
- International Badminton Federation (now Badminton World Federation – BWF), was established on 05 July 1934
- 1st ever World Badminton Day in 2022
- **The theme : "Raise A Racket".**

6 July - World Zoonoses Day



- Zoonosis or Zoonotic diseases refer to the infections or infectious diseases that originate from animals.
- On July 6, 1885, French Biologist Louis Pasteur administered a rabies vaccine to a young boy who was bitten by a rabid dog.
- The theme : "One World, One Health: Prevent Zoonoses,"

6 July World Rural Development Day



- **THEME: Financing the First Mile**
- On September 6, 2024 The United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) has declared 6 July as the World Rural Development Day, which is also foundation day of Centre on Integrated Rural Development for Asia and the Pacific (CIRDAP).

7 July - Global Forgiveness Day

- to encourage forgiveness as part of an element of personal health.

7 July - World Kiswahili Language Day

- This day was established by UNESCO to recognize the importance of Kiswahili, one of the most widely spoken languages in Africa
- Kiswahili is the first African language to be honored with its own international day by the UN, highlighting its significance in Africa and globally.
- an official language of the African Union (AU).

7 July World Bioproduct Day



- observed every year on July 7
- The first World Bioproduct Day was observed on 7 July 2021 by the World BioEconomy Forum,
- aiming to raise awareness about the importance of bio-based products in promoting environmental sustainability and advancing the global bioeconomy.
- **Bioproducts refer to products derived from renewable biological resources, such as plants and algae, to produce industrial goods, food, and energy; example - Ethanol (from sugarcane), Biodiesel (from vegetable oils)**

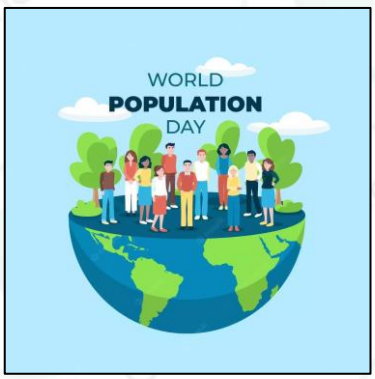
10 July - Global Energy Independence Day

- Marks a pivotal moment for countries striving to achieve energy self-sufficiency and sustainability.
- The day also celebrates Nikola Tesla, a famous inventor born on 10 July, 1856. - explored new ways to use electricity more efficiently.

10 July National Fish Farmers day

- July 10th is commemorated across India as National Fish Farmers Day in honour of the pioneering work of Professor Dr. Hiralal Chaudhury and Dr. Alikunhi, who achieved the first successful induced breeding of major carps on this day in 1957 at Angul, Odisha

11 July World Population Day



- **The theme: "Realizing the hopes and aspirations of young people – today and for the future."**
- World Population Day was established by the then-Governing Council of the United Nations Development Programme in 1989
- By resolution of December 1990, the United Nations General Assembly decided to continue observing World Population Day
- **The Day was first marked on 11 July 1990 in more than 90 countries**

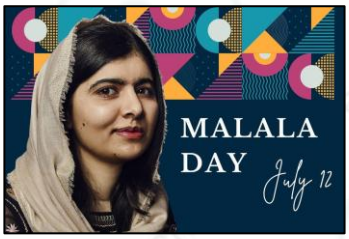
11 July World Horse Day

- Adopted by UNGA United Nations on 3 June 2025

12 July - Paper Bag Day

- to help raise awareness of the environmental benefits of using paper bags over plastic bags.
- This day also celebrates the invention of the first paper bag machine in 1852 by Francis Wolle
- In 1870, Margaret Eloise Knight also known as the "mother of the grocery bag" designed the square, flat bottom of paper bags .

12 July- Malala Day



- in honor of Nobel Peace Prize recipient Malala Yousafzai.
- Malala Yousafzai was born in Mingora, Pakistan, on July 12, 1997

- **In 2007 the Taliban took over the city where Malala lived and banned girls from attending school.**
- **In 2009, Malala started a blog and wrote about life under Taliban rule.**
- **Taliban shot Malala Yousafzai in the head**
- **In 2013, TIME Magazine declared Malala one of the most influential people in the world.**

12 July- International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms



- In 2023, the United Nations General Assembly proclaimed 12 July as the International Day of Combating Sand and Dust Storms
- declared the period from 2025 to 2034 the United Nations Decade on Combating Sand and Dust Storms.

12 July- International Day of Hope

- **First celebration**
- **United Nations General Assembly has designated 12 July as the International Day of Hope—a day to celebrate and promote hope as a guiding principle for individuals, communities, and nations alike.**
- THEME: A Universal Need in Uncertain Times

14 July - Bastille Day or French National Day



- **Bastille Day is the national day of France. It marks the storming of the Bastille prison on July 14, 1789, a key event in the French Revolution.**
- People were angry at King Louis XVI's rule, high taxes, food shortages, and inequality.
- The fall of the Bastille became a symbol of the people's power and the beginning of the end for the French monarchy.

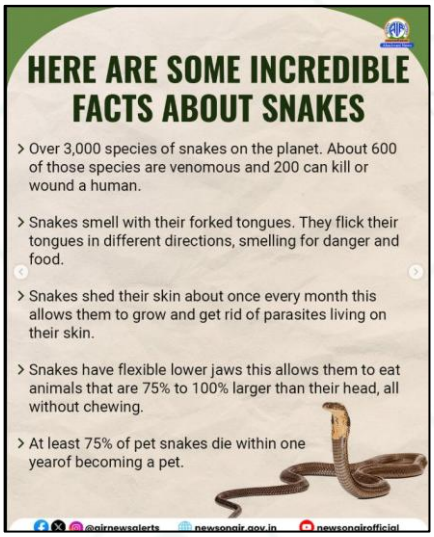
15 July World Youth Skills Day

- **2026 Theme: Skills for a Shared Future**
- **In 2014, the United Nations General Assembly declared 15 July as World Youth Skills Day, to celebrate the strategic importance of equipping young people with skills for employment, decent work and entrepreneurship.**

16 July Artificial Intelligence (AI) Appreciation Day

- The day celebrates the country's growing role in the global AI landscape.
- **India's AI journey began in the 1960s with early computer science research.**
- A major step came in 1986 with the Knowledge-Based Computer Systems project.
- In the 1990s, organisations like C-DAC advanced supercomputing and early AI work.

16 July World Snake Day



- The origins of World Snake Day trace back to 2009

17 July World Day for International Justice

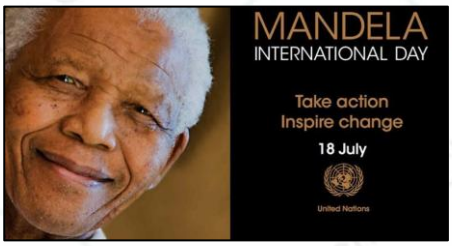
- It marks the anniversary of the adoption of the Rome Statute on 17 July 1998, the founding treaty of the ICC, which seeks to protect people from genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and the crime of aggression.

About International Criminal Court (ICC)

- It is the first international permanent court to investigate and prosecute individuals accused of serious international crimes.
- ICC's founding treaty, called the Rome Statute (adopted in 1998 entered into force in 2002)
- **Membership: 124 countries are States Parties to Rome Statute of ICC.**

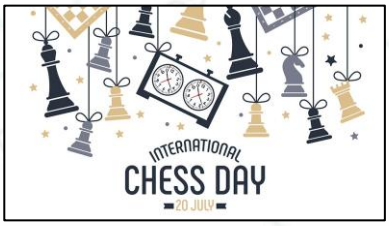
- **India, Israel, the US, Russia and China are not parties to the Rome Statute.**
- Palestine became the 123rd member (2015) and Malaysia became 124th State party (2019).
- **Enforcement: ICC's decisions are binding.**

18 July Nelson Mandela International Day



- commemorates the birth of Nelson Mandela, South Africa's first Black President and a global icon of peace, justice, and reconciliation.
- **Recognized by the United Nations in 2009,**
- **Nelson Mandela Decade of Peace - (2019 – 2028)**
- **In December 2015, the UN General Assembly unanimously adopted the United Nations Standard Minimum Rules for the Treatment of Prisoners.**
- It also approved that the rules should be known as the "Nelson Mandela Rules"

20 July International Chess Day



- **To mark the date of the establishment of the International Chess Federation (FIDE) in Paris in 1924.**
- Observed by chess players around the world since 1966.
- **On 12 December 2019, the UN General Assembly proclaimed 20 July as World Chess Day**
- Theme : "Celebrate, create, and make a difference."

20 July International Moon Day



- Marks the anniversary of the first landing by humans on the Moon as part of the Apollo 11 lunar mission in 1969.
- UN General Assembly declared International Moon Day in 2021.
- The United Nations Office for Outer Space Affairs (UNOOSA) is the United Nations office responsible for promoting international cooperation in the peaceful uses of outer space.

22 July National Flag Day



- On 22nd July 1947, the **Constituent Assembly of India, chaired by Dr. Rajendra Prasad**, **adopted the National Flag.**
- The design of the **Indian tricolour** is largely attributed to **Pingali Venkayya,** an Indian freedom fighter.
- He **passed away in 1963** and was posthumously **honoured with a postage stamp in 2009** for his contribution towards Indian freedom struggle. In **2014,** his name was also proposed for the **Bharat Ratna.**
- The **hoisting/use/display** of the Indian National Flag is governed by the **Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971** and the **Flag Code of India, 2002.**
- The Flag Code of India, 2002 was amended in 2021 **allowing polyester or machine made Flag and again in** 2022 **allowing flag to be flown day and night**.
- **The National Flag shall be rectangular in shape.** The Flag can be of any size but the **ratio of the length to the height (width)** of the Flag shall be **3:2.**

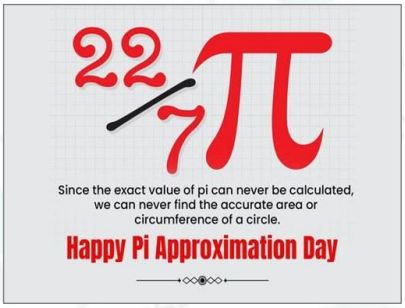
22 July National Mango Day



- Every year, on July 22, India celebrates National Mango Day
- India is the home of about 1,000 varieties.

- The **English word "mango**" originated in the 16th century from the Portuguese word "manga," which in turn was derived from the **Tamil word "mangai" or "mankai"**
- The **major mango-growing states** are Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Bihar, Telangana and West Bengal.

22 July Pi Approximation Day



- The ratio of a circle's circumference to its diameter is called Pi.
- The **value of Pi is approximately 3.14**. The value of Pi has been calculated to trillions of digits.
- When placed in the **date/month format**, July 22 looks like **22/7** - this is **an approximate value of Pi.**
- **Physicist Albert Einstein** was also **born on July 22**. Theoretical Physicist **Stephen Hawking passed away on July 22.**
- Pi Day is also observed on March 14, as it looks like 3/14 when placed in the month/date format.
- The symbol of Pi was designed back in 1706 by mathematician Leonhard Euler.

22 July World Brain Health Day

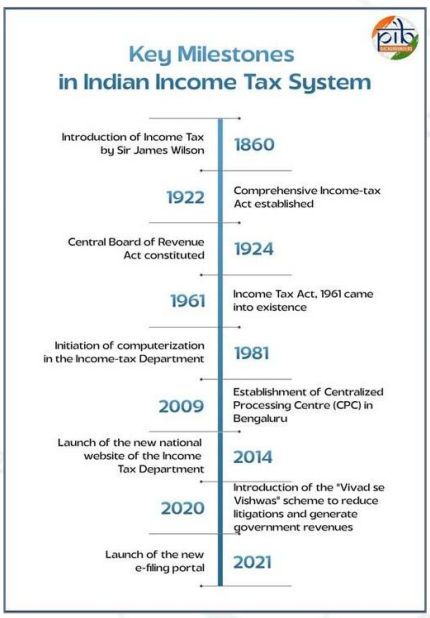
- Commemorating the awareness of brain diseases.
- **THEME : "Brain Health: Access for All"**

23 July National Broadcasting Day



- On this day **in 1927**, the **first ever radio broadcast in the country** went **on air from the Bombay Station under the Indian Broadcasting Company.**
- IBC failed financially and was **taken over by the British government in 1930** as the **Indian State Broadcasting Service (ISBS).**
- On the 8th of June, **1936**, the Indian State Broadcasting Service became **All India Radio (AIR).**
- In **1956**, the **name AKASHVANI was adopted** for the National Broadcaster.
- Motto of Akashvani – Bahujana Hitaya, Bahujana Sukhaya.

24 July Income Tax Day



- Income Tax Day (or **Aaykar Divas**), celebrated on **24th July,** marks a significant milestone in India's fiscal history.
- This day commemorates the **introduction of income tax in India by Sir James Wilson, a British economist in 1860** to meet the losses from the **1857 Military Mutiny.**
- The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has officially observed the occasion since 2010.

25 July World Embryologists Day

- **Also known as World IVF Day**
- **July 25th commemorates the birth of Louise Joy Brown in 1978 in England, who was the first baby successfully conceived through In Vitro Fertilization (IVF).**

25 July International Day for Judicial Well-being

- **Theme: Justice begins with well-being**

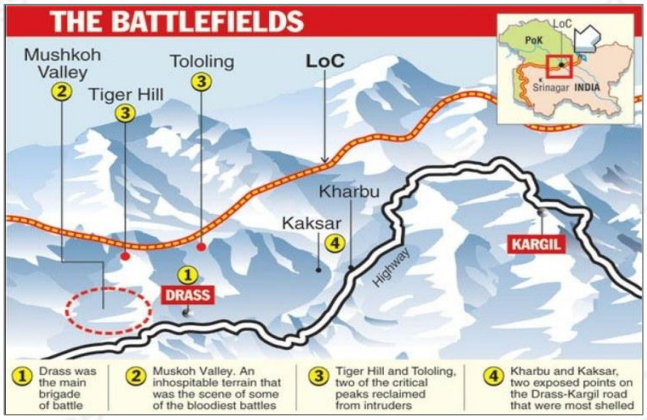
- On 25 July 2024, United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime **(UNODC) in partnership with the Nauru Judiciary**, adopted the **Nauru Declaration on Judicial Well-being** which recognizes that the **health and well-being of judges is critical** to ensuring judicial integrity, independence, and the quality of justice delivered to the public.
- **In March 2025 , the United Nations General Assembly adopted Resolution,** officially proclaiming **25 July** as the **International Day for Judicial Well-being.**

25 July World Drowning Prevention Day

- Declared in April 2021 by General Assembly
- THEME: **UNITE TO TURN THE TIDE**

26 July Kargil Vijay Diwas

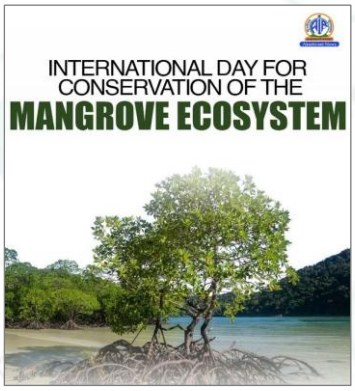
- To commemorate India's victory over Pakistan in the Kargil War.



About Kargil War:

- It was **fought between India and Pakistan between May and July 1999 in the Kargil** and along the Line of Control (LOC).
- During the winter of 1998-1999, **Pakistani forces secretly infiltrated the Drass and Batalik sectors of Kargil** in the Ladakh region.
- Their objective was to capture positions that would allow them to **monitor and potentially control movements along the vital NH 1A highway.**
- India mobilized nearly 200,000 troops to counter the threat, leading to the onset of the Kargil War.
- **Operation Vijay:** The Indian Army fought bravely and **recaptured the famous 'Tiger Hill' and other important posts** around under 'Operation Vijay'
- **High Altitude Warfare:** It was fought at extreme altitudes, with some of the battlegrounds reaching heights of over 18,000 feet.
- **Duration:** It lasted for approximately three months.
- **The End of Conflict:** The war came to an end on July 26, 1999
- **Live on TV:** It was the first ever war to be broadcasted live on TV channels in India.

26 July International Day for the Conservation of the Mangrove Ecosystem



- **Established by UNESCO in 2015**, this Day raises awareness of mangroves' importance and promotes their sustainable conservation.
- Mangroves are natural marvels that **exist at the intersection of land and sea.**
- They protect coastlines from erosion, support rich biodiversity, act as carbon sinks and as natural coastal barriers against storm surges, making them key allies in our fight against climate change.
- **The theme : Healthy Mangroves for Sustainable Blue Economy and Climate Resilience**

28 July - World Nature Conservation Day



- To raise awareness of conserving nature and ensuring the well-being of the present and future generations.
- **Established in 1998**
- In India, the observance is promoted by the Environmental Information System (ENVIS) under the Ministry of Environment and Forests.

28 July - World Hepatitis Day

- **THEME: "Hepatitis: Let's break it down"**
- To raise awareness of viral hepatitis, an **inflammation of the liver** that causes severe liver disease and liver cancer.
- **Chronic hepatitis B and C silently cause liver damage and cancer** – despite them being preventable, treatable, and, in the case of hepatitis C, curable

29th July International Tiger Day

- The world celebrates Global Tiger Day on July 29th.
- Global Tiger Day was officially **declared at the Saint Petersburg Tiger Summit in 2010.**
- The 13 countries where wild tigers still roam, came together to **commit to Tx2 – the global goal to double the number of wild tigers** by the next Chinese Year of the Tiger in 2022.

Global Conservation Milestones

- **Project Tiger in India** launched in 1973, helped boost tiger numbers from approximately 1,700 in 2010 to more than 3,600 in 2022.
- **Nepal's anti-poaching efforts** and legal enforcement resulted in "zero poaching" seasons and stable tiger numbers.
- **WWF's corridor initiatives**, such as #TigersNeedCorridors, advocate landscape connectivity across India, China and Southeast Asia.

30 July World Day against Trafficking in Persons

- THEME: Trapped Behind the Scam.
- The World Day against Trafficking in Persons was proclaimed by the United Nations General Assembly, In 2013

30 July International Day of Friendship

- The International Day of Friendship was proclaimed in 2011 by the UN General Assembly
- The International Day of Friendship is an initiative that follows on the proposal made by UNESCO defining the Culture of Peace as a set of values, attitudes and behaviours

31 July World Ranger Day



- **World Ranger Day**, observed on **July 31st each year,** is dedicated to recognising the dedication of **rangers who protect natural and cultural treasures.**
- **Theme - "Rangers: Guardians of a Changing Planet"**
- The first World Ranger Day **was observed in 2007**
- The first World Ranger Day was observed in 2007 on the 15th anniversary of the founding of the International Ranger Federation (IRF). It was formed on 31st July 1992
- **Rangers in India,** also known as **Van Rakshaks or Green Soldiers**

31 July National Mutt Day

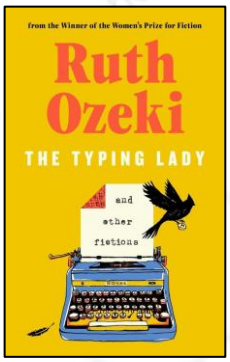
- National Mutt Day encourages us to embrace, save and celebrate mixed breed dogs twice a year on July 31 and December 2.

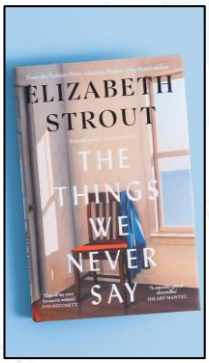
Books

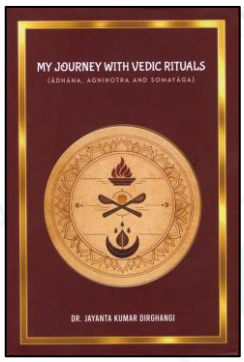
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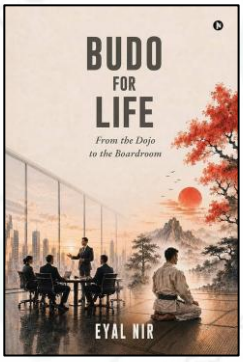
Book	Author
Women-O-Pause - A mid-life guide for women and their men	By Lenaa Kumar Published by Penguin Random House
The Typing Lady	By Ruth Ozeki
The Things We Never Say	By Elizabeth Strout
My Journey with Vedic Rituals (Ādhāna, Agnihotra and Somayāga),	By Dr. Jayanta Kumar Dirghangi Published by Purushottam Publishers
BuDo for Life	By - Sensei Eyal Nir
The Voice of Justice: Justice Gavai Speaks	Edited by Prof. (Dr.) S. Sivakumar Published by Thomson Reuters
Fieldwork As a Sex Object	Published by HarperCollins
Limitless Traditions	Author: Shefali Vaidya
The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units	Published by The Hindu Group Editors: Suresh Nambath, Varghese K. George, Rajkamal Das
Socrates: The Barefoot Philosopher	Author: Vijay Tankha

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Women-O-Pause - A mid-life guide for women and their men

- writer Lenaa Kumar
- book Women-O-Pause - A mid-life guide for women and their men
- published by Penguin Random House

'The Typing Lady: And Other Fictions' by Ruth Ozeki

- The Typing Lady: And Other Fictions is a 2026 short story collection by Ruth Ozeki.
- It marks her first collection of short fiction

Elizabeth Strout's 'The Things We Never Say'

- Elizabeth Strout's new novel, The Things We Never Say
- follows 57-year-old Massachusetts high school history teacher Artie Dam.

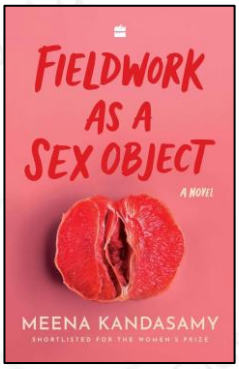
My Journey with Vedic Rituals by Dr. J.K. Dirghangi Released

- Book, My Journey with Vedic Rituals (Ādhāna, Agnihotra and Somayāga),
- Author: Dr. Jayanta Kumar Dirghangi
- published by Purushottam Publishers, Kolkata

Kolkata hosted the first India launch of "BuDo for Life" by Eyal Nir

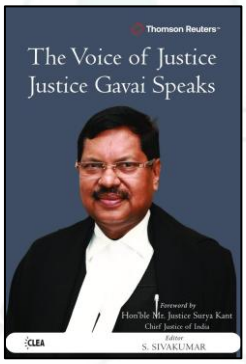
- Sensei Eyal Nir, a martial arts practitioner, leadership mentor, and 7th Dan Traditional Karate Black Belt,
- launched his book "BuDo for Life"
- The book's thematic statement is rooted in the philosophy of BuDo (The Martial Way), an ancient Japanese tradition.

Meena Kandasamy new novel, 'Fieldwork As a Sex Object'



- Meena Kandasamy has authored a new novel titled Fieldwork As a Sex Object.
- The book is published by HarperCollins.

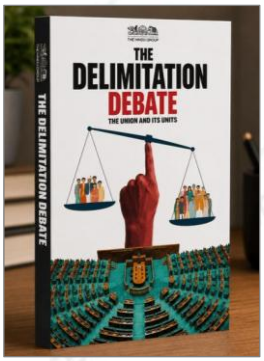
Vice-President releases book "The Voice of Justice: Justice Gavai Speaks"



- The Vice-President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan released the book "The Voice of Justice: Justice Gavai Speaks" at Uprashtrapati Bhavan.
- Edited by Prof. (Dr.) S. Sivakumar
- published by Thomson Reuters in association with the Commonwealth Legal Education Association (C.L.E.A.)

Author Keith Butler launched - The History of Anglo-Indians





- Author and educator Keith Butler launched The History of Anglo-Indians: A Graphic Novel at Kolkata
- illustrated by Harry MacLure.
- Published by Chennai's Anglo Ink publications
- The book is the first graphic novel dedicated exclusively to exploring and preserving the 500-year heritage of the Anglo-Indian community.

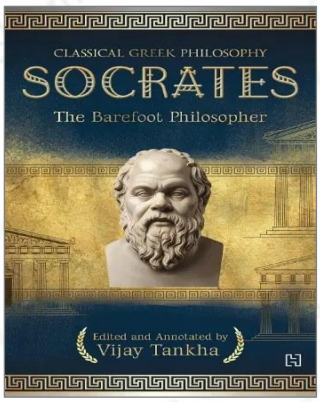
Gaurang Shah's 'Limitless Traditions' chronicles India's handloom heritage

- In Limitless Traditions, a coffee table book launched recently, By Hyderabad-based textile designer Gaurang Shah .
- **author: Shefali Vaidya**
- The work showcases Hyderabad-based designer Gaurang Shah vast range of regional weaves—such as Jamdani, Paithani, Kanjeevaram, Banarasi, and Khadi—each rooted in unique cultural traditions.

The book, The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units

- The book, The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units, published by The Hindu Group
- Editors: Suresh Nambath, Varghese K. George, Rajkamal Das
- The book is a collection of 17 essays — preceded by an introduction — on delimitation, federalism, representation, and Census, and highlights how the lack of access to key data makes delimitation studies difficult in India.

The barefoot 'gadfly': Vijay Tankha's new book brings the baffling, maddening Socrates back to life



- a recent book on Socrates by Vijay Tankha, titled Socrates: The Barefoot Philosopher.
- Socrates is often called a "gadfly" because he constantly questioned and challenged Athenian society—like an insect that keeps provoking a horse into action.
- "Barefoot" reflects his simple, ascetic lifestyle, symbolizing his rejection of materialism and focus on ethical inquiry.

Appointments

Person	Appointment
Alok Kumar Mittal	Director General of Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPR&D)
Amit Garg	Director of the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)
Sujeet Pandey	Director of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA)
Lieutenant General Mohit Malhotra	General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the South Western Command
Lieutenant General Rajesh Pushkar	General Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Southern Command
Air Marshal Tejinder Singh	Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC)
IPS Anurag Kumar	Delhi Police Commissioner
Ravi Agrawal	Chairman of Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)
Harjit Singh Grewal	Chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities (NCM)
Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala	Secretary of the Ministry of Earth Sciences
Vikram Misri	Foreign Secretary
Sanjeev Jain	India's new ambassador to North Korea
Somnath Ghosh	High Commissioner of India to Malaysia
Shri Vivek Nishant Nath	Director (Commercial) of NMDC Limited
Anupam Misra	Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL)
S. Somanath	Observer on the board of Agnikul Cosmos
Vineet Joshi	Secretary, Ministry of Panchayati Raj
Naresh Pal Gangwar	Secretary, Department of Higher Education
T. K. Anil Kumar	Secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy
Katikithala Srinivas	Secretary, Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region
Keshav Chandra	Secretary, Ministry of Mines
Chandra Bhushan Kumar	Secretary, Ministry of Labour and Employment
Sushil Kumar Lohani	Secretary, Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying
Satendra Singh	Secretary, Department of Urban Development

D. Thara	Secretary, Department of Capital Development
Piyush Goyal	Secretary General, National Human Rights Commission
Person	New Appointment / Position
Anurag Jain	Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog
Pralhad Joshi	Union Minister for Education
Captain Shivani Sehrawat	First-ever woman Aide-de-Camp (ADC) to the Chief of the Army Staff
Shri Ngulkham Jathom Gangte	Ambassador of India to Mexico.
Shatmanyu Shrivastava	Executive Director (Finance & Accounts) and Chief Financial Officer of Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)

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Appointments (National)

Centre Appoints New Chiefs of BPR&D, NCRB and SVPNPA



- The Central government appointed new heads for the Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPR&D), the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), and the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA).
- Alok Kumar Mittal, a 1993-batch Indian Police Service officer of the Haryana cadre, has been appointed Director General of BPR&D.
- Amit Garg, a 1993-batch Indian Police Service officer of the Andhra Pradesh cadre, has been appointed Director of the NCRB.
- Sujeet Pandey, a 1994-batch Indian Police Service officer of the Uttar Pradesh cadre, has been named Director of SVPNPA in Hyderabad.





Lieutenant General Mohit Malhotra, Assumes Command Of Jaipur Based South Western Command

- Lieutenant General Mohit Malhotra, AVSM, SM has assumed the appointment of General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the South Western Command.
- Commissioned into the 47 Armoured Regiment in June 1989
- Lieutenant General Mohit Malhotra has been awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal and the Sena Medal

Lt Gen Rajesh Pushkar Avsm, Vsm Assumes Command Of Southern Command



- Lieutenant General Rajesh Pushkar AVSM, VSM assumed command as the General Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Southern Command on 01 July 2026.
- He succeeds Lieutenant General Sandeep Jain, AVSM, SM who has taken over as the Vice Chief of the Army Staff.
- An alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Lieutenant General Rajesh Pushkar was commissioned into 74 Armoured Regiment in December 1988.

Air Marshal Tejinder Singh takes over as CISC

- Air Marshal Tejinder Singh took over as the Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to Chairman Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) on July 01, 2026.
- Prior to his present appointment, the Air Marshal was the Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C), South Western Air Command.
- In recognition of his meritorious service, Air Marshal Tejinder Singh was awarded the Vayu Sena Medal in 2007, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2022 and Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026.

IPS Anurag Kumar appointed as the Delhi Police Commissioner



- IPS Anurag Kumar has been appointed as the new Delhi Police Commissioner, replacing Satish Golcha
- 2010: Mr. Kumar was conferred the Police Medal for Meritorious Service (PMMS) in recognition of his work under the AGMUT.
- **2016: Mr. Kumar was decorated with the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Service(PPMDS) for his contribution to domestic security operations.**

Ravi Agrawal Reappointed as CBDT Chairman



- The Union government extended the tenure of Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)Chairman Ravi Agrawal by six months, till December 2026.
- The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) is a statutory authority responsible for administering direct tax laws in India.
- It functions under the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance.

Harjit Singh Grewal – The New National Commission for Minorities Chief



- The Centre appointed Harjit Singh Grewal as the Chairperson of the National Commission for Minorities (NCM) , after the tenure of Iqbal Singh Lalpura ended.
- He is the second Sikh leader to head the statutory body in succession.
- **It is a statutory body under the Ministry of Minority Affairs.**
- In January 1978, the government set up the Minorities Commission to safeguard the interests of minorities.
- With the enactment of the National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992, the Minorities Commission became a statutory body and was renamed as the National Commission for Minorities.

T Srinivasa Kumar appointed Earth Sciences Secretary

- The Centre has appointed internationally renowned oceanographer Dr. Srinivasa Kumar Tummala as the Secretary of the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES).
- He has been appointed for a tenure of two years from the date of assuming charge, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- Dr. Tummala, is currently serving as Head of the Indian Ocean Tsunami Warning and Mitigation System (IOTWMS) Secretariat under UNESCO's Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) in Perth, Australia.

Government extends Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri's tenure by one year, till 14th July 2027

- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved a one-year extension in service for Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, who is a 1989 batch IFS officer, beyond 14th July this year.
- Mr Misri assumed charge as Foreign Secretary on 15th July 2024.
- He was India's Ambassador to China from January 2019 to December 2021.

▪ He has also served as Private Secretary to three Prime Ministers of India – I.K. Gujral, Dr. Manmohan Singh and Narendra Modi.

Sanjeev Jain appointed as India's next ambassador to North Korea

▪ The central government's Ministry of External Affairs has announced the appointment of Sanjeev Jain as India's new ambassador to North Korea.

▪ He will take over from previous ambassador Aliawati Longkumer.



Govt appoints Somnath Ghosh as next High Commissioner of India to Malaysia

▪ The Government has appointed Somnath Ghosh as the next High Commissioner of India to Malaysia.

▪ Mr. Ghosh, an Indian Foreign Service officer of the 1997 batch, is presently serving as Consul General of India in Chicago

Shri Vivek Nishant Nath takes charge as Director (Commercial), NMDC



▪ Shri Vivek Nishant Nath assumed charge as Director (Commercial) of NMDC Limited, India's largest iron ore producer.

▪ NMDC Limited (formerly National Mineral Development Corporation) is a Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE)

▪ Shri Nath began his professional career with NMDC in 1992

▪ He subsequently held key positions in Essar Steel Limited and ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel India before joining Odisha Mining Corporation Limited (OMC) as General Manager (Sales & Marketing) in 2021.

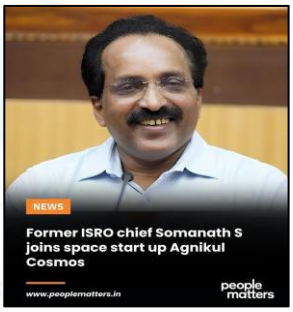
Shri Anupam Misra takes over as Chairman & Managing Director of Hindustan Copper Limited



▪ Shri Anupam Misra assumed charge as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL).

▪ Prior to joining HCL, Shri Misra served as Director (Marketing) at Fertilisers and Chemicals Travancore Limited (FACT) from July 2020 to June 2026 and also held the additional charge of Chairman & Managing Director of FACT.

S. Somanath Joins Agnikul Cosmos Board



▪ S. Somanath, former Chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation, has joined Chennai-based Agnikul Cosmos as an observer on its board of directors.

▪ He served as ISRO Chairman from January 2022 to January 2025 and worked in India's space programme for nearly 40 years.

▪ Agnikul Cosmos is an Indian space technology company based in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.

▪ Its launch vehicle is called Agnibaan, and the company has developed a two-stage configuration for orbital launch missions.

Centre appoints Secretaries in various Ministries and Departments

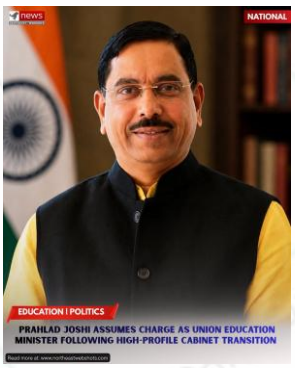


- The Centre has appointed Secretaries in various Ministries and Departments.
- Vineet Joshi, presently Secretary, Department of Higher Education in the Ministry of Education, has been appointed as Secretary, Ministry of Panchayati Raj.
- Naresh Pal Gangwar will be the new Secretary, Department of Higher Education,
- T K Anil Kumar has been appointed Secretary, Department of School Education and Literacy.

Anurag Jain Appointed CEO of NITI Aayog

- On 22 July 2026, the Centre appointed Anurag Jain as the **Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog for a period of two years.**
- a 1989-batch Indian Administrative Service officer of the Madhya Pradesh cadre,
- Earlier this year, economist Ashok Kumar Lahiri was appointed Vice Chairperson of NITI Aayog, succeeding Suman K. Bery.
- The government also appointed Rajiv Gauba, Professor K. V. Raju, Professor Gobardhan Das, Dr. M. Srinivas and Professor Abhay Karandikar as **full-time members of the policy think tank.**
- NITI Aayog stands for **the National Institution for Transforming India** and functions as the Government of India's policy think tank.
- It was established on 1 January 2015, replacing the Planning Commission, which was created in 1950.
- The Prime Minister of India serves as the Chairperson of NITI Aayog.

Prahlad Joshi takes charge as Education Minister



- Union Minister for Education Pralhad Joshi officially took charge of the Ministry of Education at Kartavya Bhavan
- The Minister also holds charge of the Union Ministries of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, and New and Renewable Energy.
- Mr. Joshi was appointed as Education Minister after Dharmendra Pradhan resigned from the post
- Mr. Pradhan resigned from his post following the Cockroach Janta Party-led student protests across the country, demanding his ouster over the NEET paper leak cases.
- The President, as advised by the Prime Minister, has accepted the resignation of Shri Dharmendra Pradhan from the Union Council of Ministers, with immediate effect, under clause (2) of Article 75 of the Constitution of India.

Captain Shivani Becomes First Woman ADC to Army Chief Gen Dhiraj Seth



- Captain Shivani Sehrawat made history by becoming the first-ever woman Aide-de-Camp (ADC) to the Chief of the Army Staff, serving under General Dhiraj Seth

Ngulkham Jathom Gangte Appointed India's Next Ambassador to Mexico

- Shri Ngulkham Jathom Gangte (IFS: 1994), presently Special Secretary in the Ministry, has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to Mexico.
- Gangte served as India's Ambassador to Tunisia from 2021 and held concurrent accreditation to Libya.

LIC appoints Shatmanyu Shrivastava as CFO

- State-owned Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) announced the appointment of Shatmanyu Shrivastava as Executive Director (Finance & Accounts) and Chief Financial Officer.
- Previously, he was Executive Director (Enterprise Risk Management) and Chief Risk Officer.

Appointments (International)

Person	Appointment
Chirag Veer Singh Sarao	First 'keshdhari' Sikh American to join the U.S. Air Force Academy
Sergii Koretskyi	Prime Minister of Ukrainian
Keiko Fujimori	President of Peru

Andrew Burnham	Prime Minister of the U.K.
Kanishka Narayan	United Kingdom's first Minister for Artificial Intelligence
Oleksandr Syrskyi	Army Commander-in-Chief of Ukraine
Uday Ruddaraju	Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Compute at OpenAI
Andrew Burnham	Prime Minister of the U.K.
Kanishka Narayan	United Kingdom's first Minister for Artificial Intelligence
Oleksandr Syrskyi	Army Commander-in-Chief of Ukraine
Uday Ruddaraju	Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Compute at OpenAI

Chirag Veer Singh Sarao becomes first Sikh American to join U.S. Air Force Academy

- Chirag Veer Singh Sarao has become the first 'keshdhari' Sikh American to join the U.S. Air Force Academy
- A 'keshdhari' Sikh maintains unshorn hair (kesh) and beard as articles of faith.

Conservative leader Keiko Fujimori wins Peru's presidential election

- Right-wing candidate Keiko Fujimori has been declared the winner of Peru's tight presidential election
- Capital: Lima
- Currency: Peruvian sol



Andy Burnham becomes U.K. PM

- Former Manchester Mayor, Andrew Burnham, was appointed Prime Minister of the U.K.
- Outgoing Prime Minister - Keir Starmer

Short News

- Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskiy has nominated Naftogaz chief Sergii Koretskyi as the country's new Prime Minister following the resignation of Yulia Svyrydenko.British Prime Minister Andy Burnham has appointed Indian-origin Labour politician Kanishka Narayan as the United Kingdom's first Minister for Artificial Intelligence,
- Born in Muzaffarpur, in India's northern state of Bihar
- Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has removed Army Commander-in-Chief Oleksandr Syrskyi from his post, appointing **Mykhailo Drapatyi** as the new head of the armed forces.
- Indian-origin technology executive Uday Ruddaraju has been appointed Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Compute at OpenAI.

Awards

Awards - National

72nd National Film Awards: Article 370 bags best feature film, Mammootty gets best actor award

- The winners of the 72nd National Film Awards were announced in New Delhi



Feature Films category

- Best Feature Film: Article 370
- Best Actor in Leading Role: Yami Gautam (Article 370), Kartik Aaryan (Chandu Champion), Mammootty (Bramayugam)
- Best Debut Film: Swatantrya Veer Savarkar
- Best Direction: Rajkumar Periasamy (Amaran)
- Best Children's Film: 35 – Chinna Katha Kaadu
- Best Film Promoting National, Social, Environmental Values: Captain Miller
- Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: Kalki 2898 AD
- Best Dialogues: Venky Atluri (Lucky Baskhar)
- Best Screenplay: Yogesh Deshpande (Swargandharva Sudhir Phadke), Bandireddi Sukumar (Pushpa 2)
- Best Cinematography: Shehnad Jalal (Bramayugam)

Non Feature Films

Special Jury Mention:



- a) Chola Dora aur Sui (Hindi); Director: Jaymin Modi & Lokesh Ghai
- b) Badra-Kali Natakam (Malayalam); Director: Ananda Jyothi (Jose Antony)
- Best Script: Obur (Clouds, Hindi & Urdu); Script writer: Faraz Ali
- Best Cinematography: Life in Loom (English, Tamil, Hindi, Assamese & Bengali); Edmond Ranson
- Best Direction: Statue of Unity - Ekta Ka Prateek; Aanand L Rai
- Best Animation Film: Touched as Water (Silent); Producer: JB Productions; Director & Animator: Joshy Benedict
- Best Non-Feature Film Promoting Social and Environmental Values: Piplantari: A Tale of Eco Feminism (Hindi, Rajasthani & English); Producer: Johnsons Suraj Films International; Director: Suraj Kumar
- Best Documentary: Ram-Nami (Hindi); Producer: BBP Studio Virtual Bharat Pvt Ltd; Director: Bharatbala Ganapathy
- Best Biographical/Historical Reconstruction Film: Kakori (Hindi); Producer: KSR Brothers & Minti Mishra; Director: Kamlesh K Mishra
- Best Debut Film: Angen (Invisible, Santhali); Director: Ravi Raj Murmu
- Best Non-Fiction Film: Bhangar (Marathi & English); Producer & Director: Sumira Roy

Jal Shakti Ministry launches 7th National Water Awards



- Recently, the Ministry of Jal Shakti has launched the 7th National Water Awards on the Rashtriya Puraskar portal of Ministry of Home Affairs.
- The first edition of the National Water Awards was introduced in the year 2018.

▪ It aims to sensitize the public about the importance of water and motivate them to adopt the best water usage practices.

▪ These awards are instituted by the Department of Water Resources, River Development and Ganga Rejuvenation, Ministry of Jal Shakti.

▪ Eligibility for the awards: Any State, District, Urban Local Body, Dam Own Agencies, & Industry who have done good work in the field of water conservation and management is eligible.

▪ Trophy and Citation: Each winner would be provided a Trophy with a Citation.

▪ Categories: This year's awards cover several categories, including Best State, Best District, Best Urban Local Body, Best Implemented Project in the Water Sector, and Best Industry for Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives in the water sector

Applications Open for Bharat Life Sciences Award 2026



▪ Bharat Life Sciences Award (BLSA) 2026 invites applications to recognise excellence in scientific research, innovation, and public health impact.

▪ The Award carries ₹7 crore grant support.

▪ It honours scientists, research institutions, universities, startups, and ecosystem leaders in life sciences and healthcare.

▪ Organised by FICCI in collaboration with Lilly.

▪ Application period: 1 July – 10 August 2026No application fee is required.

Eligible participants include:

▪ Researchers and scientists

▪ Public research institutions

▪ Universities

▪ Private sector innovators

ICMR wins Gold at National Awards for e-Governance 2026

▪ The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has received the Gold Award in Category 2 – Innovation by Use of AI and Other New Age Technologies for Providing Citizen-Centric Services at the National Awards for e-Governance 2026.

▪ The accolade was awarded to ICMR's flagship initiative, ICMR-MINDS, a National Health Research Priority project.

Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar Recognises Haveli Sangeet

▪ FOUR ARTISTS from Gujarat have been selected for the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar for 2024 and 2025.

▪ The awardees are Haveli Sangeet practitioner Goswami Shri Ranchhodlalji, Garba artist Tvisha Vyas, Rudra Veena maker Kishorbhai Somabhai Mistry and Surat-based theatre director Kapildev Shukla.

▪ Haveli Sangeet is a devotional music tradition linked with the Pushtimarg sect and the temple culture of Gujarat and Rajasthan.

▪ The award, instituted by the Sangeet Natak Akademi in 2006,

▪ The Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar is an annual award for outstanding young performers under 40 years of age in Indian performing arts.

▪ The award carries a cash prize of 25,000 rupees, a plaque, and an angavastram.

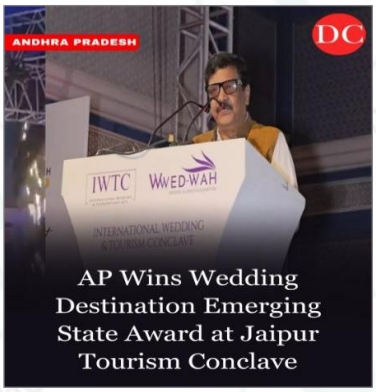
NSA Ajit Doval Selected for Lokmanya Tilak National Award



- National Security Advisor Ajit Doval has been selected for the prestigious Lokmanya Tilak Award for his significant contribution to national security.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah will present the award to Doval at a function in Pune on August 1
- He is the longest-serving National Security Advisor of India.

- Instituted in 1983, the Lokmanya Tilak Award was first conferred on socialist leader S M Joshi.
- It is awarded every year on August 1, the death anniversary of freedom fighter Bal Gangadhar Tilak, to individuals who have made a remarkable contribution to the nation's progress and development.
- Over the years, the award has been presented to several eminent personalities, including Prime Minister Narendra Modi, former PMs Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Manmohan Singh, former President Pranab Mukherjee and veteran politician Sharad Pawar.

Andhra Pradesh Tourism bags 'Best Wedding Destination Emerging State' award



- Andhra Pradesh Tourism has bagged the 'Best Wedding Destination Emerging State Award', in recognition of the State government's special initiatives to develop Andhra Pradesh as a premier hub for destination weddings and promote the wedding tourism sector.
- at the International Wedding and Tourism Conclave (IWTC) being held in Jaipur, Rajasthan

Forest watcher Murukesan at Parambikulam Tiger Reserve in Kerala wins NTCA award 2026



- Murukesan N., a forest watcher and naturalist at Parambikulam Tiger Reserve, has won this year's National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) award of excellence for tiger conservation.
- He will receive the award from Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change Bhupender Yadav in New Delhi on July 29, the World Tiger Day.
- Apart from the national recognition, the award carries a cash prize too.
- A member of the Malasar tribal community from Sungam hamlet in Parambikulam, Murukesan, 44, has dedicated the past 25 years to conservation in Parambikulam Tiger Reserve.
- The NTCA award is among the country's highest honours for service in tiger reserves.

Union Minister of Communications Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia confers Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Telecom Excellence Awards

- Union Minister of Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia conferred the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Telecom Excellence Awards- 2025 to two organizations for their outstanding contributions in Telecom Technology.

The awardees are as follows:

- **Amantya Technologies Pvt. Ltd.**
- **Finaara**

- 'Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Telecom Excellence Awards' have been instituted by Department of Telecommunications, Ministry of Communications,
- To encourage innovations in telecom sector and stimulate/ inspire Telecom Skill ecosystem by rewarding the successful telecom skilled people and institutions of India annually for their exemplary and outstanding contributions in the areas of Telecom Innovations, Telecom Skilling, Telecom Services, Telecom Manufacturing, Telecom Applications in deploying telecom dependent sectoral solutions for different fields such as agriculture, commerce, health, education etc.

Awards - International

Jamir Nazir's AI-suspected story 'The Serpent in the Grove' wins Commonwealth Short Story Prize



- Trinidadian writer Jamir Nazir, 61, who wrote 'The Serpent in the Grove', has been named the 2026 overall winner of the £5,000 (₹6,23,500) award.
- Since 2012, Granta has been publishing the winners of the Prize — awarded in partnership with the Commonwealth Foundation — for five geographies: Africa, Asia, Canada and Europe, the Caribbean, and the Pacific.

Winners

- Asia region: Sharon Aruparayil (India) for Mehendi Nights
- Africa: Lisa-Anne Julien (South Africa) for Me and Ma'am
- Canada and Europe: John Edward DeMicoli (Malta) for The Bastion's Shadow. DeMicoli is the first Maltese writer ever to win the regional prize.
- Caribbean region: Jamir Nazir (Trinidad and Tobago) for The Serpent in the Grove.
- Pacific region: Holly Ann Miller (New Zealand) for Second Skin

Krithi Karanth named 2026 Rolex National Geographic Explorer of the Year



- A trailblazing conservation scientist and educator Krithi K. Karanth has been named the 2026 Rolex National Geographic Explorer of the Year.
- Already a Rolex Awards Laureate, she has dedicated her career to reducing wildlife-human conflict in India, launching multiple ambitious conservation programmes that impact 100 wildlife reserves.

Samriddh Gram Digital Inclusion Wins WSIS Prize



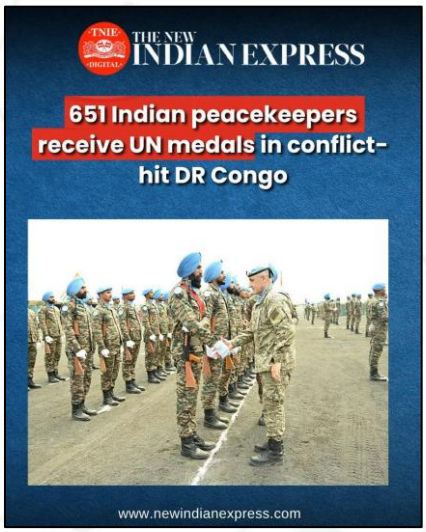
- Recently, the Department of Telecommunications' (DoT) Samriddh Gram has won the World Summit on the Information Society (WSIS) Prizes 2026 under Action Line C6 – Enabling Environment.
- It is a flagship rural digital transformation initiative of the Department of Telecommunications built on the BharatNet network.
- Objective: It is envisaged as a pioneering phygital (physical + digital) Services model integrating on-ground presence with robust digital infrastructure to empower rural citizens.
- The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has been conferred the National Award for e-Governance 2026 (Gold) by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances for its AI-enabled Clinical Decision Support System integrated with the eSanjeevani telemedicine service."
- The AI-enabled Clinical Decision Support System integrated with the eSanjeevani platform offers clinical support to doctors based on patient symptoms, enhancing clinical decision-making and benefiting millions of patients.

FIU-IND case regarding large-scale cyber fraud recognised as runner-up at Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026

- The Financial Intelligence Unit–India (FIU-IND) secured the Runner-up position at the Best Egmont Case Award (BECA) 2026 during the Egmont Group Plenary held in Baku, Azerbaijan.
- The Best Egmont Case Award recognises excellence in financial intelligence, international cooperation, and efforts to combat money laundering and terrorist financing.
- The Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU) was established under the Ministry of Finance.

▪ The recognition highlights India's growing leadership in financial intelligence and its commitment to strengthening the Anti-Money Laundering/Counter Financing of Terrorism (AML/CFT) framework.

651 Indian Army Personnel Awarded UN Medal for Peacekeeping Mission in DR Congo



▪ 651 Indian Army personnel serving under the United Nations have been awarded the prestigious United Nations Medal during a ceremonial Medal Parade held at the Permanent Operating Base Sake in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC).

▪ The medals recognise the battalion's exceptional professionalism, operational excellence and steadfast dedication while serving under UN Organisation Stabilisation Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO)

▪ India has been deploying troops to MONUSCO since 2005

Soumya Swaminathan inducted as Fellow of the Royal Society

▪ Leading Indian scientist Soumya Swaminathan was formally inducted as a Fellow of the Royal Society of London

▪ She follows her father—the legendary agricultural scientist and Bharat Ratna MS Swaminathan to the oldest science academy of the world.

▪ The Royal Society is the oldest Science Academy in the world.

▪ A former Chief Scientist at the World Health Organisation (WHO) and former Director General of the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR), Soumya is currently principal advisor to the National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme.

▪ Soumya Swaminathan became the second Indian woman scientist to receive this fellowship.

▪ Prof. Gagandeep Kang was elected in 2019 and became the first Indian woman Fellow of the Royal Society.

Hospital earns Guinness World Record for largest IBD awareness programme



▪ Yashoda Hospitals, Somajiguda, Hyderabad has secured a place in the Guinness World Records by organising the world's largest awareness session on Inflammatory Bowel Disease (IBD).

▪ A total of 578 participants attended the programme simultaneously, both in person and online, setting a new global record.

Ahmedabad sets world record by planting 3.61 lakh saplings in one hour

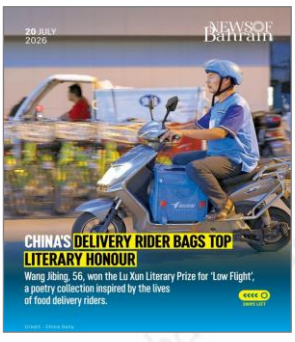
▪ Ahmedabad has made the its entry into the Guinness World Records by planting 361,000 saplings in a single hour, and establishing a new world record for the largest Miyawaki action for plantation in an hour.

▪ This initiative was organized by the Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC)

▪ Miyawaki Method is a method of the afforestation which was introduced by Japanese botanist, Dr. Akira Miyawaki, in the 1970s.

▪ The method works by planting a variety of native plants in a single area to create the forests which are almost like natural forests.

Food Delivery Rider Wins China's Lu Xun Literary Prize



- Wang Jibing, a food delivery rider and poet from Jiangsu province, won the poetry category of China's Lu Xun Literary Prize for his collection Low Flight.
- His poetry collection Low Flight, published in 2024

- The ninth edition of the prize recognised 35 works across seven categories, and the award was established in 1996 in memory of the Chinese writer Lu Xun.
- The Lu Xun Literary Prize is one of China's major literary awards and is given every four years. It recognises works in several genres, including poetry, fiction, essays, and literary criticism

James Gray to Receive Locarno Career Pardo Award

- American filmmaker James Gray will receive the Pardo alla Carriera, also called the Honorary Career Pardo Award, at the 79th Locarno Film Festival in Locarno, Switzerland.
- The award ceremony is scheduled for 9 August 2026 in Piazza Grande, the open-air screening venue in the Swiss city.

Pankaj Tripathi to receive Artist of Distinction award at IFFM 2026



- Actor Pankaj Tripathi will be honoured with the Artist of Distinction award at the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne 2026.
- the honour will be presented to celebrate the actor's "exceptional contribution to Indian cinema and his remarkable journey as one of the country's most respected performers".
- This will also be the first time the National Award-winning actor will attend the festival and receive the honour in Melbourne, Australia.
- The festival will take place in Melbourne, Austrailia from August 13-23.

Shorts news

▪ Rani Mukerji will be conferred the prestigious Honorary Doctor of Letters by La Trobe University at the Indian Film Festival of Melbourne (IFFM) 2026 for her contribution to cinema.

Obituaries

Demise of Sir Garfield Sobers



▪ Legendary former West Indies all-rounder Sir Garfield Sobers, regarded as one of the greatest cricketers of all time, has died aged 89.

▪ Sobers played 93 Tests between 1954 and 1974, scored 8,032 runs and took 235 wickets.

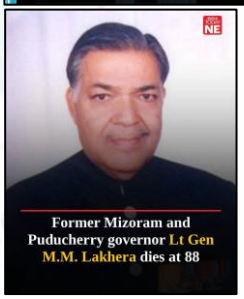
▪ He was also named one of Wisden's five cricketers of the 20th century.

Former Emir of Qatar, Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani dies at 74

▪ Former Emir Sheikh Hamad bin Khalifa Al Thani, who ruled Qatar from 1995 until his abdication in 2013, has died at the age of 74.

▪ Sheikh Hamad is widely regarded as one of the key architects of modern Qatar.

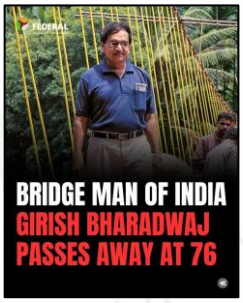
Mr. M.M. Lakhera former Lieutenant Governor of Puducherry passed away



▪ A former General officer of Indian Army, Lakhera served as the Lt. Governor of Puducherry from 2004 to 2006.

▪ He served as the Governor of Mizoram from July 2006 to September 2011.

'Bridge Man of India' Girish Bharadwaj passes away in Sullia



▪ Girish Bharadwaj, the architect of hanging foot bridges built across India, passed away in Dakshina Kannada district of Karnataka,

▪ The Union Government had honoured him with the 'Padma Shri' award in 2017 for building over 140 hanging foot bridges, mainly for rural connectivity, in different parts of

the country.

▪ He was popularly called 'Bridge Man' of India.



Sahitya Akademi Award-winning Tamil writer Poomani passes away

▪ Sahitya Akademi Award-winning and one of the most distinguished figures in Tamil literature, Poomani (Pulithurai Manickavasagam) passed away at the age of 79 years

▪ Poomani received the Sahitya Akademi Award in 2014 for his monumental novel 'Agnaadi', an epic narrative set against the backdrop of the Sivakasi (1899) and Kazhugumalai (1895) communal riots.

Legendary playback singer S Janaki passes away at 88



▪ Veteran playback singer S Janaki, fondly known as the "Nightingale of South India," died.

▪ Born in Andhra Pradesh.

▪ she recorded over 40,000 songs in around 20 Indian languages, including Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada, Hindi, Bengali, Odia, Tulu, Urdu and Punjabi.

▪ She received four National Film Awards for Best Female Playback Singer,

▪ Janaki retired from playback singing in 2016,

▪ She is conferred with 33 State Film Awards.

▪ She was chosen for Padma Bhushan in 2013.

Pandavani legend Teejan Bai dies at 70



▪ Teejan Bai, an artiste who took the ancient Chhattisgarhi folk tradition of Pandvani — musical narration of Mahabharata — to the world, died

▪ Known for her powerful voice, animated storytelling, and captivating stage presence involving her signature stringed instrument (tambura),

▪ The Government of India conferred upon her its civilian accolades: Padma Shri (1988), Padma Bhushan (2003) and Padma Vibhushan (2019).

Noted film and theatre personality Vijaya Mehta passes away at 92



▪ Noted film and theatre personality Vijaya Mehta passed away at her Mumbai residence last night at the age of 92.

▪ She was one of the pioneers of experimental Marathi theatre.

▪ Vijaya Mehta, fondly known as 'Bai', introduced a new theatrical language, fresh perspectives, and a globally informed approach to Marathi stagecraft.

▪ Vijaya Mehta was honoured with the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1975 and the National Film Award for Best Supporting Actress for 'Rao Saheb' in 1986,

▪ She also made a significant mark in films and television with works such as, 'Pestonjee', 'Shakuntalam', and the television series 'Smritichitre'.

Sahitya Akademi Award winner Puviyarasu no more

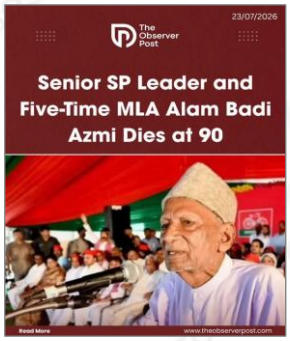


▪ Poet Puviyarasu, a two-time recipient of the Sahitya Akademi Award and one of the founders of the Vanampadi poetry movement that helped shape modern Tamil verse, died

▪ He received the Sahitya Akademi Award for Translation in 2006 for his Tamil translation of the poems of Kazi Nazrul Islam, published under the title Puratchikaran.

- In 2009, he won the Sahitya Akademi Award for his poetry collection Kaiyoppam.

U.P. oldest MLA Alam Badi Azmi dies.



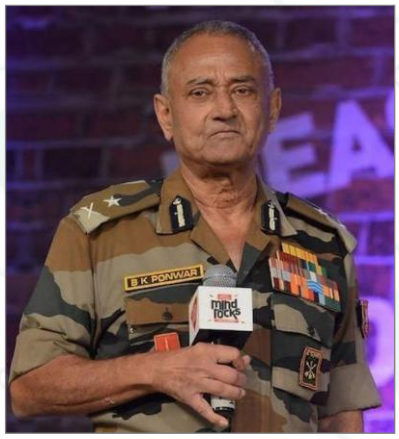
- Alam Badi Azami, 90, the oldest member of the Uttar Pradesh Vidhan Sabha and a five-time MLA from the Nizamabad assembly constituency in Azamgarh district, died
- He represented the Nizamabad constituency five times between 1996 and 2007 and again from 2012 until now.

Hira Singh Bisht, Former Uttarakhand Minister, Dies at 85



- Senior Congress leader and former Uttarakhand minister Hira Singh Bisht passed away due to cardiac arrest.
- Born on November 4, 1940, **Bisht began his political career in undivided Uttar Pradesh.**
- Bisht was a three-time MLA. In 1985, he was elected for the first time from the Dehradun Assembly constituency.
- He served as the state president of the Indian National Trade Union Congress (INTUC) in Uttarakhand
- He was among the founding members of the Cricket Association of Uttarakhand.

Brigadier B.K. Ponwar, Jungle Warfare Pioneer, Dies at 77



- Brigadier Basant Kumar Ponwar (Retd), a decorated veteran of the 1971 Indo-Pak War and the architect of the country's modern jungle warfare against Maoist insurgency, died here.
- Born on March 3, 1949, in Indore, he was commissioned into the 1st Battalion of the Maratha Light Infantry (1 MLI) in December 1969.
- served as Commandant of the Army's Counter Insurgency and Jungle Warfare School (CIJWS) in Vairengte, Mizoram, where he oversaw the inaugural Indo-US exercise 'Yudh Abhyas' in 2004.
- The Counter Terrorism and Jungle Warfare College was established in August 2005 in Kanker in the Bastar region of Chhattisgarh.
- He was awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM) and Vishisht Seva Medal (VSM) for exceptional service.

Inventor of Plastination Dr. Gunther von Hagens Dies at 81



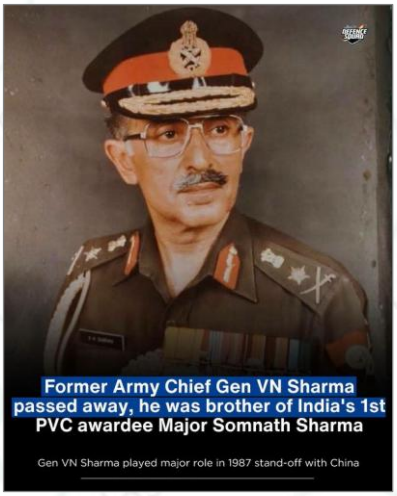
- Gunther von Hagens, the creator of the controversial "Body Worlds" exhibitions where dissected human and animal bodies were displayed, has died at the age of 81
- Sometimes known as "**Doctor Death**", he became famous for developing a technique called plastination, **by which fluids and fatty tissue in corpses are replaced by rubber and polymers.**

Former AC Milan defender Franco Baresi dies at 66

- Franco Baresi, the former AC Milan defender and World Cup winner with Italy, has died. He was 66.
- Baresi spent his entire 20-year playing career with the club from 1977 until he retired in 1997, winning six Serie A titles and three European Cups/Champions Leagues.
- Baresi captained Milan for 15 seasons, making 719 appearances and scoring 33 goals.
- He was capped 81 times by Italy and was part of the squad which won the 1982 World Cup.
- In 2020, Baresi became honorary vice-president of AC Milan,

- He also lifted four Supercoppa Italianas, two European Super Cups and the Intercontinental Cup twice.

Demise of former COAS General Vishwa Nath Sharma



- General Vishwa Nath Sharma, former Chief of Army Staff, passed away in New Delhi at the age of 97.
- He served as the 14th Chief of Army Staff (COAS) from 1 May 1988 to 30 June 1990.
- He was the first President's Commissioned Officer to rise to the position of Army Chief.
- He was commissioned into the 16th Light Cavalry of the Armoured Corps.
- Led the Indian Army during a challenging period marked by insurgency in Punjab.
- Oversaw operations involving the Indian Peace Keeping Force (IPKF) in Sri Lanka.
- The IPKF operation against the LTTE was the most significant challenge during his tenure.
- Served as Colonel General Staff Operations of an Armoured Division on the Western Front during the 1971 India-Pakistan War.
- Took over as General Officer Commanding-in-Chief (GOC-in-C), Eastern Command in June 1987 before becoming Army Chief.

National

Aastha Van Sanrakshan Yojana - Centre Clears ₹3,000-Crore to Save 15,000 Sacred Groves



- The Union Minister of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change has approved the conservation of over 15,000 "sacred groves" across the country under a new scheme called the "Aastha Van Sanrakshan Yojana".
- The new scheme, with an initial corpus of `3,000 crore over five years (2026-27 to 2030-31), aims to conserve and restore nearly 15,000 sacred groves (Aastha Vans) across the country, alongside a new scheme for landscape restoration to combat land degradation and biodiversity loss, funded by the National Fund."
- Sacred groves, or "Aastha Vans", are specific forest areas that local communities, particularly tribal groups, protect due to their spiritual and cultural significance.
- These locations are often considered sacred, and caring for them is an integral part of the community's traditions and beliefs.
- Additionally, the groves also serve as sources of local rivulets and drinking water.

Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme



- The Central Government is considering extending the Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises (PMFME) Scheme until 2029 owing to its success.
- It was launched on 29 June 2020.
- It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme that focuses on the growth and formalisation of micro food units across the country.
- The scheme is part of the Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyaan and supports the Vocal for Local vision in the food processing sector.

▪ It provides financial, technical and business assistance to entrepreneurs for setting up new units or upgrading existing ones.

Financial Outlay & Time Period

▪ The scheme runs from 2020-21 to 2025-26 with an outlay of Rs. 10,000 crores.

▪ The expenditure under the scheme is to be shared in 60:40 ratio between Central and State Governments, in 90:10 ratio with North Eastern and Himalayan States, 60:40 ratio with UTs with legislature and 100% by the Center for other UTs

Features

▪ Credit-linked capital subsidy 35% of the eligible project cost, maximum ceiling Rs.10 lakh per unit.

▪ It provides seed capital of Rs. 40,000/- per member of SHG engaged in food processing for working capital and purchase of small tools subject to maximum of Rs. 4 lakh per SHG Federation.

▪ Credit linked capital subsidy @35% subject to maximum of Rs. 3 crore to support FPOs, SHGs, Cooperatives and any Government agency for setting up of common infrastructure.

▪ Grant upto 50% for Branding and Marketing to groups of FPOs/ SHGs/ Cooperatives or an SPV of micro food processing enterprises.

Amrit Bharat Station Scheme



▪ Recently, the Prime Minister of India virtually inaugurated 75 redeveloped railway stations across 20 states under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme (ABSS).

▪ It was launched in 2022 which aims at development and upgradation of railway stations over the Indian Railways (IR) network.

▪ The policy is based on Master Planning for long term and implementation of the same as per needs and demand of the station to station.

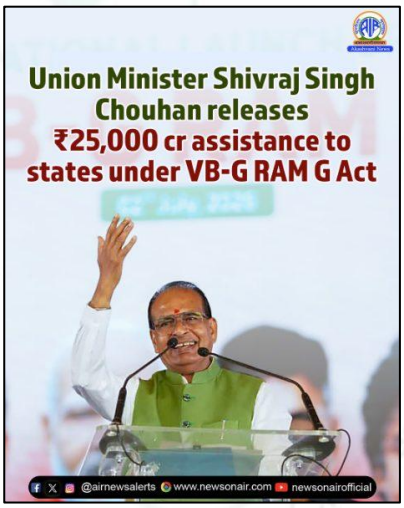
▪ The ABSS has a long-term vision that involves creating master plans, promoting multimodal connectivity, better station accessibility for passengers, etc.

▪ The goal is to make stations cleaner, more comfortable, and easier to use.

▪ Amenities: It includes proving entry and exit points, waiting halls, toilets, platforms, and roofing. Facilities like lifts, escalators, and free Wi-Fi are added wherever needed.

▪ Local Economy Support: Local products will be sold at kiosks under the 'One Station One Product' scheme

Shivraj Singh Chouhan Releases First Installment of ₹25,863 Crore to States for VB-G-RAM-G



▪ Union Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan released the first instalment, or Mother Sanction, of ₹25,863 crore to states for the implementation of the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) [VB-G-RAM-G].

▪ The Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) Act, 2025, has come into effect, replacing the two-decade-old Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005.

▪ guaranteeing 125 days of paid employment per year to rural households (up from 100 days).

▪ a 60-day pause during peak agricultural sowing and harvesting seasons has been built in — to ensure adequate availability of farm labour during critical agricultural periods.

▪ It will operate as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS), with a fund sharing pattern of 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan States/UT and 60:40 for all other States.

▪ Union Territories without legislatures continue receiving 100% Central funding.

Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme

▪ Recently, the Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister of India has approved the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS) with a budgetary outlay of Rs 62,500 crore.

▪ Aim: It aims at building Indian brands to achieve technological sovereignty, capture large economic value and create Indian patents in design and R&D.

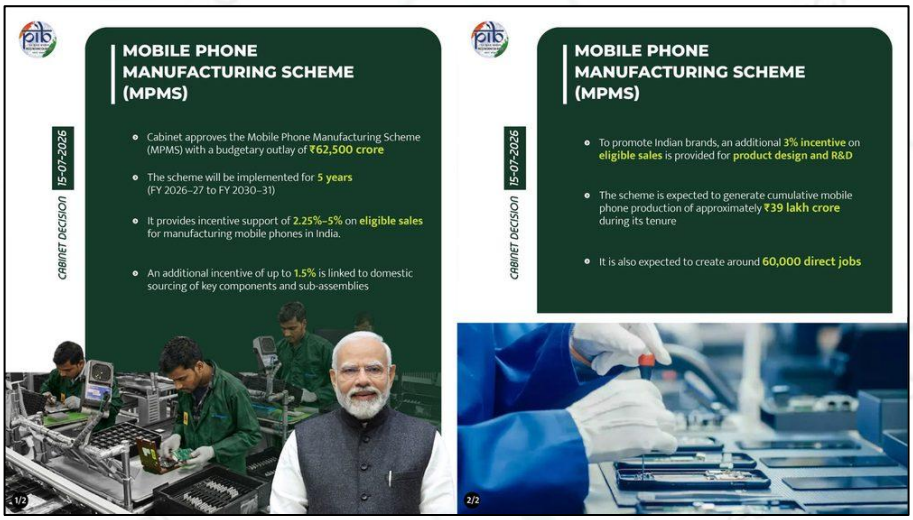
▪ Time Period: The scheme tenure shall be 5 Years i.e. from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31.

Features

▪ The scheme provides incentive support on eligible sales for manufacturing of mobile phones in India at differentiated rates ranging from 2.25% to 5%.

▪ The scheme also provides additional incentive of up to 1.5% linked to domestic sourcing of key components/ sub-assemblies.

▪ For building Indian brands, an additional incentive of 3% on Eligible Sales for design and R&D of the product.



PARIVARTAN Scheme

▪ Recently, the Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs (MoHUA) has approved the Guidelines for the PARIVARTAN Scheme.

▪ PARIVARTAN (Programme for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivization of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air Pollution and Network Emissions) was launched by the central government.

▪ It is aimed at facilitating the replacement of older, highly polluting trucks and buses operating in the National Capital Region (NCR) with cleaner Bharat Stage (BS)-VI compliant or electric vehicles.

▪ Implementing Ministry: It is implemented by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH).

▪ Funding: It is funded by the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB)

▪ States Covered: Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and NCT of Delhi issued notifications granting Motor Vehicle Tax

Incentives under the Scheme

▪ Motor Vehicle Tax concessions, registration fee waivers,

▪ 5% interest subvention on vehicle loans,

▪ A minimum 8% OEM discount on eligible new vehicles,

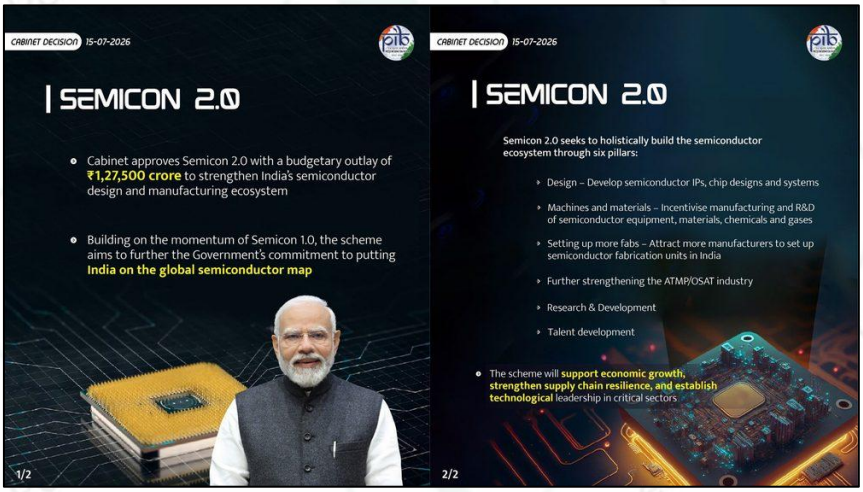
▪ Monthly fuel voucher support for eligible diesel and CNG replacement vehicles, and

▪ One-time financial assistance for electric replacement vehicles and Certificate of Deposit (CoD) trading.

▪ It will be implemented through an integrated digital platform that will seamlessly interface with VAHAN, V-Scrap, DigiELV, the Public Financial Management System (PFMS), participating lenders

Cabinet approves Rs 1.27 lakh crore Semicon 2.0 to strengthen India's semiconductor ecosystem

▪ The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved Semicon 2.0, a comprehensive programme with a budget outlay of ₹1,27,500 crore aimed at strengthening India's semiconductor design and manufacturing ecosystem and providing long-term policy support to the sector.



▪ Semicon 2.0 has been designed around six key pillars covering chip design, manufacturing equipment and materials, fabrication facilities, semiconductor packaging, research and development, and talent development.

The National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 for Atmanirbhar Bharat (NIPU-2026)



▪ The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, officially approved the National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 for Atmanirbhar Bharat (NIPU-2026).

▪ NIPU-2026 is a newly approved macroeconomic sector-specific investment policy aimed at reviving, expanding, and constructing advanced, domestic natural gas-based urea manufacturing plants.

▪ Objectives: The objective of the policy is to add 10 million tonnes of fresh, indigenous urea production capacity by supporting the establishment of eight to nine new natural gas-based fertilizer plants.

Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal launches 'Seafarer-First' initiative to safeguard Indian seafarers in conflict-affected region

▪ Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW), Sarbananda Sonowal launched a comprehensive 'Seafarer-First' response, directing an unprecedented whole-of-government approach to safeguard every Indian seafarer operating in the conflict-affected region.

▪ To establish a comprehensive vessel-by-vessel operational dashboard to account for every Indian on every vessel, irrespective of their flags, operating in the Persian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman.

▪ The dashboard will provide real-time information on vessel position, ownership, cargo, crew strength, crew welfare, threat assessment, intended voyage, next port of call and the availability of facilities.

MECON Achieves Miniratna Category-I Status with Net Worth Surpassing ₹535 Crore



▪ The Ministry of Steel has approved the grant of Miniratna Category-I status to MECON Limited, a Schedule 'A' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE) under the administrative control of the Ministry of Steel.

▪ MECON Limited, established in 1959 and headquartered in Ranchi, is one of India's premier engineering, consultancy, project management and contracting organizations.

▪ Category-I CPSEs: Can incur capital expenditure on new projects, modernization, or equipment purchase without government approval up to ₹500 crore or up to 100% of their net worth, whichever is lower.

▪ Category-II CPSEs: Have a lower financial ceiling, allowing capital investments up to ₹300 crore or up to 50% of their net worth, whichever is lower.

Central Vista Area to Be Renamed Kartavya Bhawan Area

▪ The Central Vista redevelopment area in New Delhi is being referred to as the Kartavya Bhawan Complex or Kartavya Bhawan Area

▪ The renamed precinct covers the government buildings, Kartavya Marg, and future structures within the Central Vista zone.

▪ Central Vista is the central administrative axis of India in New Delhi. It includes major government buildings and ceremonial spaces between Rashtrapati Bhavan and India Gate.

SwaYaan Initiative

▪ Recently, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and Drone Federation India launched National Innovation Challenge for Drone Research (NIDAR) under SwaYaan initiative

▪ SwaYaan initiative was launched in 2022.

▪ It is a National Initiative by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) to develop and strengthen the UAS/Drone ecosystem in India.

▪ The vision is in line with the Government of India's initiative to make India a global Drone hub by the year 2030.

TribeX Platform

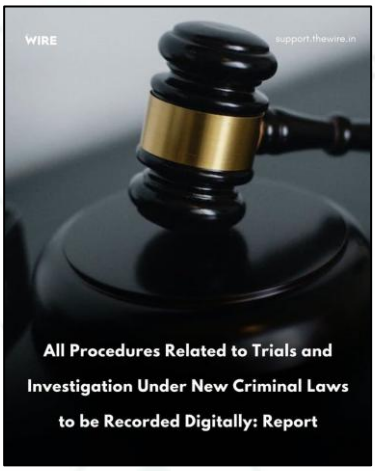
▪ Recently, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched the TribeX platform.

▪ It is a first-of-its-kind digital learning platform dedicated to tribal arts, culture, traditional knowledge and skill development.

▪ It is conceived as a comprehensive digital learning ecosystem and offers structured learning opportunities through free certificate courses and UGC-recognized Post Graduate diploma programmes in tribal languages, art forms, crafts and traditional knowledge.

▪ It currently hosts 20 free certificate courses across a diverse range of tribal art forms, including paintings, handicrafts, handloom, artefacts and traditional musical instruments.

The Union Minister of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change recently launched the PaleoIndia Portal



▪ It is a digital initiative developed jointly by the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) and the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management (NCSCM), Chennai, using dynamic geological maps provided by the GSI.

▪ The digital platform documents fossil fauna across all 28 states and 8 Union Territories.

▪ It currently hosts information on more than 5,000 fossil specimens spanning mammals, reptiles, birds, fishes, amphibians, molluscs, arthropods, foraminifera, echinoderms, and ichnofossils.

▪ It features a real-time data upload system to enable field-based and citizen science contributions for safeguarding India's paleontological heritage

Key Facts about National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management

▪ It was established by the Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change (MoEF&CC) in 2011 as an autonomous institution to support the protection, conservation, rehabilitation, management, and policy advice of the coast.

▪ **Headquarters: Chennai, Tamil Nadu**

The Interoperable Criminal Justice System (ICJS)

- The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) announced that the nationwide rollout of the Interoperable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) is on track, with all investigations and trials under the BNS, BNSS, and BSS to be digitally recorded from January 1, 2027.
- The Interoperable Criminal Justice System (ICJS) is a unified national digital platform that integrates the main, traditionally isolated pillars of the criminal justice delivery network into a single conversational ecosystem.
- It replaces legacy, paper-driven workflows with a secure cloud-based data framework hosted on the government's MeghRaj cloud infrastructure.
- **Nodal Agency: National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.**
- **Technology Partner: Developed and architected by the National Informatics Centre (NIC).**

Aim:

- **One Data, Once Entry Principle: To cut out manual redundancies by ensuring that case data needs to be entered into the system only once, making it instantly usable across all platforms.**
- **Promoting SMART Policing: To move away from scattered physical records and toward an intelligence-led, paperless justice system supported by data analytics.**

Key Features and Five-Pillar Architecture:

- **CCTNS (Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems): Connects over 16,000 police stations across India, supporting FIR registration in 23 languages with Bhashini integration for Zero-FIR translation.**
- **e-Courts & e-Prosecution: e-Courts enables digital transfer of case files, e-Summons, and evidence tracking, while e-Prosecution digitizes prosecutors' case records and legal workflows for faster trials.**
- **e-Prisons: Maintains a centralized database of prison inmates with biometric records, while providing online services such as e-Mulaqat and digital grievance redressal.**

Doctrine of Per Incuriam

- In a significant ruling, the Supreme Court recently clarified the circumstances under which a judicial decision can be declared per incuriam—a legal doctrine that allows courts to disregard a precedent rendered in ignorance of binding law or an earlier authoritative judgment.
- The term "per incuriam," meaning 'through lack of care,' refers to judgments passed without reference to, or in ignorance of, a statute or an earlier judgement/precedent which would have been relevant and therefore affected the result of the case.
- As per legal principles, these judgments, which are decided based on incorrect interpretations of the law, may cause legal and practical issues.

Trial in Absentia



- A Special NIA Court in Jammu issued a non-bailable warrant against Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba chief Hafiz Saeed in connection with the Pahalgam terror attack case.
- The NIA may seek his trial in absentia under Section 356 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023.
- Trial in absentia refers to a criminal trial conducted in the absence of the accused.
- Under Section 356 of the BNSS, a court may conduct the inquiry, trial and pronounce judgment against a proclaimed offender who has deliberately absconded to evade trial and has no immediate prospect of arrest.
- The person must first be declared a proclaimed offender under Section 84(4) of the BNSS.
- The accused must face an offence punishable with at least 10 years' imprisonment, life imprisonment or death under the BNS or any other law.

▪ Before commencing the trial, two consecutive warrants of arrest must be issued at an interval of at least 30 days.



The e-OCI Card

▪ Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation launched the FCRA 2.0 Portal and the highly anticipated e-OCI (Electronic Overseas Citizen of India) Card in New Delhi.

▪ The Electronic Overseas Citizen of India (e-OCI) Card is a citizen-centric, paperless documentation framework designed for the global Indian diaspora.

▪ It converts the traditional, physical OCI stamp-and-booklet layout into an institutionalized, securely verifiable digital credential.

▪ Ministry: Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), Government of India.

Aim:

▪ To eliminate physical paperwork, verification delays, and administrative overhead costs for more than 50 lakh OCI holders.

▪ To integrate diaspora credentials directly with real-time digital immigration security lines across all Indian airports.

President of India to inaugurate 'Saushrutam 2026' at AIIA, New Delhi on Sushruta Jayanti



▪ The President of India, Smt. Droupadi Murmu, will grace the inaugural ceremony of Saushrutam 2026 .

▪ Hosted by the All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA), New Delhi, an autonomous body under the Ministry of Ayush, from 15 to 17 July 2026.

▪ Celebrated to mark Sushruta Jayanti, observed annually on 15 July to honour Acharya Sushruta, widely regarded as the Father of Surgery.

Monsoon Session of Parliament to Be Held from July 20 to August 13

▪ Sessions of Parliament are the periods during which both Houses of the Indian Parliament to conduct their business.

▪ **Article 85 of the Indian Constitution empowers the President to summon each House at intervals not exceeding six months.**

▪ While the Constitution does not specify the number of sessions or sitting days, Parliament typically meets three times a year.

Sessions of Parliament: A session refers to the period between the first sitting and prorogation of a House. A recess is the interval between prorogation and reassembly of Parliament. Typically, there are 3 sessions in a year:



▪ **Budget Session (Feb–May)**

▪ **Monsoon Session (July–August)**

▪ **Winter Session (Nov–Dec)**

▪ The Monsoon Session of Parliament typically occurs between July and August, named for the coinciding monsoon season.

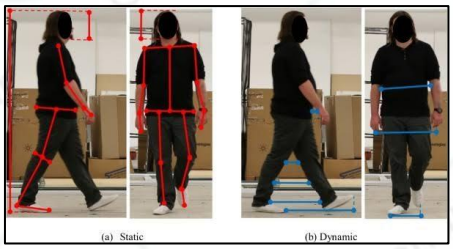
▪ This session primarily focuses on enacting legislation, allowing Members of Parliament to introduce bills, engage in extensive debates, and collectively decide on their passage.

Gait Analysis

▪ During the high-profile investigation into the Ketan Agarwal murder case at Lohagad Fort, a Pune court extended the police custody of the accused to allow investigators to conduct a forensic gait analysis.

▪ Gait analysis is the systematic and scientific study of human locomotion—specifically how an individual walks, hops, or runs.

▪ It involves a detailed biomechanical breakdown of how the nervous system coordinates continuously with bones, muscles, and joints to move the body forward, producing a highly distinct "biomechanical signature" for every individual.



Primary Applications

▪ Helps identify suspects from CCTV footage by analysing unique walking patterns such as limps, stride length, or body posture when facial identification is unavailable.

▪ Assists in diagnosing Parkinson's disease, stroke, cerebral palsy, dementia, orthopedic disorders, and monitoring rehabilitation through gait abnormalities.

▪ Enables athletes to improve running efficiency, reduce injury risk, optimize movement mechanics, and design customized footwear through gait analysis.

Academic Bank of Credit

▪ The Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) and the Automated Permanent Academic Account Registry (APAAR) are building a trusted digital ecosystem for academic records, making education more flexible, transparent, and accessible for every learner.

▪ It is a revolutionary digital platform by the Ministry of Education, Government of India.

▪ It is regulated by the University Grants Commission (UGC).

▪ It is built to support every learner's journey by providing a digital platform for storing, managing, transferring, and redeeming academic credits earned by students from recognised educational institutions.

▪ The main objective of ABC is to create a flexible, learner-friendly education system in which learning achievements can be recognised, stored, and used throughout a person's life.

▪ It supports the vision of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the National Credit Framework (NCrF)..

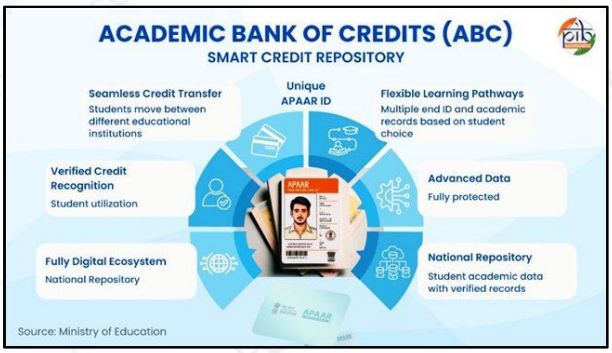
How Does Academic Bank of Credit Work?

▪ Students register on the ABC portal and receive a unique ABC ID or APAAR ID linked to their Aadhaar and DigiLocker account.

▪ Students belonging to eligible Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) can use the ABC facility.

▪ Academic institutions upload credit data directly to the ABC portal against each student's account.

▪ Students can accumulate, transfer, and redeem credits across HEIs without losing academic progress.



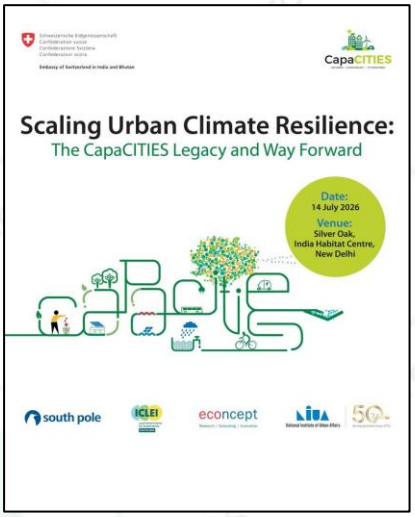
▪ Credits are valid for a maximum of 7 years or the duration prescribed by the relevant academic discipline. Once redeemed, credits cannot be reused

▪ Credit redemption and certificate issuance are handled by academic institutions via the National Academic Depository (NAD) platform.

CapaCITIES Programme

▪ Recently, an event 'Scaling Urban Climate Resilience: The CapaCITIES Legacy and Way Forward', celebrated the progress made over a decade of the CapaCITIES programme.

▪ It was launched in 2016.



- The Capacity Building Project on Low Carbon and Climate Resilient City Development in India (CapaCITIES) programme strengthens the capacities of Indian cities to promote low-carbon, climate-resilient urban development.
- Funding: It is funded by the Embassy of Switzerland to India and Bhutan.
- Implemented By: The initiative was implemented through a collaborative partnership involving ICLEI South Asia, South Pole and econcept.
- Knowledge Partner: the National Institute of Urban Affairs
- Phases: First phase (2016-19) AND second phase (2019-23)

Key Features

- It has equipped Indian cities with the knowledge, tools, and institutional capacities to mainstream low-carbon, climate-resilient development into urban governance.
- City Support: It has supported cities like Coimbatore, Thiruchirappalli Tirunelveli in Tamil Nadu, Ahmedabad, Rajkot, Vadodara, Udaipur and Siliguri and the state governments of Gujarat, Tamil Nadu.
- **Institutional Governance: Established permanent Net-Zero and Climate Action Cells in six project cities to enable long-term implementation, monitoring, and climate budgeting**

MANAS: A Digital Shield Against Drugs



- National Narcotics Helpline MANAS (Madak Padarth Nishedh Asoochna Kendra) was launched on 18 July 2024 under the aegis of the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, in collaboration with the Digital India Corporation (DIC).
- Built as a secure, technology-driven platform, MANAS enables citizens to report drug-related activities, seek counselling, and access rehabilitation support at any time.
- MANAS brings together the vision of Digital India and the mission of a Nasha Mukt Bharat.

India Mining Week 2026 to be held in November 15–17

- Union Minister of Coal and Mines, Shri G. Kishan Reddy, formally announced the India Mining Week 2026.
- Scheduled to be held from 15 – 17 November 2026 at the Yashobhoomi Convention Centre, New Delhi.
- The three-day summit will be organised under the theme “Stronger Resources, Smarter Mining, Sustainable Tomorrow”.

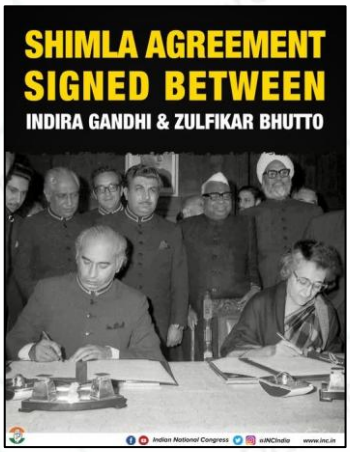
Akashvani Launches Broadcasting House Photo Gallery ‘Swar Prerna Veethika’



- Akashvani inaugurated ‘Swar Prerna Veethika’, a dedicated photo gallery celebrating the enduring bond between Akashvani and India's legendary musicians.
- The gallery was inaugurated by Padma Vibhushan Pt. Hariprasad Chaurasia at the Akashvani Rang Bhavan Auditorium, Akashvani Bhavan, New Delhi.

The Simla Agreement, signed on July 2, 1972.

- Simla Agreement or Shimla Agreement was signed on 2 July 1972 between Indian Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and Pakistani President Zulfikar Ali Bhutto.
- It was a peace pact to normalise relations after the 1971 war, which led to the creation of Bangladesh.
- Aftermath of 1971 War: The Simla Agreement was signed following the India–Pakistan war that resulted in Bangladesh’s independence and a decisive Indian victory.

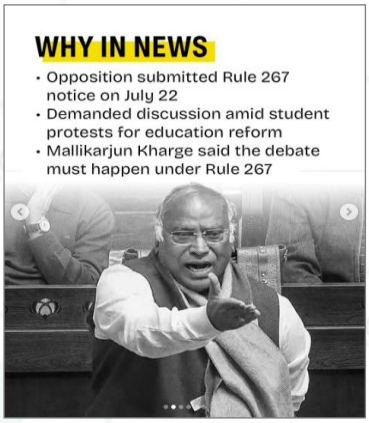


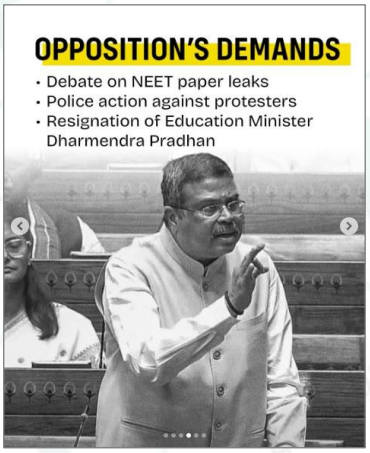
- Purpose of Agreement: The Simla Agreement aimed to facilitate troop withdrawals, ensure Prisoners of War (POW) repatriation, and establish a framework for resolving future disputes bilaterally.

Key Provisions of the Shimla Agreement

- Normalization of Relations: The principles and objectives of the United Nations Charter shall govern the relations between the two countries.
- The agreement outlined steps to resume communications, trade, cultural exchanges, and people-to-people contacts.
- It also facilitated the repatriation of prisoners of war and civilians detained during the conflict, marking a humanitarian gesture.
- Establishment of the Line of Control (LoC) in Jammu and Kashmir: The agreement converted the 1971 ceasefire line into the LoC.

What is Rule 267 in Rajya Sabha?





- In News : The Opposition has sought a discussion on the NEET paper leak issue under Rule 267 in the Rajya Sabha
- According to the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Council of States (Rajya Sabha), Rule 267 relates to the suspension of rules.
- under Rule 267, Rajya Sabha MPs can submit a written notice to suspend all listed business in the House and discuss an issue of importance that the country is facing.
- A motion under Rule 267 indicates that a matter was serious enough for the House to suspend its normal business to take it up.
- "The Chairman alone has the power to give consent for moving of a motion for suspension of a rule, and it is for the House to decide whether a particular rule should be suspended or not."
- Thus, it is the discretion of the Chairman to decide whether to allow a motion under Rule 267, as it states that "the consent of the Chairman" is required for a member to bring such a motion.
- However, this rule does not apply where specific provisions already exist for the suspension of a rule under a particular chapter of the rules.

Who can issue Rule 267?

- Any member of the Rajya Sabha can issue a notice to the Chairperson for a discussion on any subject under Rule 267.

When was Rule 267 last invoked?

- The last time it was used was in November 2016, when the Upper House invoked Rule 267 to discuss demonetisation.

Fast-Track Courts (FTCs)

- Prime Minister of India announced the establishment of **fast-track courts (FTCs)** to deliver swift and stringent justice for offenses related to examination paper leaks.
- Fast-track courts are special temporary judicial benches established to expedite the trial of specific, high-priority offenses, complex corporate frauds, or cases involving vulnerable demographics.
- They aim to reduce backlog and accelerate the judicial process by holding daily hearings and adhering to strict timelines.
- Article 14 Guarantees: Special courts must satisfy Article 14 (Equality before the Law).

Examples

- **14th Finance Commission (2015–2020):** Recommended setting up 1,800 FTCs to address heinous crimes (like murder and kidnapping) and property disputes pending over five years.
- Nirbhaya Fund Centrally Sponsored Scheme (2019): Established Fast-Track Special Courts (FTSCs) dedicated exclusively to trial cases under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and rape cases.
- **Target Disposal Rates**: FTSCs operate with a target disposal rate of 165 cases per judge annually (or ~41–42 cases per quarter).
- **High Efficiency Ratio:** FTSCs dispose of an average of 9.5 cases per month—nearly three times higher than regular trial courts (3.3 cases per month).



Law & Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal introduces Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026 in Lok Sabha

- Union Minister of Law and Justice Arjun Ram Meghwal introduced the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha.
- The bill aims to further amend the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 for increasing the number of Judges of the Apex Court from the present 33 to 37 (excluding the Chief Justice of India).
- In May this year, President Droupadi Murmu had promulgated an ordinance to increase the number of Supreme Court Judges from 33 to 37.
- Under the Constitution's Article 124, Parliament alone has the power to fix the number of Supreme Court judges.

Digital Local Pass System

- Recently, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has expanded the digital services available on the RajmargYatra mobile application by introducing a digital Local Pass System.

Digital Local Pass System

- It enables eligible commuters to purchase monthly toll passes digitally through the **RajmargYatra mobile** application without the need to visit a toll plaza.
- It has been rolled out initially at the Mundka-Bakkarwala Toll Plaza on Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II) in Delhi.

Features of Digital Local Pass System

- Under the new system, **residents living within a 20-kilometre radius of an eligible toll plaza** can purchase a Local Pass through the app, allowing them unlimited travel through the respective toll plaza for one month.
- It uses consent-based integration with government platforms such as DigiLocker and VAHAN to automatically retrieve verified information related to a commuter's address, vehicle registration and linked FASTag.
- Eligibility is further verified using GIS-based validation.

Key Facts about Rajmargyatra App

- It is a citizen-centric mobile App developed for smoother and better experience of citizens on highways, integrated with a web-based application for updating information and monitoring of complaint redressal.
- It provides information about the highway, toll plaza, nearby amenities such as petrol pumps, hospitals, charging stations, weather updates, etc

Operation Vajra: Central Bureau of Narcotics Seizes 12 Crore Tramadol Tablets

- The Central Bureau of Narcotics (CBN), under the Department of Revenue (DoR), Ministry of Finance, prevented illegal trafficking and diversion of export consignment comprising 120 million (12 crore) high-strength Tramadol Hydrochloride (250 mg) tablets,

- The operation, codenamed “Operation Vajra”, was carried out by preventive teams of the Central Bureau of Narcotics, Gwalior, during the period between 10th and 20th July 2026 across Bengaluru, Delhi and Kochi.
- high-strength Tramadol has been illegally abused in conflict zones to suppress pain, fatigue and fear among fighters, earning it the nickname “fighter drug”.

Pharma Jan Samadhan and Pharma Sahi Daam Integrated



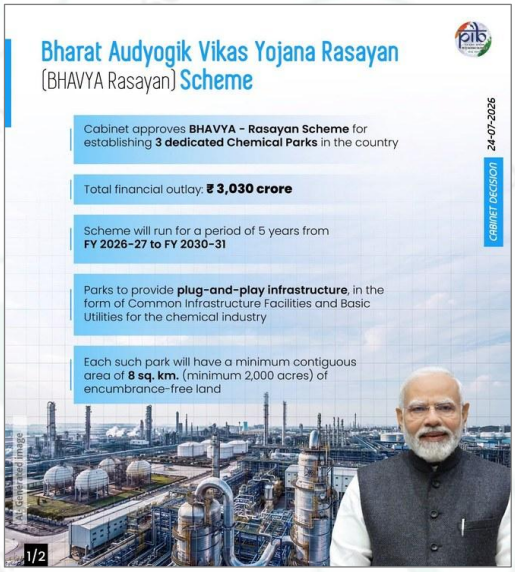
- The **National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority** integrated the Pharma Jan Samadhan portal with the Pharma Sahi Daam portal.
- The unified government platform provides a single interface for checking medicine prices and lodging complaints related to drug pricing.
- **Pharma Jan Samadhan** was launched in 2015 for consumer grievances related to medicine pricing and availability.
- **Pharma Sahi Daam** provides price information for scheduled and non-scheduled medicines.
- The integration of the two portals creates a single web-based interface for price checks and complaints.

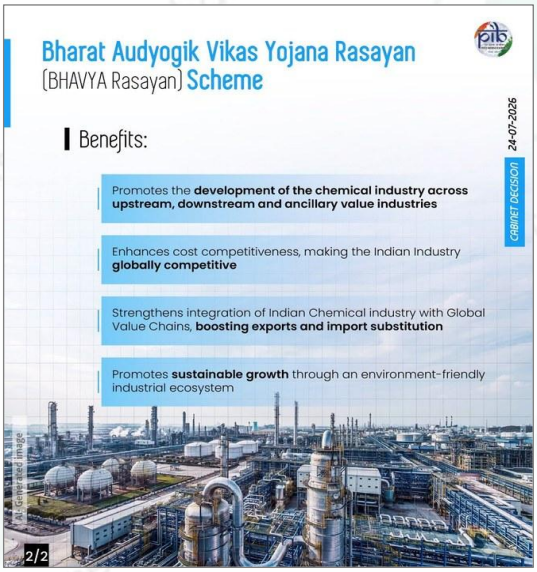
Cabinet Approves BHAVYA Rasayan Scheme

- Recently, the Union Cabinet approved the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana Rasayan BHAVYA Rasayan scheme.
- It was launched for the establishment of three dedicated chemical parks across the country.
- The scheme is designed to promote the development of the chemical industry across the entire value chain, including upstream, downstream and ancillary industries.
- Financial Outlay: It has a total financial outlay of ₹3,030 crore, (₹3,000 crore for developing common infrastructure facilities and basic utilities within the parks and ₹30 crore towards administrative expenses).
- Time Period**: The scheme will be implemented over five years, from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31.**

Features of BHAVYA Rasayan Scheme

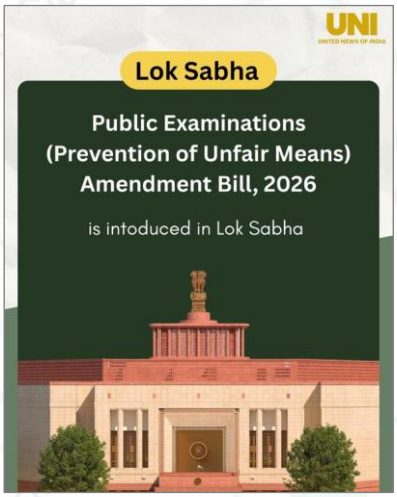
- The Centre will provide financial assistance of up to ₹1,000 crore for each chemical park, subject to a minimum contribution of ₹500 crore by the respective state government.
- The chemical parks will be developed by state governments through a challenge-based selection process, with each park requiring at least 2,000 acres (8 sq. km.) of contiguous, encumbrance-free land.





- The parks will feature plug-and-play infrastructure tailored to the needs of the chemical sector, including
- Common Effluent Treatment Plants (CETPs), Treatment, Storage and Disposal Facilities (TSDFs), water supply and distribution systems, solvent recovery and distillation facilities, steam generation and distribution networks, interconnected pipeline systems, and logistics and warehousing infrastructure.

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, was introduced in the Lok Sabha

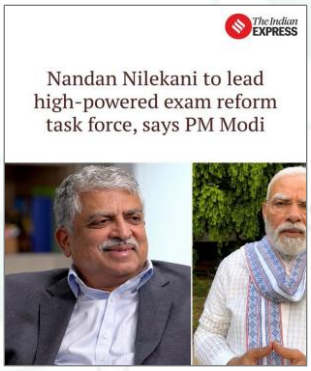


- The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, was introduced in the Lok Sabha .
- Minister of State for DoPT Jitendra Singh moved the Bill in the House.
- The Centre has also proposed empowering the Central Government to constitute a Special Task Force (STF) to investigate offences under the Act whenever required.

What does the Bill promise?

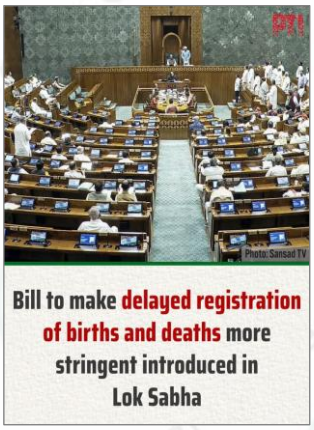
- In a substantial shift, the Bill proposes an increased jail term for **individuals** convicted under the Act. By which, the maximum imprisonment has been increased **from five to ten years.**
- To ensure the perpetrator is punished adequately, the fine amount has been enhanced to **₹50 lakh from ₹10 lakh.**
- The Bill proposes an **increased jail term to five years** from the earlier three years to directors, senior management personnel and officials colluded in the paper leak activity.
- Additionally, the Bill prescribes a maximum imprisonment for **organised offences to seven years from the earlier five years.** Also, the fine penalty has been raised to ₹10 crore from ₹1 crore.
- The amendment proposes the formation of Special Fast Track Courts across States and Union Territories for quick delivery of verdict.
- The Bill stipulates that the court sessions must **conduct hearings on a daily basis and finish trials within three months** of filing the charge sheet.
- To ensure the speedy prosecution, the Bill has moved the demand for State and Union Government **to appoint one or more special public prosecutors.**
- The Bill, pressing the need for a sturdy appellate mechanism, has proposed two judges of High Court would hear appeals against court judgments of Fast Track Courts.

Nandan Nilekani to Lead Exam Reforms Task Force



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the constitution of a high-powered task force, to be headed by former UIDAI chairman **Nandan Nilekani**, to recommend steps to make the country's examination system leak-proof and technology-driven.
- Mr. Nilekani has worked with the Union Government in the past to set up the Aadhaar ecosystem and Unified Payments Interface (UPI).
- He is also the chairman of the governing body of the economic policy research think tank, the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER), and a co-founder of Infosys.

Union Minister Nityanand Rai introduces Registration of Births and Deaths Amendment Bill in Lok Sabha



- Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai introduced the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha.
- The Bill seeks to amend the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969.
- The Bill provides that if a birth or death is reported to the Registrar more than one year but within two years after its occurrence, it may be registered only with the approval of the District Magistrate, Sub-Divisional Magistrate or an Executive Magistrate authorised by the District Magistrate, following verification of the authenticity of the birth or death.
- The Bill further states that if a birth or death is reported to the Registrar after more

than two years, it will be registered only on the order of a Judicial Magistrate of the First Class.

- As per the existing Act, registration of births and deaths is mandatory, and the certificate issued under the Act provides legal identity to an individual.
- The new Bill has been brought to make provisions for delayed registration more stringent and to encourage timely reporting of births and deaths.

PM Modi to Launch 'Nasha Mukt Yuva for Viksit Bharat' Campaign on August 2

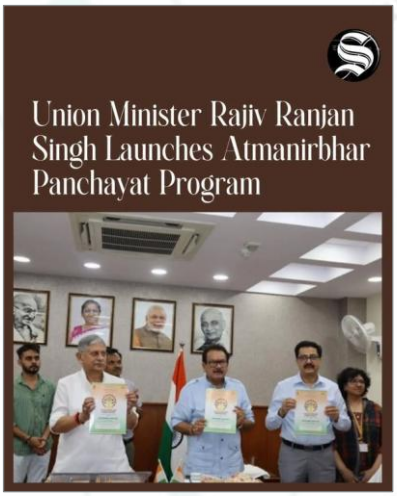


- Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya announced that a **nationwide 100-week campaign to raise awareness against Drugs** will be launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on August 2.
- 'Nasha Mukta Yuva for Viksit Bharat Sankalp Abhiyaan' will rely on walkathons, sports activities, meditation sessions, street plays, and art competitions every Sunday to drive home the message of drug-free society.
- This campaign will be led by MY Bharat youth, with the objective of uniting young people across the country in a collective national mission against substance abuse

Centre orders sugar dealers to limit stocks to 30 days, 4,000 quintals

- The Central Government imposed stockholding limits on sugar dealers across India from 1 August to 30 November 2026.
- The order was issued to regulate sugar availability, control hoarding, and restrict speculative trading during a period of rising retail and ex-mill prices.
- The Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution issued the measure .
- Under the order, no sugar dealer can hold sugar for more than 30 days from the date of receipt.
- A dealer also cannot keep more than 4,000 quintals, or 400 tonnes, of sugar at any point in time.
- All sugar dealers must declare their stocks and update inventory details weekly on the Department of Food and Public Distribution portal.
- The restrictions were imposed under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, and the Sugar (Control) Order, 2025.
- The Essential Commodities Act, 1955, empowers the Union Government to regulate the production, supply, distribution, and trade of essential goods.

Atmanirbhar Panchayat Program



- Recently, the Union Minister of Panchayati Raj launched the **Atmanirbhar Panchayat Programme and the SAMARTH Panchayat Portal.**

Atmanirbhar Panchayat Program

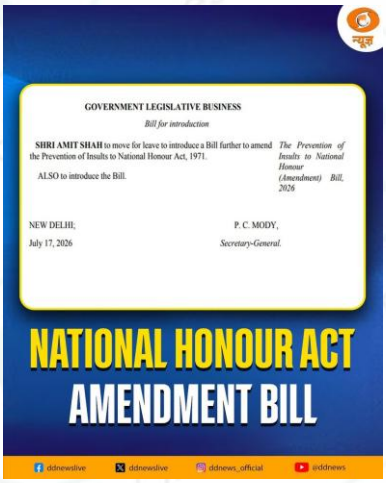
- It is a unique initiative of the Ministry of Panchayati Raj.
- It enables Gram Panchayats and Block Panchayats to identify local assets and opportunities and develop them, with dedicated technical support from the Ministry, into bankable, revenue-generating projects that build sustainable Own Source of Revenue (OSR).
- **Financing:** It is facilitated through Public Private Partnerships, Corporate Social Responsibility contributions, convergence with other schemes and bank finance, with NABARD and HUDCO as institutional partners.
- Target: A total of 350 projects are to be developed over four years, comprising 50 projects in the first year and 100 in each of the following three years.

- **Eligibility:** Gram Panchayats with a minimum OSR of Rs. 50 lakh and Block Panchayats with a minimum OSR of Rs. 1 crore, each with at least three years of tenure remaining, are eligible to apply, with relaxed thresholds for special category States.

What is the **SAMARTH Portal?**

- It is a first-of-its-kind digital initiative of the Ministry of Panchayati Raj designed to strengthen the financial capacity of Gram Panchayats through technology-enabled management of OSR.
- It is developed as a unified, configurable national platform which enables Gram Panchayats to digitally manage the complete OSR lifecycle, from taxpayer registration and demand generation to online payments, collection and real-time monitoring.
- Chhattisgarh and Himachal Pradesh have already been onboarded on the portal.

National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026



- The Rajya Sabha introduced the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which seeks to extend **statutory protection to Vande Mataram, the National Song**, by amending the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971.
- The Act currently criminalises insults to the **National Flag, the Constitution and the National Anthem.**
- The Bill seeks to amend Section 3 of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, which currently penalises anyone who intentionally prevents the singing of the National Anthem (Jana Gana Mana) or causes disturbance to an assembly engaged in its singing.
- The amendment extends the same protection to Vande Mataram.
- If passed, intentionally preventing the singing of the National Song or disrupting a gathering engaged in its rendition would become a criminal offence punishable with up to three years' imprisonment, a fine, or both. Repeat offenders would face a minimum prison term of one year, as is currently the case for offences relating to the National Anthem.
- Vande Mataram was written by the Bengali writer Bankimchandra Chattopadhyay in 1882. The song, particularly its first two stanzas, became a powerful symbol of anti-colonial nationalism, particularly during the Swadeshi movement following the partition of Bengal in 1905.
- On January 24, 1950, Rajendra Prasad announced that Jana Gana Mana would be the National Anthem and that Vande Mataram would be honoured equally because of its role in the freedom struggle.
- The distinction continued after Independence. Article 51A(a) of the Constitution requires citizens to respect the National Flag and National Anthem but does not mention the National Song.

The FCRA Bill 2026, A Threat To Civil Society Organisations

- The government listed the **Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026** for consideration during Parliament's Monsoon Session.
- The Bill proposes a centralized mechanism to take over, manage, and dispose of assets of civil society organizations whose **FCRA** registrations are cancelled, surrendered, or not renewed
- The Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 amends the statutory framework governing how non-governmental organizations (NGOs), trusts, and cultural bodies receive and manage foreign grants.
- While the original 1976 and 2010 Acts primarily aimed to prevent foreign financial influence in Indian politics and public service, the 2026 Bill focuses on the post-license lifecycle of assets.

Key Features of the FCRA Bill 2026:

- An FCRA registration certificate is deemed to have ceased if it is explicitly cancelled by the government, surrendered by the organization, denied renewal, or if no renewal application is submitted before its five-year expiry.
- Establishes a centralized Designated Authority in which all foreign contributions and physical assets created fully or partially out of foreign funds permanently vest upon license cessation.
- Permanently vested assets can be transferred to government ministries/agencies or auctioned, with all sale proceeds and unutilized foreign funds credited directly to the Consolidated Fund of India (CFI).
- Where vested assets include a place of worship, the Designated Authority must entrust its management to a prescribed entity while maintaining its distinct religious character.
- Statutory liability for organizational violations is placed on key functionaries (directors, trustees, partners, committee members), requiring them to prove due diligence to avoid prosecution.
- Reduces the maximum prison sentence for statutory violations from five years to one year while mandating prior central government approval before initiating criminal investigations.

The Ministry of Panchayati Raj launched the DAANVEER initiative



- It is a citizen participation initiative that enables individuals and organisations to voluntarily contribute computers to gram panchayats.
- It is done through the 'Meri Panchayat' mobile application to strengthen digital infrastructure at the grassroots.
- It is an initiative of the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, it has been developed in collaboration with the National Informatics Centre (NIC) and DigiHaat.
- It provides an end-to-end digital and verifiable mechanism through which citizens and organisations can contribute towards the technology and infrastructure needs of gram panchayats.
- The initiative is available through the Meri Panchayat app, which is integrated with the DigiHaat marketplace.

Union Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia launches theme for 10th India Mobile Congress 2026



- Shri Jyotiraditya M. Scindia, Union Minister for Communications and Development of North Eastern Region, unveiled "**Scale without boundaries**" as the theme for the **10th edition of India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026.**
- The Asia's largest digital technology forum is scheduled to be held from October 7–10, 2026, at Yashobhoomi (India International Convention & Expo Centre), New Delhi.

  The 10th edition of India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026 is anchored around four key pillars that reflect India's vision of building a digitally empowered, secure and growth-oriented future:-
- **Srishti** – Building the Future, which will focus on fostering innovation, emerging technologies and solutions that shape the next generation of digital infrastructure.
- **Suraksha** – Strengthening Trust, which will underscore the importance of secure, resilient and trusted digital ecosystems.
- **Sashakt** – Expanding Opportunities, aimed at leveraging technology to empower citizens, businesses, startups and communities while ensuring inclusive access to digital opportunities.
- **Samvardhan** – Fueling Growth, which will highlight the role of digital technologies in driving economic growth, investment, entrepreneurship, job creation and India's emergence as a global technology leader.

BJP to launch nationwide Shri Guru Ravidas Maharaj Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan

- The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) will launch its nationwide '**Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan**' to commemorate the 650th birth anniversary of Sant Guru Ravidas Maharaj, with a series of programmes aimed at promoting his message of equality, dignity, social harmony and social justice.
- The campaign, to be observed until February 20 (Magha Purnima) under the guidance of the BJP's national leadership, will be organised across the country, including Punjab.

As part of the campaign, the Shri Guru Ravidas Maharaj Kalash Vandan Abhiyan will be held from July 29 to September 10.

- Under the initiative, a sacred Kalash carrying holy soil from Guru Ravidas's birthplace at Seer Govardhanpur in Varanasi will be ceremonially received and taken across Punjab before being presented to Guru Ravidas temples.
- The campaign will also include the Sant Sampark Abhiyan, which will continue until August 31, during which BJP leaders and workers will visit saints associated with the Guru Ravidas tradition to seek their blessings.

NAKSHA Project

- The Directorate of Settlement and Land Records (DSLR) prepares to launch its month-long inquiry under the NAKSHA pilot program in Margao and Cuncolim and Panaji city.
- NAKSHA (National Geospatial Knowledge-based Land Survey of Urban Habitations) is a modern, GIS-based urban land parcel mapping initiative.
- It aims to revolutionize urban land records across Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) in States and Union Territories.
- The program operates under the broader framework of the Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme (DILRMP).
- NAKSHA specifically leverages cutting-edge technology to create highly accurate digital maps for complex urban and peri-urban habitations across multiple states and Union Territories, ensuring our cities are future-ready.
- Implemented by: The initiative is being implemented with the technical support of Survey of India, National Informatics Centre Services Inc. (NICSI).
- Nodal Ministry: It was launched by the Department of Land Resources (DoLR), Ministry of Rural Development.

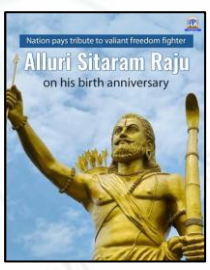
Eminent Personalities In News

PM Modi pays tribute to Swami Vivekananda on his death anniversary



- Swami Vivekananda passed away on July 4, 1902, at the age of 39.
- He was born as Narendranath Datta on January 12, 1863, in Kolkata.
- Swami Vivekananda's life changed significantly when he met his spiritual mentor, Ramakrishna Paramahamsa, in 1881.
- He founded Ramakrishna Mission, In 1897
- The headquarters Ramakrishna Mission is located in Belur, in the Howrah district of West Bengal, India.
- Swami Vivekananda is best known for his address at the Parliament of the World's Religions in Chicago in 1893, where he introduced Hindu philosophy to the Western world.
- Neo-Vedanta: Combined Vedantic thoughts with nationalism. This school maintains that different schools of Vedanta are all different interpretations of a single truth.

Defence Minister pays tribute to Alluri Sitaram Raju on his birth anniversary



- Alluri Sitarama Raju was born on July 4, 1897, in the village of Mogallu, near Bhimavaram in present-day Andhra Pradesh

- The Rampa Rebellion (1922-1924) was the most significant movement led by Alluri Sitarama Raju.
- It was primarily a revolt of the tribal communities against the enforcement of the Madras Forest Act of 1882.
- the British authorities placed a bounty of Rs. 10,000 for Raju's capture, dead or alive.
- **On May 7, 1924, he was deceitfully captured, tied to a tree, and executed.**

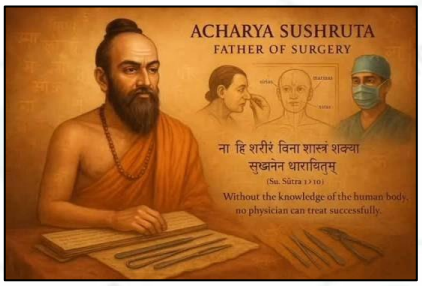
Nation pays tribute to Captain Vikram Batra on his martyrdom day



- Marking his supreme sacrifice during the 7th July, 1999 during Kargil War.
- Captain Batra was awarded the Param Vir Chakra Posthumously on 15th August, 1999 - India's highest military decoration
- On July 26, 1999, the Indian Army announced the successful culmination of "Operation Vijay", declaring victory after a nearly three-month-long battle on the icy heights of Kargil in Ladakh.
- The Indian Army, since then, commemorates July 26 as Kargil Vijay Diwas

Sushruta Jayanti

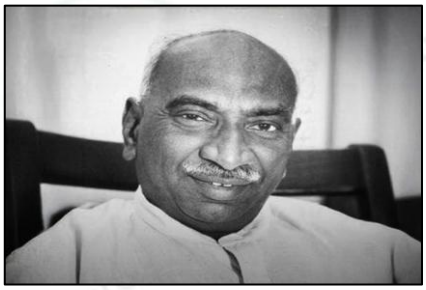
- Sushruta Jayanti 2026 falls on July 15, honoring the legendary Acharya Sushruta, revered globally as the Father of Surgery
- He was an ancient Indian surgeon from Kashi (around 7th century BC) and is the author of 'Sushruta Samhita', a comprehensive textbook on medicine and surgery.



The Sushruta Samhita is organized into five major sections:

- **Sutrasthana: Primary principles dealing with basic principles of medical sciences and pharmacology;**
- **Nidana: It deals with pathological concepts;**
- **Sarirasthana: On human anatomy;**
- **Chikitsasthanam: On medical and surgical management;**
- **Kalpasthanam: On toxicology.**

PM Modi pays homage to freedom fighter Thiru K Kamaraj on his birth anniversary



- Popularly known as Kamarajar (15 July 1903 – 2 October 1975)
- Widely acknowledged as the "Kingmaker" in Indian politics
- **President of Indian National Congress (INC) from 1964 to 1967**
- He was the founder and the president of the Indian National Congress (Organisation)
- Served as the Chief Minister of Madras State (Tamil Nadu) in 1954.
- Awarded with India's highest civilian honour, the Bharat Ratna, posthumously in 1976.
- In 1963, he suggested to Jawaharlal Nehru, India's first Prime Minister, that senior Congress leaders should leave ministerial posts to take up organisational work. This suggestion came to be known as the 'Kamaraj Plan'.

Mangal Pandey birth anniversary



- He was born on 19th July, 1827, in a town near Faizabad, what is now eastern Uttar Pradesh.
- He joined the 34th Bengal Native Infantry of the British East India Company.
- He revolted against the East India Company for introducing cartridges that were greased with animal fat as it hurt the religious sentiments of the soldiers.

▪ Eventually, this movement of rebels reached other parts of India and which led to a mass revolt against the government.

▪ The movement of protest and rebellion came to be known as the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857, also known as the First War of Independence.

▪ On 29th March, 1857, Pandey and his fellow sepoys rose up in rebellion against the British officers and even attempted to shoot them. As a result of this, he was executed on 8th April, 1857, in Barrackpore.

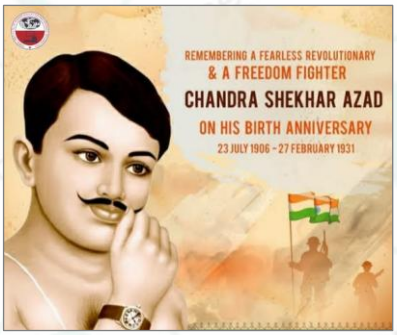
▪ **In October 1984, as a tribute to his efforts, the Government of India issued a postage stamp with his image.**

HM Amit Shah & Defence Minister Rajnath Singh pay tribute to freedom fighter Batukeshwar Dutt on his death anniversary



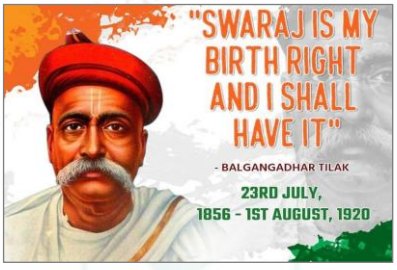
- July 20 marks the death anniversary of **Batukeshwar Dutt,**
- Batukeshwar Dutt, a brave revolutionary who fought alongside Bhagat Singh
- Batukeshwar Dutt was a freedom fighter and was born on 18th November 1910 in Khandaghosh village, Burdwan district, West Bengal.
- He met Bhagat Singh, who inspired him to join the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA), and he also became an active member of the Naujawan Bharat Sabha.
- On 8th April 1929, Dutt and Bhagat Singh threw two homemade bombs into the empty space of the Central Legislative Assembly
- They raised slogans like Inquilab Zindabad, distributed leaflets stating if the deaf are to hear, the sound has to be very loud, and surrendered willingly to draw nationwide attention.

Chandra Shekhar Azad birth anniversary



- Chandra Shekhar Azad was **born on 23rd July 1906** in the **Alirajpur district of Madhya Pradesh.**
- Chandra Shekhar, then a **15-year-old student**, **joined a Non-Cooperation Movement in December 1921.**
- After being arrested, he famously declared his name as "Azad" (Free) in court — a name he lived by till his death.
- He became a **leading member of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)** and worked alongside revolutionaries like Bhagat Singh and Rajguru.
- Azad was involved in several acts of resistance, including the **Kakori Train Robbery (1925)** and the **shooting of J.P. Saunders (1928)** to avenge Lala Lajpat Rai's death.
- Surrounded by police in **Alfred Park (now Azad Park), Allahabad in 1931**, he chose to shoot himself with his last bullet rather than be captured alive.

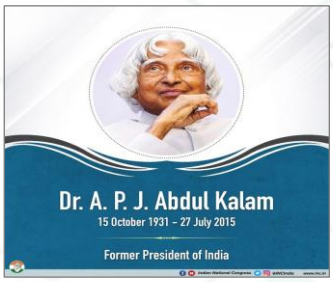
Lokmanya Tilak birth anniversary



- **Birth:** He was **born on 23rd July 1856 in Ratnagiri, Maharashtra.**
- Freedom fighter and lawyer, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, is also known as **Lokmanya Tilak.**
- **Founder of the Deccan Education Society (1884)** along with his associate Gopal Ganesh Agarkar and others.
- **Slogan: "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it!"**
- A book **'Indian Unrest' written by Valentine Chirol,** an English journalist, **stated Tilak the 'father of Indian unrest'.**
- Emphasised the importance of a cultural and religious revival to go with the political movements.
- **Popularised the Ganesh Chaturthi festival** in the Maharashtra region.

- **Propounded the celebration of Shiv Jayanti** on the birth anniversary of the monarch Chhatrapati Shivaji.
- Along with **Lala Lajpat Rai and Bipin Chandra Pal,** he was part of the **Lal-Bal-Pal trio** of leaders with extremist outlooks.
- **All India Home Rule League:** Founded by Tilak in April 1916 at Belgaum
- **Newspapers:** Weeklies Kesari (Marathi) and Mahratta (English)
- **Books:** Gita Rhasya and Arctic Home of the Vedas.
- **Death:** He died on 1st August 1920.

27 July - APJ Abdul Kalam's Death Anniversary



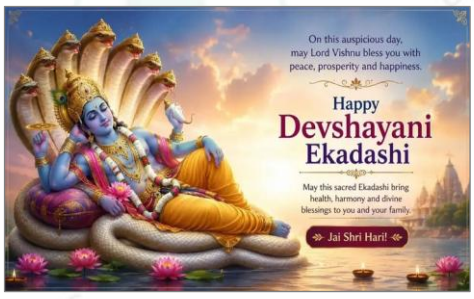
- **Born on 15th October 1931** at Rameswaram in Tamil Nadu.
- His **birth anniversary is celebrated** as the **National Innovation Day** and **World Students' Day.**
- He was sworn in as **India's 11th President in 2002** and completed the full term in 2007.
- **Awards Received:**
  - He was awarded the coveted civilian awards - **Padma Bhushan (1981)** and **Padma Vibhushan (1990)** and the highest civilian award **Bharat Ratna (1997).**
- **Death: 27th July 2015 at Shillong, Meghalaya.**
- Dr. Kalam also played an **instrumental role in developing missiles like Agni and Prithvi under the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme (IGMDP) of which he was the chief executive.**
- Kalam is also credited with playing a **major role in the Pokhran-II nuclear tests**
- **Chief Scientific Adviser to the Prime Minister** and Secretary of the Defence Research and Development Organisation from **July 1992 to December 1999**

Contributions to ISRO:

- Dr. Kalam was also the **project director of India's first Satellite Launch Vehicle (SLV-III)** which successfully deployed the Rohini satellite in near-earth orbit.
- Kalam has also played a **contributory role** in the **development of Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV).**
- He authored many books like **India 2020: A Vision for the New Millennium, Wings of Fire, Ignited Minds: Unleashing the Power within India, Transcendence: My Spiritual Experiences with Pramukh Swamiji, A Manifesto for Change: A Sequel to India 2020**.

National/International Festivals

Occasion of Devshayani Ashadhi Ekadashi



- Ashadhi Ekadashi, also known as Devshayani Ekadashi or Hari Shayani Ekadashi, is being observed according to Drik Panchang, the Ekadashi tithi began on July 25 and will conclude on July 26.
- The festival marks the beginning of Chaturmas, a four-month period regarded as highly sacred in Hindu tradition.
- The Sanskrit word Devshayani means "when the deity goes to sleep," symbolising the beginning of Lord Vishnu's divine rest
- According to ancient Hindu scriptures, including the Bhavishya Purana and the Padma Purana, Lord Vishnu enters Yoga Nidra, or divine sleep, on this day and is believed to awaken on Prabodhini Ekadashi, observed later in the year.

State

Ladakh

India Commissions First Geothermal Wells at Puga Valley



- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor officially commissioned India's first and deepest twin geothermal wells at Puga Valley in eastern Ladakh.
- situated at an extreme altitude of over 14,000 feet
- Executed by the ONGC Energy Centre, these 1,000-meter-deep wells will serve as the technical backbone for India's first 1 MW demonstration-scale geothermal power plant.
- The Puga Valley system is India's pioneer breakthrough into geothermal energy—the process of tapping clean, round-the-clock power from natural heat reservoirs trapped beneath the Earth's crust.

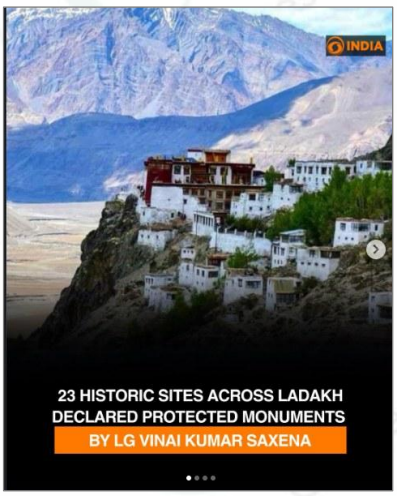
How Geothermal Wells Are Formed?

- Tectonic and Volcanic Heat Source: The Indian plate's ongoing collision with the Eurasian plate forms structural fractures, faults, and deep-seated magmatic activity along the Indus Suture Zone.
- This proximity brings internal mantle heat very close to the shallow crust.
- Deep Fluid Circulation: Meteoric water (melted snow and glaciers) seeps deep into these rock fractures, where it is superheated by the underlying hot rocks.
- High-Pressure Ascent: Because hot water is less dense, it is driven back upward toward the surface under high pressure, trapping superheated fluids and steam inside permeable deep reservoirs or erupting at the surface as natural hot springs and sulfur fumaroles.

The Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council (LAHDC) Act

- The Ladakh administration created 17 new tehsils, raising the Union Territory's total to 32, and plans to extend the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council (LAHDC) Act benefits to all seven newly designated districts through suitable legal provisions.
- The Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils Act, 1997 (Act No. XXXI of 1997) is a comprehensive piece of legislation enacted to provide for the establishment of Autonomous Hill Development Councils and an Inter-District Advisory Council in the Ladakh region.
- The Act originally extended to the whole of the Leh and Kargil districts.
- Aim: The foundational objective of the Act is to empower local populations in the high-altitude region through decentralized governance.

Ladakh Declares 23 Heritage Sites as Protected Monuments



- The Ladakh administration declared 23 heritage sites across the Union Territory as Protected Monuments under the Jammu and Kashmir Ancient Monuments Preservation Act.
- The list includes petroglyph clusters, rock carvings, ancient caves, monasteries, forts, palaces, and inscriptions from different parts of Ladakh.
- A protected monument is a site, structure, or object that receives legal protection under a heritage law for preservation and regulated conservation.
- In India, such protection is used for monuments of archaeological, historical, or artistic value, and it can restrict construction, encroachment, and unauthorised alteration in the notified area.
- Specific sites in the list include the Petroglyph Site at Sharnos, the Maitreya

Buddha Rock Carving at Shey near Sindhu Ghat, Tingmosgang Fort, Ancient Caves at Saspol, Stongday Gonpa, Sumoor Fort, and rock inscriptions at Yourbaltak in Kargil.

Jammu & Kashmir

Kathua Railway Station renamed as Martyr Captain Sunil Kumar Choudhary Kathua Station



- The Northern Railway has officially renamed Kathua Railway Station in the Jammu Division as "Martyr Captain Sunil Kumar Choudhary Kathua" Railway Station with immediate effect.
- The station's new alpha code will be MSKT, replacing KTHU,
- The station will appear as "MC Sunil Kathua" in the Unreserved Ticketing System and Passenger Reservation System.

Kwar Hydroelectric Project

- The heavy rainfall triggered a major landslide near the under-construction 540 MW Kwar Hydroelectric Power Project in the Kishtwar district of Jammu and Kashmir recently.
- It is a 540 MW hydropower project located on the Chenab River in the Kishtwar district of Jammu and Kashmir.
- The project is envisaged as a Run of River Scheme.
- The project is being developed by Chenab Valley Power Projects Private Ltd. (CVPPL).
- CVPPL is a joint venture company between NHPC Ltd and Jammu & Kashmir State Power Development Corporation (JKSPDC) with equity contributions of 51 percent and 49 percent, respectively.

Himachal Pradesh

ICMR to Set Up India's First High-Altitude Medicine Centre

- The Indian Council of Medical Research is establishing India's first dedicated centre for high-altitude medicine and public health research in Himachal Pradesh.
- The ICMR Centre for High Altitude Medicine and Public Health Research will come up at Keylong in the Lahaul and Spiti district and will upgrade the existing ICMR field station into a multidisciplinary research hub.
- Keylong is the headquarters of Lahaul and Spiti district in Himachal Pradesh and lies at high altitude in the western Himalayas.

Eight Traditional Himachal Products Secure GI Tags

- Eight traditional products of social, economic, cultural and agricultural significance of Himachal Pradesh have been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) status.
- The fresh registrations have taken products from Himachal Pradesh that now enjoy the GI Tag to 17.

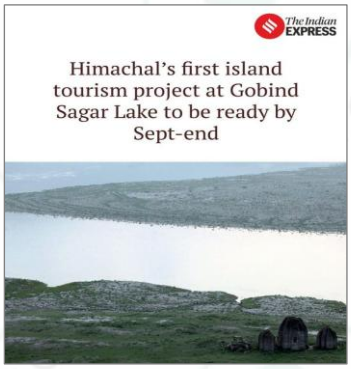


This eight newly recognized products are,

- Spiti Seabuckthorn (Chharma)
- Salooni Safed Makka (White Maize)
- Chamba Metal Art
- Sirmauri Loiya (traditional woollen garment)
- Kinnauri Topi
- Sepuvadi of Mandi
- Kinnauri Apple
- Kinnauri Jewellery

▪ The state government is further pursuing GI registration for four indigenous products – Bhot Jau (barley from the Pangi region of Chamba), Chamba Chukh, Plectranthus honey (from the Bharmour region of Chamba) and Sirmaur ginger.

Himachal's first island tourism project at Gobind Sagar Lake to be ready by Sept-end



- Bilaspur to emerge as a major destination for eco-tourism, water sports, aero sports and adventure tourism as the Himachal Pradesh's first-ever Island Tourism Project at Jeori Pattan in Govind Sagar Lake, Bilaspur, is set to be opened to tourists within a month.
- The major islands of Govind Sagar Lake—Jeori Pattan, Dhararsani and Bholu—are being developed on the lines of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
- Bilaspur, which is home to the Gobind Sagar, is created by the huge hydel dam at Bhakra's vast reservoir stretching over 90km and covering an area of approximately 170 square km.

Gobind Sagar Lake:

- It is a manmade reservoir located in the Una and Bilaspur districts of Himachal Pradesh.
- It is named in honour of Guru Gobind Singh, the tenth Sikh Guru.
- Its source is the Bhakra Dam on the Sutlej River.
- One of the world's highest gravity dams, the Bhakra dam is perched at an elevation of 225.5 m above its lowest foundations.
- It helps in supplying water for irrigation to the states of Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, and Rajasthan, significantly benefiting agriculture in the region.
- In 1962, the lake was recognized as the 'waterfowl refuge.'

Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand Becomes India's Sixth Fully Literate State



▪ Uttarakhand has achieved a historic milestone in the field of education by becoming the sixth fully literate state in India under the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and the ULLAS (Understanding of Lifelong Learning for All in Society) – New India Literacy Programme.

▪ Before Uttarakhand, five states–Mizoram, Goa, Tripura, Himachal Pradesh and Sikkim–had attained the status of fully literate states.

Uttarakhand to Implement New Madrasa Education Framework



▪ A major change in Uttarakhand's madrasa education system will come into effect.

▪ Under the new arrangement, the Uttarakhand Madrasa Education Board will be abolished, and all minority educational institutions in the state will be governed under a new framework.

▪ From July 1, the Uttarakhand Madrasa Education Board, the Uttarakhand Madrasa Education Board Act, 2016, and the Uttarakhand Non-Government Arabic and Persian Madrasa Recognition Rules, 2019 will cease to have effect.

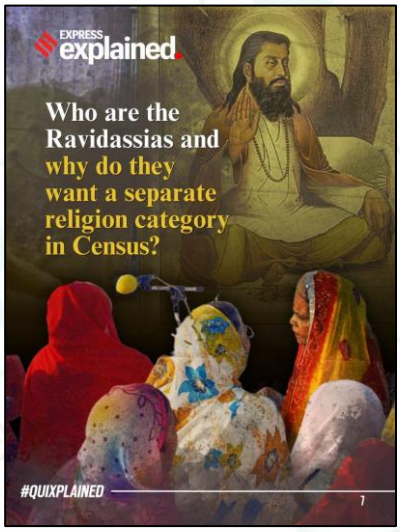
▪ The state government has introduced a new system under the Uttarakhand Minority Educational Institutions Act.

▪ Under the new framework, the Uttarakhand State Minority Education Authority will be responsible for granting recognition to minority educational institutions, monitoring their functioning, and ensuring academic quality.

▪ The new system will cover educational institutions of the Muslim, Sikh, Jain, Christian, Buddhist, and Parsi communities. All institutions will be required to comply with the prescribed standards and obtain recognition from the Authority.

▪ According to the state government, the new framework aims to ensure transparency, quality education, and equal opportunities across minority educational institutions.

Punjab



Ravidassia community demand for the creation of a separate "Ravidassia religion"

▪ Recently, members of the Ravidassia community gathered in Punjab to renew calls for a longstanding demand for the creation of a separate "Ravidassia religion" category in the Census.

▪ The Ravidassias are a Dalit community which follows a spiritual path based on the teachings of Shri Guru Ravidas.

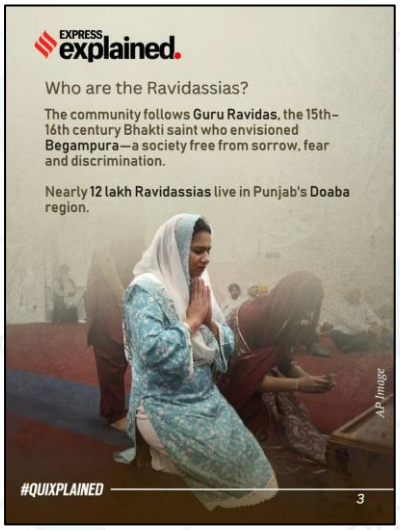
▪ They live in the Doaba region of Punjab, which includes districts such as Kapurthala, Hoshiarpur, Nawanshar and Jalandhar.

Key Features of Ravidassias Community

▪ **Holy Book: The Ravidassia community adopted the Amrit Bani of Guru Ravidas as its holy book which contains 200 hymns of Guru Ravidas.**

▪ Concept of Begampura: It is an ideal concept given by Guru Ravidas which explains a city without sorrow, fear, or inequality.

▪ Sacred Site: Seer Goverdhanpur in Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)is one of the most important pilgrimage locations of the Ravidassia tradition.



Who was Guru Ravidas?

▪ Guru Ravidas (1377-1527 C.E.) was a renowned saint known for his contributions to the Bhakti movement.

▪ Guru Ravidas is also known as Raidas, Rohidas, and Ruhidas.

▪ Ravidas is traditionally seen as a student of the bhakti-poet Ramananda.

▪ The core of Guru Ravidas's philosophy was the rejection of the caste system and the promotion of human rights and dignity.

▪ He abandoned the saguna (with attributes, image) forms of supreme beings and focussed on the nirguna (without attributes, abstract) form of supreme beings

Haryana

PM Modi Inaugurates India's First Hydrogen Train on Jind-Sonipat Route



▪ Prime Minister Narendra Modi flagged off India's first hydrogen-powered train between Jind and Sonipat at Jind railway station in Haryana.

▪ Powered by hydrogen fuel cell technology instead of diesel engines, covering a distance of around 90 kilometres

▪ With an operational speed of 75 kilometer per hour on the Jind-Sonipat section and a design speed of 110 kilometer per hour,

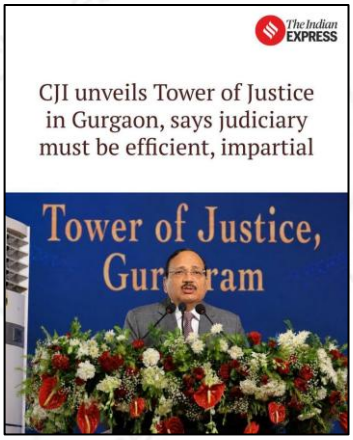
▪ With the introduction of Hydrogen- powered train, India has joined the select group of countries that have operational hydrogen-powered trains.

▪ These include Germany, Japan, China and the United States.

▪ **Green Hydrogen: A zero-emission fuel created by splitting water into hydrogen and oxygen using renewable electricity, such as solar or wind.**

▪ "Hydrogen for Heritage" Project: A 2023 Indian Railways initiative to deploy 35 hydrogen trains on ecologically sensitive and scenic routes (costing ₹80 crores per train and ₹70 crores per route).

CJI Surya Kant inaugurates Gurugram's 'Tower of Justice'.



▪ The Chief Justice of India, Surya Kant, inaugurated the "Tower of Justice" in Gurugram, a new judicial complex with 56 courtrooms and digital infrastructure.

▪ The complex replaces the nearly five-decade-old district court infrastructure and is expected to enhance judicial capacity.

▪ The construction of judicial complexes equipped with state-of-the-art facilities is a clear reflection of the Haryana government's sensitivity and commitment towards strengthening the justice delivery system.

Sirsa Kinnow gets a GI tag.



▪ Sirsa's kinnow recently received its Geographical Indication (GI) tag, with the Registry in Chennai sealing the certificate of registration.

▪ It is a variety of Kinnow grown in the Sirsa district of Haryana.

▪ It is Haryana's first fruit to receive a Geographical Indication (GI) tag.

▪ Kinnow is a hybrid citrus fruit.

▪ It is a hybrid between two citrus cultivars, namely 'King' (Citrus nobilis) and 'Willow Leaf' mandarin (Citrus deliciosa).

▪ The hybrid was developed in 1915 by HB Frost at the University of California Citrus Experimentation Station.

▪ It is round, large, and has golden-orange skin similar to an orange.

▪ It has a sweet and sour taste.

▪ It comprises a high amount of juice content, making it ideal for extracting juice and pulp.

▪ It is a rich source of Vitamin C and minerals like calcium and potassium, which are beneficial for health.

▪ It contains 0.2 to 0.3% pectin, which is anti-cancerous and also helps in lowering cholesterol.

▪ The peel of the Kinnow fruit contains oil which is used in cosmetics.

▪ It is a largely cultivated fruit of North India, and Punjab holds the major share of the Kinnow-producing area of the country, with other states including Rajasthan, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu, and Kashmir.

▪ It is popularly known as the "king of fruits" in Punjab.

▪ It has the ability to withstand soaring temperatures as high as 40°C during summer and 0°C during winter.

Delhi

Delhi Launches Delhi Next Civic-Tech Innovation Programme

▪ Delhi launched the 'Delhi Next – Code, Create and Change' programme on 2 July 2026 as a civic-tech innovation initiative for government departments in the National Capital Territory of Delhi.

▪ The programme plans to pilot 60 projects for urban problem-solving through technology-based solutions.

AI Holobox of former PM Atal Bihari Vajpayee inaugurated at PM Sangrahalaya

- The AI Holobox of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee was inaugurated at the Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya in New Delhi.
- The installation uses a hyper-realistic 3D avatar and interactive dialogue features to present factual material on Vajpayee's life, public career, and political legacy.

- The AI Holobox allows visitors to ask questions and receive responses based on historical research and documented writings. Similar interactive AI avatars at the museum include Mahatma Gandhi, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, and Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.
- The Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya is a museum dedicated to the Prime Ministers of India. It is located in New Delhi and includes digital and interactive exhibits on national leadership and governance.

Prakriti Café inaugurated in national capital to promote healthy dietary practices



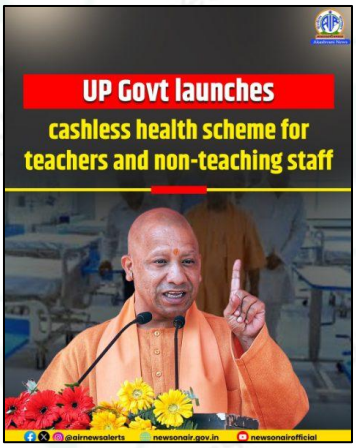
- Ayush Minister Prataprao Jadhav inaugurated Prakriti Café at Ayush Bhawan in New Delhi, a first-of-its-kind workplace initiative of the Ministry aimed at promoting healthy dietary practices inspired by Ayush Ahaar.
- The café offers a range of fresh and wholesome food options based on the principles of the Ayush Ahaar initiative.

Uttar Pradesh

Cabinet Approves two Elevated Corridors to Decongest Varanasi

- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved two major elevated corridor projects worth over ₹25,445 crore to ease traffic congestion, improve connectivity and strengthen multimodal transport infrastructure in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh.
- The projects include a 43.218-km Varuna River Elevated Corridor connecting NH-31 and the Varanasi Ring Road, and a 46.039-km Ganga River Elevated Corridor linking NH-19 with the Varanasi Ring Road.
- Both projects will be executed by the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) under the Hybrid Annuity Model (HAM).

UP Govt launches cashless health scheme for teachers and non-teaching staff



- Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched the 'Chief Minister's Teachers' Cashless Medical Scheme' from Varanasi, which will offer medical coverage of up to 5 lakh rupees to more than 15 lakh teaching staff.
- Under the scheme, teachers across the state and their families will gain access to cashless medical facilities worth up to 5 lakh rupees.
- The scheme will also benefit Shiksha Mitras (para-teachers), instructors, cooks, and eligible staff of Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas.
- An MoU was also signed with the State Bank of India to provide social security cover to the teachers and their families.
- Under the scheme, contractual employees drawing a monthly salary of more than rupees 10,000 will receive a personal accident insurance cover ranging from 30 lakh rupees to 80 lakh rupees.
- In cases of permanent disability, insurance benefits between 30 lakh rupees and 80 lakh rupees will be provided, while partial disability will be covered for 15 lakh rupees to 40 lakh rupees.
- The scheme also includes air accident insurance, along with add-on benefits to support the education of employees' children and the marriage of daughters in the event of an unforeseen tragedy.

Varanasi Airport to Get Country's First Six-Lane Runway Underpass



- India's first six-lane underpass beneath an active runway is being constructed at the new terminal of Varanasi Airport.
- Spanning 450 metres, this engineering marvel represents next-generation infrastructure, allowing uninterrupted road traffic below while aircraft operations continue seamlessly above.

Uttar Pradesh Expands Free Residential Education Under JPNSV Scheme

- The Uttar Pradesh's Jay Prakash Narayan Sarvodaya Vidyalaya (JPNSV) schools offer free residential education, study material to socially, economically and educationally disadvantaged students of the state.
- It is a flagship initiative run by the UP government's Social Welfare department covering over 100 schools.
- Special coaching for students of Classes 11 and 12 preparing for competitive examinations like NEET, JEE and CUET are also offered.
- The main motive of the scheme is to provide free, residential education to talented students from poor and backward Classes, especially those belonging to Scheduled Caste (SC), Scheduled Tribe (ST), Other Backward Classes (OBC) in rural and urban areas of Uttar Pradesh.
- Students must be aged between 10 and 12 years for Class 6 and for other classes
- They must have passed Class 5 and hold a marksheet for the same. Students living in rural areas should not have an annual family income of more than Rs. 46,080.
- Annual family income for students living in urban areas should be up to Rs. 56,460 to be eligible for the scheme.

Garhwa Fort



- The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) recently arrested the last remaining absconding accused in the 2002 Garhwa Fort idol theft, dacoity and murder case.
- Garhwa Fort is a Hindu temple complex located in Garhwa Village in the Prayagraj District of Uttar Pradesh.
- The fort was built in the year 1750, but the temples within the fort complex could be more than 1000 years old before the fort was constructed.
- The temple is believed to be built by the Guptas.
- Seven inscriptions from the reigns of Chandra Gupta, Kumara Gupta, and Skanda Gupta have been found at this site.
- The fortifications around the temple were built in 1750 CE by the Baghel King Vikramaditya.
- The temple was built in the panchakona design.
- The Shiva Linga enshrined in the temple was stolen by the British.

Uttar Pradesh Launches Kaushal Setu and Kaushal Sarathi Portals



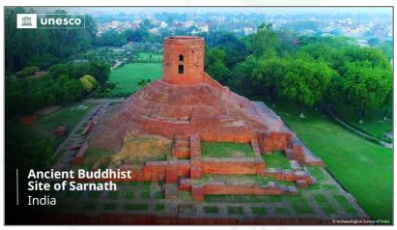
- Uttar Pradesh launched Kaushal Setu and Kaushal Sarathi in Lucknow during the state-level celebration of World Youth Skills Day-2026 at Indira Gandhi Pratishthan.
- Kaushal Setu is a digital portal of the Uttar Pradesh Skill Development Mission (UPSDM).
- It is designed for online, paperless, and transparent registration and empanelment of training partners.
- The portal is part of the state's skill development administration and uses digital processes for institutional onboarding.
- Kaushal Sarathi is a digital platform that provides district-wise information on training centres, courses, and training partners.
- It uses a digital map to help youth locate skill training facilities in their respective districts.
- The platform is linked to the skill development ecosystem of Uttar Pradesh.

28 years on tentative list, Sarnath now a UNESCO World Heritage Site



- Recently, the "Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath" got inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List.

- the 48th Session of the World Heritage Committee being held at Busan, South Korea,
- Last year, '**the Maratha Military Landscapes of India' were inscribed in the World Heritage List** at the 47th Session of the World Heritage Committee held at UNESCO Headquarters at Paris.
- With 45 sites in the List, India ranks 6th globally and 2nd in Asia Pacific Region for the most number of World Heritage Sites.
- India also has 69 sites in the Tentative List of the World Heritage, which is a mandatory threshold for any site to be considered as a World Heritage property in future.
- The ancient site of Sarnath was included in the Tentative List of World Heritage in 1998.



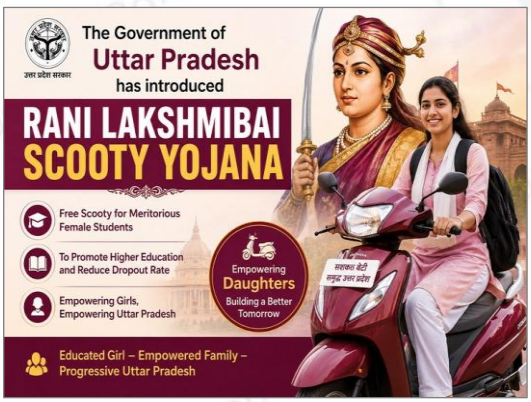
- **Location: It is located in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh.**
- It is counted among the holy pilgrimage sites of Buddhism.
- It is described in ancient Buddhist scriptures such as Rishipattan, Ishipatana, Mrigadava.
- It is now India's 45th and Uttar Pradesh's fourth World Heritage Site.
- It is the ancient sacred land where Lord Buddha, after attaining enlightenment, delivered his first sermon to humanity and set in motion the 'Dharmachakra Pravartan'.



- The inscribed serial property comprises two component parts – Chaukhandi Stupa and the Archaeological Remains of Sarnath (Dhamekh Stupa, Dharmrajika Stupa, Mulagandgakuti Vihara, Ashokan Pillar, etc.).
- In the historical period Sarnath was developed over centuries through royal, monastic and lay patronage.
- The site comprises an ensemble of ancient monuments constructed from the pre-Mauryan period (5th-4th centuries BCE to 3rd century BCE) up until the destruction of Sarnath in the 12th century CE.
- Sarnath has been one of the most extensively excavated sites by the Archaeological Survey of India which resulted in a stratified settlement spread across 16 centuries (5th-4th centuries BCE to 12th century CE).

The Government of Uttar Pradesh has introduced the Rani Lakshmibai Scooty Yojana.

- **Objective:** Boost female participation in higher education and reduce dropout rates.
- **Beneficiaries:** Meritorious female students selected from the **top 5% of graduates**.
- Under the scheme, the government will not only provide scooters but also their insurance, registration, helmets, essential accessories, and 4 litres of petrol.
- The income limit condition will be relaxed for disabled girl students, daughters of martyrs, and daughters from destitute families.



IIT Kanpur to Set Up Green Hydrogen CoE

- The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur will establish a Centre of Excellence (CoE) on Green Hydrogen under the Uttar Pradesh Green Hydrogen Policy 2024 to advance research and development in hydrogen energy generation.
- The proposal for the Centre of Excellence on Innovative and Integrated Ecosystem for Green Hydrogen (ECOGEN) has been approved by the Uttar Pradesh government and sanctioned by the Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency (UPNEDA).

'Bhadohi to be renamed Sant Ravidas Nagar': CM Yogi Adityanath

- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath announced that the **Bhadohi district would once again be renamed Sant Ravidas Nagar.**

- The move coincides with the 650th birth anniversary of Sant Guru Ravidas, which is celebrated on the Purnima Tithi of the Magha month (falling on 1st February 2026).
- Bhadohi was earlier part of the Varanasi district.
- The UP government had on December 6, 2014 announced that the Sant Ravidas Nagar district in the state would be renamed Bhadohi.

SHORT NEWS

▪ The Yogi Adityanath-led Uttar Pradesh government has announced that Jalalabad tehsil in Shahjahanpur will be renamed as Parshuram Puri.

Madhya Pradesh

Korku Tribe



▪ Recently, the indigenous Korku community of Madhya Pradesh have demanded the forest department and district administration to remove encroachments from forest lands.

▪ The Korkus belong to the Munda or Kolarian group.

▪ The Korku are mostly found in Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and adjoining Melghat region of Maharashtra.

▪ Language: A few groups have been more successful in preserving their language, especially the Potharia Korku (from the Vindhya mountains).

▪ Korku is one of the 196 languages termed endangered by UNESCO.

Culture and Society

▪ The traditional healing methods are still widely practiced by this tribe and they regard their dead as Gods.

▪ To commemorate the dead, they install a memorial pillar, which is called Munda.

▪ Dance: They perform a traditional Korku dance called Gadli.

▪ In this dance Men wear white costumes and pagdis, while womenfolk wear red, yellow, green and blue kinari sarees with minimal jewellery.

▪ The women also have an instrument called Chitkola that they use while performing.

▪ Korku women are fond of tattoos. The two dots above and below the letter S on the forehead are called 'Kapar-Godai'.

▪ **Economy: The Korku are primarily cultivators.**

▪ Self-Governance: The Korku tribe has a long-standing system of self-governance.

▪ **'Chavadi Swashasan' is the term for Korku's traditional form of self-governance.**

Pashujanya Yudh Abhyas (PYA)

▪ The Department of Animal Husbandry & Dairying (DAHD) conducted Pashujanya Yudh Abhyas (PYA), a five-day national mock drill in Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh.

▪ Pashujanya Yudh Abhyas (PYA) is a national-level mock drill conducted under the National One Health Mission to evaluate India's preparedness, coordination, and emergency response for animal health emergencies and zoonotic disease outbreaks.

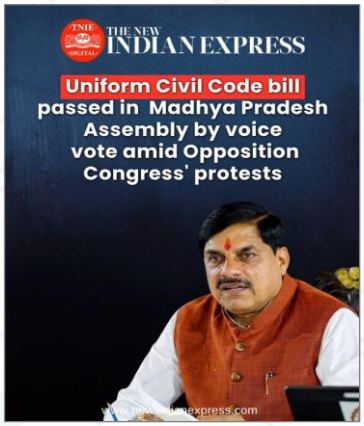
▪ Enhance inter-sectoral coordination among veterinary, public health, wildlife, laboratory, and administrative agencies under the One Health framework.

The Pyre Protest



- The 'Chita Andolan' (Pyre Protest) has resumed in Madhya Pradesh as people affected by the Ken–Betwa Link Project allege delays in rehabilitation, compensation, and resettlement.
- The Pyre Protest (Chita Andolan) is a peaceful symbolic protest in which affected people sit beside funeral pyres to express that losing their land, homes, forests, and livelihoods is equivalent to social death.
- Aim: To demand fair rehabilitation, adequate compensation, and timely resettlement for families displaced by major development projects.

MP assembly passes Uniform Civil Code Bill; will be enforced after Governor's nod



- The Madhya Pradesh Assembly passed the Madhya Pradesh Uniform Civil Code (UCC), 2026, Bill.
- Madhya Pradesh became the fourth state after Uttarakhand, Gujarat and Assam to pass a UCC law.
- The legislation creates a common civil law governing marriage, divorce, inheritance and live-in relationships, while exempting Scheduled Tribes covered under Articles 342 and 366(25) of the Constitution.
- It bans polygamy, criminalises practices such as triple talaq and nikah halala, mandates registration of marriages, divorces and live-in relationships, and grants equal inheritance rights irrespective of gender.

First Telecom Manufacturing Zone will be established in Gwalior



- India's first Telecom Manufacturing Zone will be set up in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh.
- An MoU will be signed in New Delhi between the Madhya Pradesh Government and the Department of Telecommunications, Government of India.
- The zone will be developed over about 350 acres. It will manufacture mobile phones, telecom equipment, optical fibre, semiconductors and products related to 5G and 6G technology.
- The government says the project will boost domestic production of telecom equipment, reduce imports and make Madhya Pradesh a major telecom and electronics manufacturing hub

SHORT NEWS

- Madhya Pradesh CM Dr. Mohan Yadav to lay foundation stone for 'Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Smart Industrial Park' in Satgarhi

Bihar

Bihar CM launches Heli-Tourism and Air Tourism Service Scheme-2026



- Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary launched the 'Chief Minister Bihar Heli-Tourism and Air Tourism Service Scheme-2026' to facilitate travel to tourist destinations in the State.
- Under this scheme, government helicopters will be used to visit tourist places by booking them on rent.
- The State government has already given approval for helicopter operations every Saturday and Sunday to offer aerial views of Patna's skyline.
- the helicopter services will be provided to major tourist destinations such as Patna, Rajgir, Valmikinagar, and Kaimur, for which the government will provide a subsidy of up to ₹15,422 per ticket.

▪ The scheme also includes a 10-minute helicopter tour of Patna for Rs 2,100 per person.

Bihar's 700-Year-Old Munger Banyan Identified as the Oldest Scientifically Dated Banyan Tree



▪ A banyan tree in Bihar's Munger, estimated to be around 700 years old, has been identified as the oldest accurately dated banyan tree (Ficus benghalensis) using radiocarbon dating - a method based entirely on scientific evidence rather than oral histories or historical accounts

Bihar Chief Minister inaugurated the Belwa-Minapur Link Channel in Sheohar



- Bihar Chief Minister inaugurated the 68.80 km Belwa-Minapur Link Channel (Belwadhar) in Sheohar, constructed at a cost of ₹130.88 crore.
- The Belwa-Minapur Link Channel is an artificial, high-capacity water diversion.
- It functions as the foundational phase of the broader Bagmati-Budhi Gandak River Interlinking Project and the Bagmati Flood Management Project, creating a regulated hydraulic bridge between two major river basins in Bihar.

Location:

- **Starting Point:** Belwa Ghat in the Pipra block of Sheohar district.
- **Terminal Point:** Minapur in Muzaffarpur district.
- Impact Footprint: Connects through multiple blocks across four North Bihar districts—Sheohar, Muzaffarpur, East Champaran, and Samastipur.
- Aim: The canal aims to capture and divert surplus floodwaters from the unpredictable Bagmati River into the higher-capacity bed of the Budhi Gandak River.

Jharkhand

Jharkhand Gets GI Tags for Four Handloom Products

▪ Four traditional products from Jharkhand—Bhagaiya silk, Kuchai silk, Munda jewellery, and bamboo craft—have been officially granted the prestigious Geographical Indication (GI) tag.

Bhagaiya Silk & Kuchai Silk:

▪ Traditional Jharkhand silks known for their natural golden sheen, durability, and eco-friendly wild Tussar silk production.

▪ associated with the Bhagaiya belt in Godda district.

▪ **Godda is often called the Silk City of Jharkhand, and Tasar silk is a type of wild silk produced by silkworms that feed on forest trees.**

Munda Jewellery:



▪ Traditional tribal jewellery handcrafted with unique geometric patterns and nature-inspired motifs of the Munda community.

▪ Holds cultural and spiritual significance while preserving centuries-old indigenous metalcraft traditions.

Jharkhand Bamboo Craft:

▪ Eco-friendly craft using local bamboo to create baskets, mats, utility products, and decorative items (from the Chhota Nagpur plateau)

Chhattisgarh

Direct Seeded Rice

▪ In a bid to mitigate the rainfall uncertainty due to the potential impact of El Nino, the Chhattisgarh government recently advised farmers to cultivate oilseeds and use Direct Seeded Rice (DSR) method in paddy for the upcoming kharif season.

▪ It is a modern farming technique where rice seeds are sown directly into the field, replacing the traditional method of transplanting seedlings from a nursery.





Preferred Soil Types for Direct Seeded Rice

▪ DSR can be operationalized on soils ranging from medium texture (loam) to heavy texture (clay).

▪ However, it is recommended not to go for DSR if the soil is light textured and poorly drained.

▪ This method skips the labor-intensive step of transplanting, saving farmers time and effort.

▪ DSR uses less water (up to 50%) because it doesn't require continuous flooding of the fields.

Chhattisgarh has launched the DWEEPTI Yojana

- Chhattisgarh has launched the DWEEPTI Yojana (Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion), making it the first Indian state to adopt a women-led distributed renewable energy policy.
- DWEEPTI Yojana (Decentralised Women Empowerment on Energy and Policy for Transformative Inclusion) is an initiative of the Chhattisgarh Panchayat and Rural Development Department, developed in collaboration with Transform Rural India (TRI) under the Green Economy Transition Mission.
- It integrates women-led Self-Help Groups (SHGs) into the distributed solar energy ecosystem by enabling them to install, manage, and promote rooftop solar systems.
- Aim: To promote women-led clean energy entrepreneurship, expand decentralized renewable energy adoption, and create sustainable livelihood opportunities while supporting rural energy self-reliance.

Odisha

Naba Jaubana Darshan of Lord Jagannath to be held in Puri

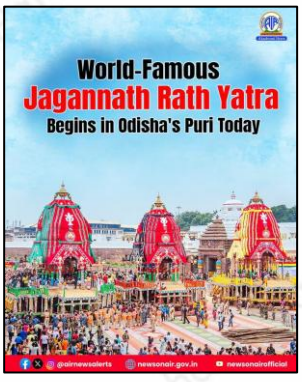


▪ In Odisha, the sacred 'Naba Jaubana Darshan' of Lord Jagannath, Lord Balabhadra, and Devi Subhadra will be held at the Shree Jagannath Temple in Puri, marking the first public appearance of the sibling deities after the fortnight-long 'Anasara' period.

▪ The deities, believed to have recuperated from their ceremonial illness following 'Snana Purnima' will be unveiled in their rejuvenated youthful.

▪ The 'Naba Jaubana Darshan' marks the culmination of the pre-Rath Yatra rituals and heralds the commencement of the world-renowned Rath Yatra.

The iconic Rath Yatra has officially commenced in Puri, Odisha



▪ Jagannath Rath Yatra is an ancient Hindu festival that commemorates the annual journey of Lord Jagannath, Lord Balabhadra, and Goddess Subhadra from the Jagannath Temple to the Gundicha Temple in Puri, Odisha.

▪ Believed to have ancient origins rooted in Hindu traditions and scriptures.

▪ The present Jagannath Temple was built in the 12th century CE by King Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva.

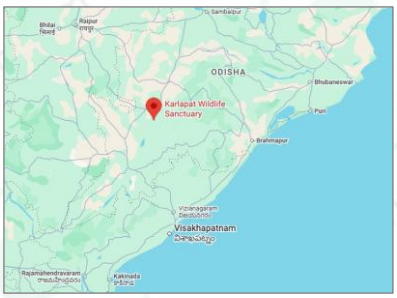
▪ Celebrates the annual visit of the three deities to Gundicha Temple, believed to be their aunt's abode.

- Popularly known as the Festival of Chariots because the deities travel in three grand wooden chariots.
- Observed every year on Ashadha Shukla Dwitiya and continues for nine days. Goddess Subhadra wished to visit her aunt's house at Gundicha Temple.
- Lord Jagannath and Lord Balabhadra accompanied her, giving rise to the annual Rath Yatra tradition.
- The festival represents the love, affection, and family bond among the three divine siblings.

The Three Chariots of Jagannath Rath Yatra

Deity	Chariot Name	Canopy Colour
Lord Jagannath	Nandighosha	Red and Yellow
Lord Balabhadra	Taladhwaja	Red and Green
Goddess Subhadra	Darpadalana (Devadalana)	Red and Black

The Karlapat Bauxite Block



- India's top industrial giants—including Adani, Reliance Industries, Hindalco, Vedanta, Powercem, and Coal India—are competing to acquire the Karlapat bauxite block in Odisha.
- The Karlapat-Pollingpadar block is one of India's largest unallotted, greenfield (previously unmined) bauxite deposits.
- Bauxite serves as the primary commercial ore required to produce alumina, which is then smelted into aluminium metal.
- **District: Kalahandi district, Odisha.**
- Geographic Belt: Situated within the mineral-dense Eastern Ghats Mobile Belt, known for hosting the East Coast Bauxite deposits.
- Located adjacent to the Karlapat Wildlife Sanctuary, an ecologically sensitive zone and elephant corridor.
- The deposit formed through in-situ chemical weathering of pre-existing Precambrian rocks

West Bengal

Project INROAD Expands Natural Rubber Plantations in North-East

- Project INROAD, or Indian Natural Rubber Operations for Assisted Development, is a plantation expansion initiative for natural rubber in North-East India and West Bengal.
- By 15-16 July 2026, the project had created 1.8 lakh hectares of new rubber plantations against a target of 2 lakh hectares across 113 districts.
- Project INROAD was launched in the financial year 2021-22 with an estimated outlay of Rs 1,100 crore.
- The project is implemented by the Rubber Board of India and is financially supported by Apollo Tyres, CEAT, JK Tyre and MRF through the Automotive Tyre Manufacturers' Association.
- The project covers plantation development, supply of planting material and farmer support in rubber-growing regions.

Janai's Manohara and Balagarh's Traditional Boats Receive GI Tags



- West Bengal's another two products got the GI Tag recognition
- The famous Manohara sweet from the Janai has also received GI recognition.
- Hand-rolled fresh chhena (cottage cheese) mixed with coconut and pistachios, dipped into a thick, crystallized sugar shell
- The GI tag has also been awarded to the Balagarh's traditional wooden boats, it is a craft with a history spanning more than 500 years.

- It is located along the Hooghly River, Balagarh emerged as the important boat-building centre during the era of the historic Saptagram Port.
- Initially, dingi (small) boats were built here, followed by larger vessels.

Chandannagar's jalbhara gets GI tag



- Jalbhara, a traditional sweet from Chandannagar (near Kolkata, West Bengal), has been awarded the Geographical Indication (GI) tag.

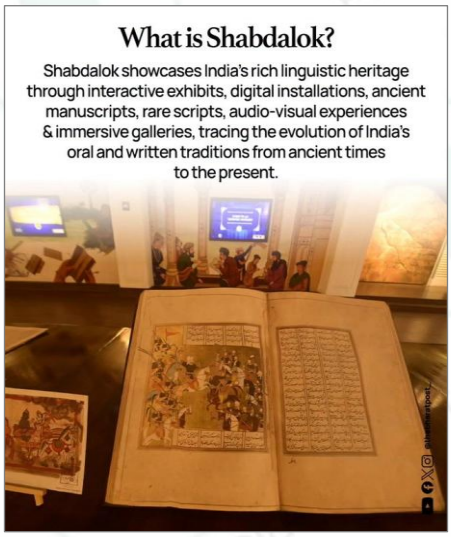
Origin and Creators

- Invented around 220 years ago by Surjya Modak and his son Siddheshwar Modak.
- Origin traces back to the year 1250 of the Bengali calendar (approx. 1843–44).
- Created in Telinipara, Chandannagar, on request of a zamindar's household for a unique wedding sweet.

Preparation and Composition

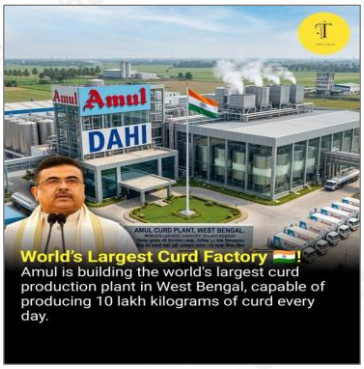
- Made using chhena (cottage cheese from curdled cow milk).
- Filled with a mixture of:
- Aromatic rose extract
- Jaggery reduced to a sticky consistency called "dolo"
- Named "jalbhara" (meaning "water-filled") due to its liquid-filled core.
- Cultural and Historical Influence
- Portuguese presence in nearby Bandel popularised the use of curdled milk in sweets, influencing its creation.

Amit Shah inaugurates India's first immersive language museum in Kolkata



- Museum of Word, also known as Shabdalok, at the National Library campus in Kolkata, is India's first immersive language museum.
- It was developed by the National Library under the Union Culture Ministry.
- It showcases the country's linguistic heritage and traces the evolution of oral and written traditions through interactive, technology-driven exhibits.
- The first phase of the museum chronicles the diversity of Indian languages, scripts, and literature.
- The museum has nine galleries that explore different facets of the history of languages and their influence on India's civilization and culture.
- Shabdalok celebrates India's 22 official languages and traces their journey from oral traditions and ancient manuscripts to printed works and modern electronic texts.
- One of its key attractions allows visitors to trace the evolution of words over centuries, illustrating how their pronunciation, meaning, and usage have changed over time

Amul Bengal Dairy to Host World's Largest Curd Plant



- Amul has begun work on an integrated dairy project in West Bengal that will include the world's largest curd manufacturing facility.
- The project is located at Howrah Food Park in Sankrail, Howrah district, at Biswa Bangla Convention Centre in New Town, Kolkata.
- The plant will function as a multi-product dairy unit.

West Bengal to get first NIA police station

- West Bengal is set to get its first dedicated police station for the National Investigation Agency (NIA) at National Buildings Construction Corporation Square

in Kolkata's New Town.

- With this new police station, NIA will now be able to lodge FIRs in connection with any case in West Bengal immediately in Kolkata.
- Earlier, investigations in West Bengal could begin only after a copy of that FIR was received from Delhi.
- This will be the 17th police station of the NIA across the country. The other 16 police stations are already operational in New Delhi, Jaipur, Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Bhubaneshwar, Chennai, Guwahati, Hyderabad, Imphal, Jammu, Kochi, Lucknow, Mumbai, Raipur, Ranchi, and Vishakhapatnam.



Sikkim

Sikkim launches ecological drive to revive Himalayan oak forests

▪ The Chief Minister of Sikkim, Mr Prem Singh Tamang launched "Mission: Million Oak Trees by 2047", a State-wide ecological restoration programme aimed at reviving Himalayan oak forests to strengthen water security, biodiversity and climate resilience.

▪ The first oak sapling under the mission, released the Oak Forest Restoration Manual, and launched the "Connect to Forest" toll-free helpline (1926) to enable citizens to report grievances, human-wildlife conflict, hazardous trees and access Forest Department services.

▪ Mr. Tamang inaugurated the Sikkim Forest Training Institute at Bulbuley, established under the JICA-assisted Sikkim Biodiversity Conservation and Forest Management Project

Sikkim announces 20% reservation for Agniveers in Forest Guard recruitment

- The Sikkim government has announced a 20 percent reservation for Agniveers in recruitment to the post of forest guard in the state.
- The decision aims to provide employment opportunities to Agniveers after they complete their service in the Armed Forces.
- The state government has already implemented a 20 per cent reservation for Agniveers in recruitment to the Sikkim Police.



Assam

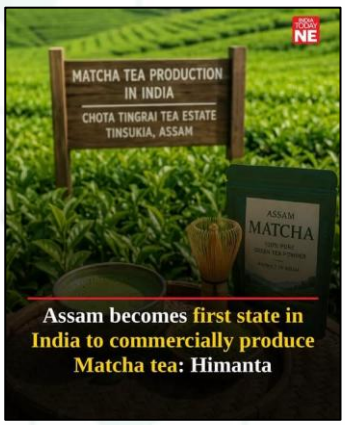
The Matcha Tea

▪ Assam's Chota Tingrai Tea Estate in Tinsukia district successfully produced and sold India's first-ever commercially grown Matcha tea.

▪ Matcha is a premium, vibrant green, finely ground powder made from specially processed, shade-grown leaves of the Camellia sinensis

▪ Unlike conventional green teas where the leaves are steeped in water and then discarded, matcha powder is whisked directly into hot water and consumed entirely, providing a highly concentrated dose of nutrients, antioxidants, and caffeine.

▪ The practice of grinding dried tea leaves into a fine powder and whisking it with hot water originated in China during the Song dynasty (960–1279 CE).



India to host two-day BRICS anti-drugs meet

▪ India will host the two-day BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies meeting in Guwahati from July 6, 2026.

▪ Organised by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB),

The BRICS nations recently adopted the Guwahati Declaration



- The BRICS nations recently adopted the Guwahati Declaration, reaffirming their commitment to strengthen cooperation to prevent and combat illicit drug trafficking and related organised transnational crime.
- It was adopted by the BRICS nations to strengthen cooperation against illicit drug trafficking and related transnational organized crime.
- The declaration was adopted at the conclusion of the two-day BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies Meeting held in Guwahati, Assam.
- It was held under India's 2026 BRICS chairship, themed "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability,".

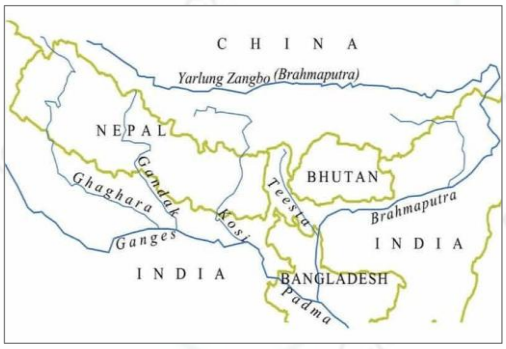
Assam Floods and Flood Management in India

- Assam has witnessed its **worst floods in over 60 years,** affecting over 8 lakh people and claiming more than 30 lives, highlighting persistent challenges in India's flood management and the need for climate-resilient infrastructure.



Why is Assam Highly Prone to Floods?

- Geographical Vulnerability: Assam lies in the Brahmaputra and Barak river basins, with over 50 tributaries draining into them.
- The Brahmaputra carries one of the world's highest sediment loads. As the river enters Assam's plains, reduced gradient causes sediment deposition, raising riverbeds and increasing flood frequency.
- **Heavy Monsoon Rainfall:** Intense southwest monsoon rainfall, coupled with heavy upstream discharge from Arunachal Pradesh and Meghalaya, frequently triggers flash floods.
- **Flood Vulnerability in India**: India has over 40 million hectares of flood-prone area out of its 329 million hectares of geographical area.
- The Brahmaputra River System originates from the **Chemayungdung Glacier**, near Mount Kailash, in the Angsi Glacier region in southwestern Tibet.
- It then passes through Arunachal Pradesh , Assam and Bangladesh, eventually merging with the Bay of Bengal



Arunachal Pradesh

Norway firm to set up India's first river kinetic energy demo plant in Arunachal



- Arunachal Pradesh has signed an MoU with Norway-based Tidal Sails AS to set up India's first kinetic energy demonstration plant.
- Under the project, a 500 kW system will generate electricity directly from river currents without major infrastructure, providing a clean, sustainable, and cost-effective renewable energy solution.

▪ The agreement was signed between the Centre for Earth Sciences and Himalayan Studies and the Norwegian firm under the India-Norway Green Partnership.

Dree Festival



▪ The Dree Festival is the major agricultural festival of the Apatani tribe in Arunachal Pradesh, celebrated annually in the Ziro Valley.
▪ Held in early July,
▪ Dree is observed during the crop-growing season.
▪ Dree is celebrated with prayers for a bumper harvest and prosperity.

Meghalaya

DARPG to organise National Conference on "NextGen Administrative & e-Gov Reforms" in Shillong

▪ The Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG), in collaboration with the Government of Meghalaya, is organizing a two-day National Conference.
▪ Theme "NextGen Administrative & e-Gov Reforms"
▪ Dates: 13–14 July 2026 in Shillong, Meghalaya

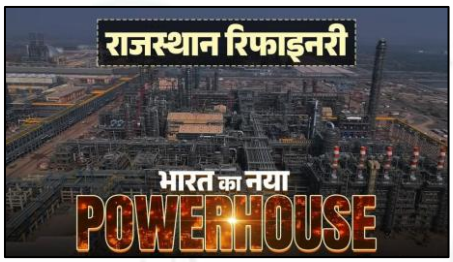
Union Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia & Meghalaya CM launch Lakadong Turmeric Mission Golden Spice



- Union Minister for the Development of the North Eastern Region Jyotiraditya Scindia launched the Lakadong Turmeric Mission Golden Spice along with Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad Sangma.
- **Mission Golden Spice** is a project under the Ministry's Unlock the Economic Potential of India's Northeast (USP) initiative and is worth over 175 crore rupees.
- Lakadong Turmeric is globally acclaimed for its exceptional quality.

Rajasthan

GI tag to Jodhpuri's Mojari



▪ The Centre has granted a Geographical Indication (GI) tag to Jodhpur's nearly 200-year-old Mojari craft, giving the traditional footwear official recognition and a boost in global branding.
▪ Jodhpuri Mojari are crafted by members of a caste called Jinagar, who according to researchers, were traditionally saddle makers.
▪ Once patronised by the royals, the Mojari gradually evolved into a distinctive craft giving the city a unique identification.

India Launches First Greenfield Refinery-Cum-Petrochemical Complex



▪ Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated India's first greenfield integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex at Pachpadra in Balotra district, Rajasthan.
▪ The project is a joint venture between Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited and the Government of Rajasthan, with equity shares of 74% and 26% respectively.

29th National e-Governance Conference commences at Rajasthan International Centre in Jaipur

- The 29th National e-Governance Conference commenced today at the Rajasthan International Centre in Jaipur.
- The two-day conference is being jointly organised by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and the Government of Rajasthan
- The theme of this year's conference is "Viksit Bharat 2047: AI-Enabled, Data-Driven and Secure Digital Governance."

Rajasthan Issues First Rare Earth Exploration Licence

- Rajasthan became the first state in India to execute an exploration licence for rare earth elements
- The licence covers 207.63 square kilometres in the Navatala-Devigarh (Pachpadra) region of Balotra district and Shergarh tehsil of Jodhpur district.
- Rare earth elements are a group of 17 chemically similar metallic elements that include the 15 lanthanides, scandium, and yttrium.
- An exploration licence is a legal permission for prospecting and geological investigation before mineral extraction.

Gujarat

PM Modi extends Kutchi New Year greetings on Ashadhi Bij

- Ashadhi Bij is celebrated as the Kutchi New Year and holds special significance for the people of the Kutch region in Gujarat, as well as for the global Kutchi diaspora.
- Kutchi New Year is observed every year on second day of shukla paksha or waxing phase of moon in Ashada month.
- The festival coincides with the onset of the monsoon in the region and is traditionally regarded as an auspicious occasion, particularly for farming communities.
- It is marked by cultural celebrations, community gatherings and the exchange of New Year greetings.

Gujarat's Unjha Cumin and Fennel Get GI Tags



- Unjha cumin and Unjha fennel (spices), two significant agricultural products in Gujarat, have been granted the Geographical Indication (GI) tag
- Unjha is a major agricultural market town in North Gujarat and is known for trade in cumin and fennel.
- Gujarat has expanded its list of GI-tagged agricultural products, which already includes Gir Kesar mangoes, Bhalia wheat, Kachchhi Kharek and Amalsadi chikoo.

Gujarat Launches Samras Vidyasetu Dropout Campaign

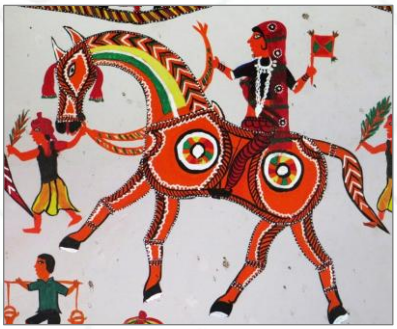
- Gujarat launched the statewide Samras Vidyasetu Mega Campaign from Ahmedabad to re-enrol more than 80,000 school dropout children in classes 1 to 12
- The campaign is linked to the state's stated goal of achieving "Zero Dropout" through school re-entry, tracking, and retention measures.
- The Samras Vidyasetu campaign includes identification of dropout children, re-enrolment in schools, contact with parents, home visits, mentoring, and bridge courses.

Pithora Painting of Gujarat's Rathwa Community Granted Geographical Indication (GI) Status



- The Pithora painting, a centuries-old wall art tradition of Gujarat's Rathwa tribal community, recently received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag.
- It is a traditional tribal wall art that has originated in the tribal regions of Gujarat, mainly in Panchmahal and Chhota Udaipur.

- It is done by tribes such as the Rathwa, Bhil, and Bhilala, who hold a strong belief in nature, spirits, and divine powers.
- Dating back to around the 13th century, Pithora painting derives its name from Pithora De, the Rathwa tribe's deity associated with marriage, prosperity, and communal well-being.
- Traditionally, Pithora paintings were created on the walls of homes.
- The paintings were often commissioned during significant life events, such as weddings, births, and festivals, serving as a means of invoking blessings and protection from deities.
- Traditionally executed by specialist ritual painters known as Lakharas, under the guidance of a priest called Badwa.
- Traditionally, walls are prepared by applying a mixture of cow dung and clay.
- Artists use natural pigments derived from minerals, plants, and other organic materials to create the colors for their paintings.



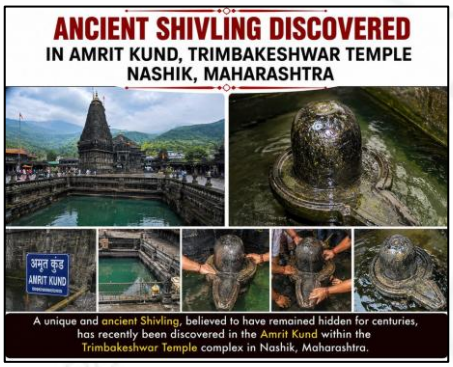
- Common colors include red, yellow, green, and blue, each derived from specific natural sources.
- Painters use a combination of bamboo sticks, cotton and wooden stencils to create their art.
- The paintings show tribal and Hindu deities, horses, animals, and scenes from daily life like farming, hunting, and dancing.

Maharashtra

Maharashtra Gives Legal Recognition to Women Farmers

- Maharashtra has become the first Indian state to enact the Maharashtra Women Farmers Empowerment Act, 2026, a landmark law recognizing and protecting the rights of women farmers.
- The Act was introduced during the UN-observed International Year of the Woman Farmer, promoting inclusive and sustainable agrifood systems.
- Historically, government agricultural benefits, extension services, and formal bank loans have been legally tied to land ownership, which is overwhelmingly held by men.

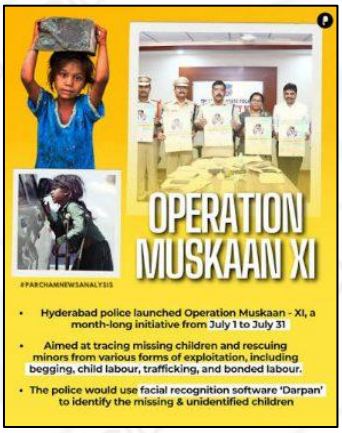
Trimbakeshwar Temple



- A unique Shivling—which has remained hidden for centuries—has been discovered from the Amrit Kund inside the Trimbakeshwar Temple complex in the Nashik district of Maharashtra recently.
- It is an ancient and historic Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Shiva.
- It is located in Trimbak village in the Nasik district of Maharashtra.
- It lies near the mountain named Brahamagiri, from which the river Godavari flows.
- It is one of twelve famous Jyotirlingas in India.
- The spiritual history of the Trimbakeshwar Temple dates back many centuries and is mentioned in sacred texts such as the Shiva Purana, Skanda Purana, and Padma Purana.
- The present temple structure was constructed by the third Peshwa, Balaji Bajirao (1740-1760), on the site of an old temple.
- The temple is constructed in the Hemadpanthi style, a traditional architectural form known for its strength, symmetry, and minimal use of mortar.
- It is built entirely from black basalt stone.
- Within the temple premises lies the Kushavarta Kund, a sacred pond regarded as the origin of the Godavari River

Telangana

India to Host BRICS Labour Ministers' Meeting



- India will host the BRICS Labour and Employment Ministers' Meeting in Hyderabad on 15 and 16 July 2026 under its BRICS presidency.
- India's BRICS Chairship in 2026 operates under the theme "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability". .

Telangana police launched month-long Operation Muskaan-XII from July 1

- The Women Safety Wing of Telangana Police on announced that Operation Muskaan-XII will be carried out from July 1 to July 31.
- The campaign would focus on tracing missing children, rescuing children from exploitation and strengthening measures for their long-term protection and rehabilitation.

Hyderabad-based Olectra becomes first company in India to deploy 4,000 electric buses



- Hyderabad-based Olectra Greentech Limited has become the first company in India to deploy 4,000 electric buses on the country's roads.
- The company stated that its fleet of 4,000 electric buses has collectively travelled more than 730 million green kilometres, preventing over 6.5 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide (CO_2) emissions.

Andhra Pradesh

Andhra Pradesh CM Chandrababu Naidu launches 'Pillale Sampada' initiative



- Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu announced the launch of 'Pillale Sampada'scheme at a World Population Day programme
- Under the scheme, a financial assistance of ₹30,000 will be given for the birth of a third child and ₹40,000 for the birth of a fourth one.
- This is to encourage balanced population growth in view of the importance of achieving demographic stability.

India Approves First PinS Helicopter Approach



- The Ministry of Civil Aviation announce a significant milestone in India's aviation sector with the approval of the country's first Private Point-in-Space (PinS) Instrument Approach Procedure for helicopter operations at Undavalli Heliport, located in Andhra Pradesh
- **Developed by the Airports Authority of India (AAI) and approved by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA),.**
- PinS (Point-in-Space) procedures use advanced satellite-based navigation technology to enable helicopters to conduct safe and precise instrument approaches to heliports that do not have conventional instrument landing infrastructure.

Karnataka

#ReclaimConstitution launches reading initiative to build public engagement around Constitution, first event in Bengaluru

- #ReclaimConstitution, a citizens' collective, launched the initiative "Constitution Corner".
- Objective: To promote a reading culture focused on the Constitution and ideas shaping society.
- It is a collaborative initiative with bookstores to create dedicated reading spaces.

Focus areas include:

- Constitutional values
- Democracy
- History and politics
- Rights and public life
- The first Constitution Corner has been set up at Turning Pages bookstore, Jakkur (Bengaluru).
- A key feature is monthly book discussions to encourage dialogue and knowledge sharing among readers.

Malaprabha River



- The Malaprabha River, which flows through parts of the Guledgudda taluk in Karnataka, has dried up recently, causing severe hardship for people living along its banks.
- It is one of the important tributaries of the Krishna River and flows through the state of Karnataka.
- The river originates in the Western Ghats, specifically at an elevation of 792 meters in the Sahyadri hill range, at Kanakumbi village in the Belgaum district.
- The Shri Mauli Devi temple marks the birthplace of Malaprabha at Kanakumbi; the place has a long history going back to prehistoric times, and it's a pilgrimage center.
- From there, it flows eastward and then northeast, finally merging with the Krishna River at the confluence point known as Kudala Sangama in the Bagalkot district.
- Malaprabha's main tributaries are Bennihalla, Hirehalla, and Tuprihalla.
- There is a dam known as Renukasagar built on this river.

Crèche Guidelines in India: Rules, Labour Laws, Safety Norms & Childcare Standards



- The severe abuse of toddlers by caregivers at the 'Little Buds Day Care' facility located on the Capgemini campus in Brookefield, Bengaluru, has sparked intense public outrage.
- A crèche is defined as a specialized care center that provides a safe, protective, and nurturing environment for children while their parents or primary guardians are away at work.

Crèches are designed to provide childcare for children aged 6 months and above, supporting working parents during early childhood.

- **Expansion under Palna Scheme: The government aims to establish 17,000 Anganwadi-cum-Crèches (AWCCs) under Mission Shakti to expand quality childcare services.**
- **Women Caregivers Only: National guidelines require only women to be appointed as caregivers and helpers to ensure child safety and comfort.**

- **Mandatory Crèche Provision: Establishments employing 50 or more workers must provide a crèche facility under labour laws.**

Kalaburagi Police launch 'Beda Bro' and 'Operation RISE' anti-drug awareness campaigns

- The Mysuru City and District Police (Karnataka) launched 'Operation RISE' and 'Beda Bro' as part of the state's anti-drug initiative.
- **Operation RISE**: RISE stands for Refuse, Inform, Support, Empower, focusing on community participation and awareness against narcotic drugs.
- **Beda Bro Campaign**: The initiative targets Gen Z youth by educating them about the physical, psychological, social, and legal consequences of drug addiction while encouraging responsible choices and resistance to peer pressure.

The E-Commerce Council of India (ECCI)

- The Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) officially launched the **E-Commerce Council of India (ECCI) in Bengaluru**.
- The E-Commerce Council of India (ECCI) is a dedicated, first-of-its-kind national industry council established to represent, unify, and advance the interests of India's digital commerce landscape.
- Nodal Body: Founded under the aegis of the Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI).
- Objectives: The core objective of the ECCI is to present a single, common voice for the digital trade ecosystem during policy conversations with the government.

Kerala

Kerala launches 'Dakshayani' scheme to boost entrepreneurship among SC/ST women

- The State government has announced a new scheme, 'Dakshayani', aimed at promoting entrepreneurship and economic empowerment among women belonging to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.
- The scheme has been named after Dakshayani Velayudhan, social reformer, the first woman graduate from the Scheduled Castes community,
- Under the scheme, self-help groups of SC/ST women will receive financial assistance to start new enterprises or expand existing ones.

Eligibility

- Self-Help Groups (SHGs) of SC/ST women
- Members must be 18 years or above
- Group must be registered

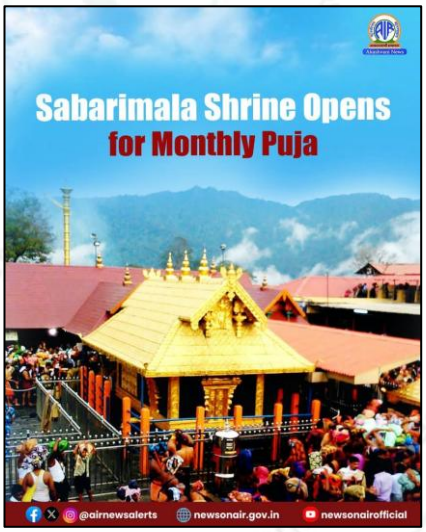
Financial Assistance

New Enterprises:

- **75% subsidy of project cost**
- Maximum subsidy: ₹10 lakh
- Remaining 25%: Bank loan / SC-ST Development Corporation support

Existing Enterprises:

- Must be operational for minimum 2 years
- Eligible subsidy: Up to ₹5 lakh for expansion



Kerala's Sabarimala Temple Reopens for Monthly Rituals

- Located in the Periyar Tiger Reserve in Kerala's Pathanamthitta district, the Sabarimala Temple is dedicated to Lord Ayyappa.
- The temple is known for its unique religious practices where devotees undertake a 41-day penance, renouncing worldly pleasures before visiting the temple.

▪ Women in their 'menstruating years' (between 10 to 50 years) were customarily prohibited from entering the temple to protect Ayyappa's celibacy.

▪ The Travancore Devaswom Board emphasised that Sabarimala is a religious denomination protected by Article 26 of the Indian Constitution.

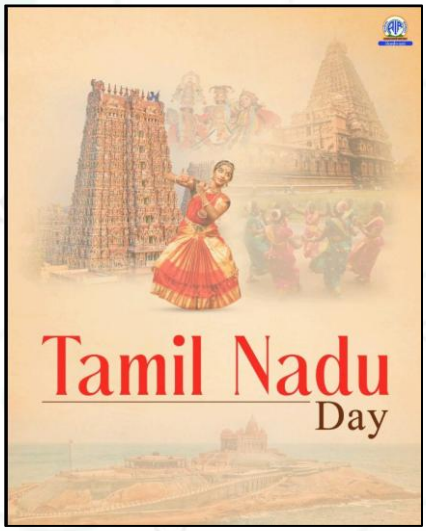
▪ The right of a religious denomination to manage its internal religious affairs is guaranteed by Article 26 of the Constitution.

▪ On September 28th, 2018, a 5-judge Supreme Court bench issued its decision in the Sabarimala Temple Entry case.

▪ The temple's practice of excluding women was deemed unconstitutional by a 4:1 majority▪ The majority ruled that the exclusion of women from Sabarimala violated the fundamental rights of women aged 10 to 50.

Tamil Nadu

18 July Tamil Nadu Day



▪ **Tamil Nadu was created on 1 November 1956 with the name Madras State.**

▪ On 18 July 1967, Madras State was officially renamed to Tamil Nadu.

▪ In 2019, five decades after the state was renamed, the Government of Tamil Nadu led by the then chief minister of Tamil Nadu Edapadi K Palaniswami, announced that 1st November of every year will be celebrated as Tamil Nadu Day from 2019 to mark the formation of the state.

▪ In July 2022, Government of Tamil Nadu led by the then chief minister of Tamil Nadu M K Stalin, announced that 18 July of every year will be celebrated as Tamil Nadu Day from 2022 to mark the formation of the state.

Tamil Nadu Facts:

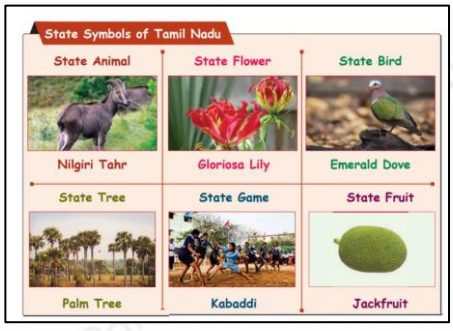
▪ **Capital: Chennai**

▪ **Home to Bharatanatyam, one of the oldest classical dance forms**

▪ **Nilgiri Hills (Ooty) and Kodaikanal – popular hill stations**

▪ **5 National Parks in Tamil Nadu:**

- Mudumalai National Park
- Guindy National Park
- Indira Gandhi (Anamalai) National Park
- Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve
- Gulf of Mannar Marine National Park



▪ **Highest Mountain Peak: Doddabetta Peak (Nilgiri Hills) - Height: 2,637 meters, Near Ooty**

▪ State animal - Nilgiri tahr

▪ State bird - Emerald Dove

▪ State flower - Gloriosa Lily

▪ State tree - Palm Tree

▪ State butterfly - Tamil yeoman

▪ **State fruit – Jackfruit**

Killai Becomes Tamil Nadu's First Climate-Resilient Village



- Killai in Cuddalore district became Tamil Nadu's first fully operational Climate Resilient Village
- The Climate Resilient Villages programme is a flagship initiative of the Tamil Nadu government launched in 2022-23.
- It covers 11 districts and includes 11 identified villages

- The programme addresses climate-related risks in coastal settlements, including cyclones, sea-level rise, saline intrusion, coastal erosion, and biodiversity loss.
- It also includes measures for sustainable livelihoods in fishing communities.

Defence

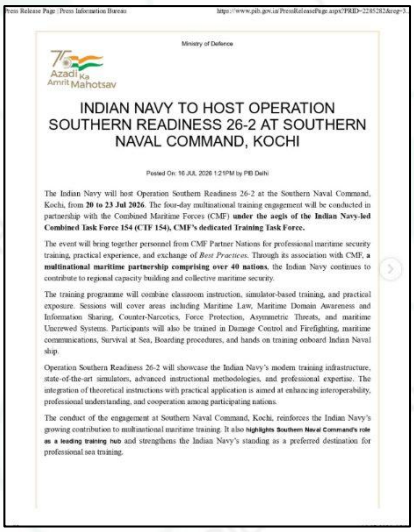
Military Exercises

Exercise Pitch Black 2026: India's Rafale fighter aircraft & C-17 arrive in Australia



- India's Rafale fighter aircraft and C-17 transport aircraft have reached Australia to participate in the multinational air combat exercise, Pitch Black 2026.
- Exercise Pitch Black 2026 is the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF)'s largest multinational air combat exercise, scheduled in Australia's Northern Territory from 20th July to 7th August 2026.
- Participating Countries: The exercise will include over 19 nations, such as India, Australia, USA, UK, Japan, France, Indonesia, Singapore, South Korea, Canada, and other Indo-Pacific partners.
- Other Exercises: Exercise AUSTRA HIND (Army), AUSINDEX (Navy), and MALABAR (Multilateral-India, USA, Japan, and Australia)

Operation Southern Readiness 26-2



Ministry of Defence

INDIAN NAVY TO HOST OPERATION SOUTHERN READINESS 26-2 AT SOUTHERN NAVAL COMMAND, KOCHI

Posted On: 16 JUL 2026 1:21PM by PIB Delhi

The Indian Navy will host Operation Southern Readiness 26-2 at the Southern Naval Command, Kochi, from **20 to 23 Jul 2026**. The four-day multinational training engagement will be conducted in partnership with the Combined Maritime Forces (CMF) **under the aegis of the Indian Navy-led Combined Task Force 154 (CTF 154), CMF's dedicated Training Task Force.**

The event will bring together personnel from CMF Partner Nations for professional maritime security training, practical experience, and exchange of *Best Practices*. Through its association with CMF, **a multinational maritime partnership comprising over 40 nations**, the Indian Navy continues to contribute to regional capacity building and collective maritime security.

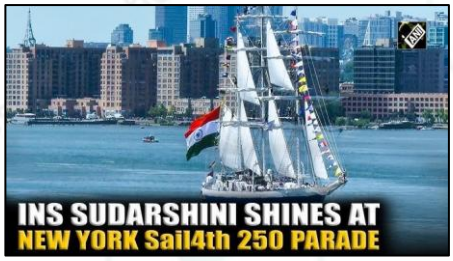
The training programme will combine classroom instruction, simulator-based training, and practical exposure. Sessions will cover areas including Maritime Law, Maritime Domain Awareness and Information Sharing, Counter-Narcotics, Force Protection, Asymmetric Threats, and maritime Uncrewed Systems. Participants will also be trained in Damage Control and Firefighting, maritime communications, Survival at Sea, Boarding procedures, and hands on training onboard Indian Naval ship.

Operation Southern Readiness 26-2 will showcase the Indian Navy's modern training infrastructure, state-of-the-art simulators, advanced instructional methodologies, and professional expertise. The integration of theoretical instructions with practical application is aimed at enhancing interoperability, professional understanding, and cooperation among participating nations.

The conduct of the engagement at Southern Naval Command, Kochi, reinforces the Indian Navy's growing contribution to multinational maritime training. It also **highlights Southern Naval Command's role as a leading training hub** and strengthens the Indian Navy's standing as a preferred destination for professional sea training.

- The Indian Navy is set to host Operation Southern Readiness 26-2 at the Southern Naval Command, Kochi.
- It is a multinational maritime training exercise.
- It is hosted by the Indian Navy at the Southern Naval Command, Kochi.
- The four-day multinational training engagement will be conducted in partnership with the Combined Maritime Forces (CMF) under the aegis of the Indian Navy-led Combined Task Force 154 (CTF 154), CMF's dedicated Training Task Force.
- The training programme will combine classroom instruction, simulator-based training, and practical exposure.
- Sessions will cover areas including Maritime Law, Maritime Domain Awareness and Information Sharing, Counter-Narcotics, Force Protection, Asymmetric Threats, and maritime Uncrewed Systems.

LOKAYAN 2026 - INS Sudarshini Arrives In New York For Sail4th 250 Celebrations



- INS Sudarshini, the Indian Naval Sail Training Ship, arrived in New York Harbor for the United States International Naval Review 250 and Sail4th 250 celebrations.
- Sail4th 250 marks the 250th anniversary of the United States' independence. The events in New York are scheduled from 4 July to 8 July 2026,

Bangladesh and United States Launch Tiger Lightning 2026

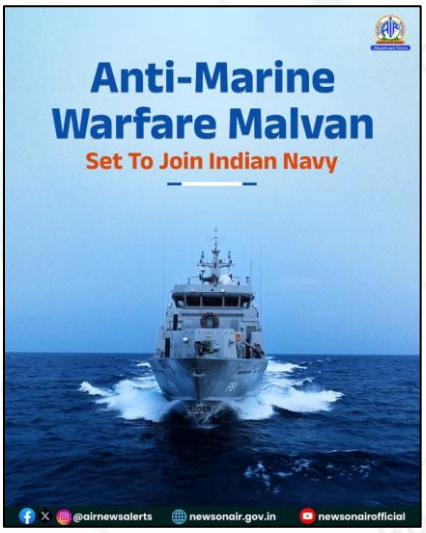
- Bangladesh and the United States began the annual bilateral military exercise Tiger Lightning 2026.
- The 2026 edition is scheduled for 13 days, from 19 July to 31 July 2026.



- The exercise began in 2017 and resumed after a pause during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Other Defence News

The Indian Navy is set to commission the Malvan Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC).



- It is the second of the Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC).
- It has been indigenously designed and constructed by Cochin Shipyard Limited.
- It draws its name from the historic coastal town of Malwan in Maharashtra,
- The ship also encapsulates the legacy of the erstwhile INS Malwan, an Indian Naval Minesweeper which remained in service till 2003.
- Features of Malwan – Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft
- Capacity: It has displacing capacity of 1,100 tons.
- Propulsion: It is Waterjets propelled ASW SWCs
- Armaments: It is equipped with torpedoes, multifunctional anti-submarine rockets, and state-of-the-art sensors including advanced radars and sonar systems.
- The ship is equipped for underwater surveillance, Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) operations in coastal waters, Low Intensity Maritime Operations (LIMO) along with mine warfare capabilities.

HAL to participate in Farnborough International Airshow 2026



- The Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) will showcase its indigenous programmes and display scaled models of LCA Tejas aircraft, Prachand Light Combat Helicopter, Advanced Light Helicopter 'Rudra', Dhruv NG helicopter and Light Utility Helicopter (LUH) at the Farnborough International Airshow 2026.
- The Farnborough International Airshow 2026 is being held from July 20-24 at Farnborough Airfield, Hampshire, United Kingdom .
- The HAL delegation will be led by its Chairman and Managing Director Ravi K.

Indonesia has signed MoU with BrahMos Aerospace



- Indonesia has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with BrahMos Aerospace for a phased procurement of two coastal missile batteries estimated at $200 million.
- BrahMos is a medium-range, universal supersonic cruise missile that operates on a distinct "Fire and Forget" Flying at a blistering speed of Mach 2.8, it holds the title of the fastest operational cruise missile in the world and is the only supersonic cruise missile available for export globally.
- Global Export from India: The Philippines, Vietnam and Indonesia.
- BrahMos uses a solid-fuel booster for rapid launch and acceleration, followed by a liquid-fuel ramjet engine that sustains supersonic cruise speed of Mach 2.8.
- **True Multi-Platform Universality: The missile can be launched from land, warships, submarines, and Su-30MKI aircraft, giving all three Indian Armed Forces a common precision-strike weapon.**
- Carrying a 200 kg warhead at Mach 2.8, BrahMos delivers enormous kinetic energy capable of destroying heavily fortified military targets.

▪ Export versions are limited to 290 km under MTCR norms, while India deploys extended-range variants exceeding 450 km for domestic use.

▪ India and Indonesia reached a significant milestone in their growing strategic cooperation by signing a deal for the supply of the Astra Mk 1 missiles.

▪ It is an indigenous Beyond Visual Range Air-to-Air missile (BVRAAM).

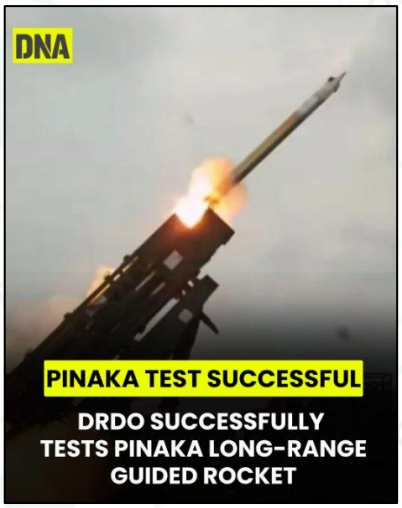
▪ It will be integrated with the Air Force and the Navy.

▪ It is developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).

▪ Speed and Range: It has a range of 80 to 110 km, an altitude of up to 20 km and a speed of Mach 4.5 (or 4.5 times the speed of sound).

▪ **Astra Mk 2 has an enhanced range of 200 km.**

DRDO Tests 60-km Pinaka Long-Range Guided Rocket



▪ Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) conducted a successful flight-test of Pinaka Long Range Guided Rocket (LRGR) at the Integrated Test Range (ITR), Chandipur on July 08, 2026.

▪ The rocket was tested for a user defined minimum range of 60 kms.

▪ The Pinaka LRGR rocket is designed by Armament Research and Development Establishment in association with High Energy Materials Research Laboratory, with support from Defence Research and Development Laboratory and Research Centre Imarat.

Army to Induct 450 Carl Gustaf M4 Rocket Launchers



▪ The Indian Army plans to induct 450 Carl Gustaf M4 variants of the battle-tested 84 mm shoulder-fired rocket launcher as part of its modernisation drive,

▪ **Designed by Swedish defence firm Saab, the lighter weapon is expected to enhance infantry firepower and operational effectiveness, particularly for troops deployed in the mountainous regions of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.**

▪ The Carl Gustaf M4 weighs less than seven kilograms, making it significantly lighter than the earlier M2 and M3 variants, which weighed 14 kg and 10 kg respectively.

▪ The launcher can accurately engage targets at distances of up to 1,000 metres, improving mobility and combat capability in demanding terrain.

▪ The Carl Gustaf M4 is designed to operate in extreme weather conditions.

▪ the launcher is effective in temperatures ranging from 50°C to minus 20°C, allowing deployment from the deserts of Rajasthan to the Himalayan frontier.

Drishti-10 Starliner



▪ A Board of Inquiry (BoI) has been ordered after an Indian Navy Drishti-10 Starliner unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) crashed near Dharampur village in Gujarat's Porbandar district during a routine training sortie recently.

▪ It is an advanced, indigenous unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV).

▪ It is a variant of Israel's Elbit Systems' Hermes 900 platform , built by Adani Defence and Aerospace at its Hyderabad facility under a technology transfer agreement.

▪ It is designed for intelligence, surveillance, and reconnaissance (ISR) missions and is a crucial asset for enhancing India's maritime and border security capabilities.

Drishti-10 Starliner Features

▪ It is a (Medium Altitude Long Endurance) UAV, which means it has the capability to fly high (usually 10,000 to 30,000 feet) and the endurance of continuous flight for up to 36 hours.

▪ It is equipped with the potential of carrying 450 kilograms of heavy and sophisticated sensors, communication gear, and radar units among others.

K9 Vajra-T



▪ After the successful collaboration on the K9 Vajra-T self-propelled howitzer, India and South Korea are set to deepen their defence partnership.

▪ It is a 155 mm, 52-caliber tracked self-propelled artillery system (howitzer).

▪ It is an Indian adaptation of South Korea's K9 Thunder 155 mm self-propelled howitzer.

▪ It is built by Larsen & Toubro with technology transferred from South Korean defence major Hanwha Defense based on its K9 Thunder.

▪ It has all-welded steel armour up to 19 mm thick.

▪ The main weapon is the 155mm /52 calibre gun capable of firing high-explosive, smoke, and guided projectiles.

▪ The gun weighs 50 tonnes and can fire 47 kg bombs.

▪ It can strike enemy targets at around 50 kilometres.

Navy to commission indigenous stealth frigate Mahendragiri this week



▪ The Indian Navy is set to commission its sixth Project 17A indigenous stealth frigate, Mahendragiri (F38), at Visakhapatnam on July 11

▪ It was designed by the Navy's Warship Design Bureau and built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited, Mumbai.

▪ The frigate is named after the Mahendragiri mountain range in the Eastern Ghats

▪ 'Mahendragiri' "is capable of undertaking anti-air, anti-surface and anti-submarine operations, and is equally suited for maritime security, power projection, humanitarian assistance and disaster relief (HADR), search and rescue,

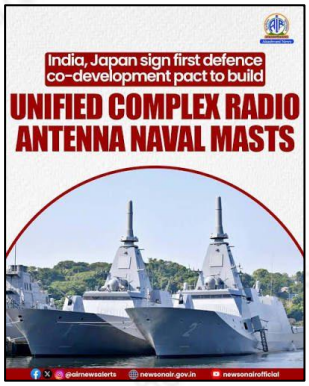
India, Japan sign first defence co-development pact to build UNICORN naval masts

▪ India and Japan have officially signed their first bilateral defence co-development agreement to jointly manufacture the cutting-edge UNICORN naval communication mast.

▪ UNICORN: It is an advanced, state-of-the-art system designed to integrate multiple communication systems and scattered antennas into a single, unified radar mast.

▪ the UNICORN mast significantly reduces a warship's radar cross-section (RCS).

▪ **UNICORN is also known as Nora-50 and is one of the best-quality weapon-grade antennas in the world.**



The Underwater Fiber Optic Sensing System (UFOSS)

▪ The DRDO has launched a major naval project to deploy an indigenous Underwater Fiber Optic Sensing System (UFOSS) on the Indian Ocean seabed to detect submarines and counter rising Chinese and Pakistani underwater activity.

▪ The Underwater Fiber Optic Sensing System (UFOSS) is a fixed, non-collapsible network of advanced undersea acoustic and hydrographic sensors anchored to the ocean floor.

▪ It serves as India's version of a strategic underwater surveillance grid, designed to provide continuous, long-term tracking of the undersea battlespace across contested maritime choke points.

Army Chief General Dhiraj Seth unveils 'VIJAY' roadmap for a future-ready force



▪ Chief of the Army Staff General Dhiraj Seth unveiled a transformation roadmap titled "VIJAY".

▪ Aim: To make the Indian Army a technology-enabled, future-ready, multi-domain force.

▪ The roadmap aligns with the Defence Minister's vision of the "Decade of Transformation".

VIJAY Framework:

▪ **V – Vigilance: Ensuring operational readiness and constant border alertness**

▪ **I** – Innovation & Transformation: Adoption of modern doctrines and advanced technologies

▪ **J – Jointness & Integration: Enhanced synergy among Army, Navy, and Air Force; Whole-of-Nation approach**

▪ **A – Atmanirbharta: Focus on indigenous technologies and self-reliance in defence**

▪ **Y** – Yodha First: Prioritising welfare and strength of soldiers, including Agniveers and veterans

15 July - Marks the 78th anniversary of the NCC in independent India

▪ **National Cadet Corps (NCC) was inaugurated to develop character, comradeship, ideals of service and capacity for leadership in the youth of the country**

▪ The present-day NCC under the Ministry of Defence came into existence on 16 Apr 1948 through the NCC Act.

▪ The NCC was formally inaugurated on 15 July 1948.

▪ the Girls Division of the NCC was started in July 1949

Raksha Mantri flagged-in 'Samudra Pradakshina'



- Raksha Mantri flagged-in 'Samudra Pradakshina', the first ever Tri-service all-women circumnavigation sailing expedition through video conferencing recently.
- It was the first ever Tri-service all-women circumnavigation.
- The expedition brought together officers from the Army, Navy and Air Force on a single mission.
- The expedition successfully fulfilled all internationally recognised criteria for a circumnavigation by
  - crossing all meridians of longitude;
  - crossing the Equator twice;
  - crossing the International Date Line; and
  - rounding the Three Great Capes – Cape Leeuwin (Australia), Cape Horn (South America) and the Cape of Good Hope (Africa).

India develops first indigenous expendable turbo jet engine in 350 kg thrust class

- India has developed its first indigenous Expendable Turbo Jet Engine in the 350 kg thrust class.
- The engine has been developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation's (DRDO) Gas Turbine Research Establishment (GTRE).
- GTRE had selected **Azad Engineering** as its industry partner for the manufacturing and assembly of the engine.

DRDO conducts successful maiden flight-test of 'Kusha' Long-Range Surface-to-Air Missile



- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) conducted the maiden flight test of the indigenous long-range surface-to-air missile (LRSAM) Kusha.
- The test took place from APJ Abdul Kalam Island off the coast of Odisha, and the missile intercepted an electronic target simulating a high-speed and high-altitude aerial threat.
- A long-range surface-to-air missile is a ground-launched air defence weapon designed to engage aerial targets at extended distances and altitudes.
- Such systems are used against fighter aircraft, unmanned aerial vehicles, cruise missiles, and other airborne threats.
- Project Kusha is an Indian air and missile defence programme that aims to create a multi-layered national shield by 2035.

Kheybar Shekan Missile



- Recently, Iran has been using the Kheybar Shekan missile in complex attacks, proving itself to be an adaptable adversary for the U.S.
- It is Iran's latest long-range solid-fuel ballistic missile.
- The name means "breaker of Khayber" in Arabic, a reference to the Battle of Khayber in Arab history.
- It is the fourth generation of the Khorramshahr missile family.

Kheybar Shekan Missile Features

- The missile is approximately 4 meters long and weighs 1,500 kilograms.
- It has a reported **range of around 1,450 km.**
- It is powered by a locally developed 'Arond' engine integrated within its fuel tank to minimise length and enhance camouflage.
- It uses solid fuel. This allows for faster launch preparation, easier storage, and better concealment, key advantages in modern missile warfare.
- It can be launched from a mobile platform and is ready in less than 15 minutes.
- The high-explosive warhead weighs approximately 550 kilograms.
- Its speed is said to reach 19,500 km/h in the atmosphere and 9,800 km/h outside it**, roughly Mach 12.**
- Due to this speed, it can make interception difficult even for advanced air defence systems.

Dark Eagle Hypersonic Missile



- The United States recently deployed the Dark Eagle hypersonic missile in Guam for the first time.
- The Dark Eagle, also known as the Long Range Hypersonic Weapon (LRHW), is a non-nuclear, ground-launched hypersonic missile system of the United States Army.
- It is the United States Army's first operational hypersonic missile system.
- The missile component of the LRHW is being developed by Lockheed Martin and Northrop Grumman.
- It is designed to strike targets at distances of up to 3,500 kilometers.
- The missile is launched via a two-stage solid-fuel booster that propels the glide vehicle into the upper atmosphere before it descends toward its target on an unpredictable trajectory.

88th CRPF personnel Raising Day

- Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)
- The CRPF began its journey **on July 27, 1939, as the Crown Representative Police.**
- It was **officially renamed the Central Reserve Police Force on December 28, 1949**, following the enactment of the Central Reserve Police Force Act.
- CRPF remains the only paramilitary force in India with six all-women battalions.

Cochin Shipyard launches seventh anti-submarine warfare vessel for Indian Navy



- Recently, the Machilipatnam (BY 529) Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC) was launched.
- It is the seventh of the Mahe-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC).
- It derives its name from the historic port city of Machilipatnam, in Krishna district of Andhra Pradesh.
- It is built by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) for the Indian Navy.
- It has a displacement of around 900 tonnes, a maximum speed of 25 knots and an endurance of 1,800 nautical miles.
- The ships are equipped with indigenously developed advanced systems, including hull-mounted sonar and low-frequency variable depth sonar, in line with the Government's Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.
- It is equipped for Underwater Surveillance, Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW) operations, and Low Intensity Maritime Operations (LIMO), along with Mine Warfare capability.

Raksha Mantri inaugurates Department of Military Medicine at Command Hospital in Lucknow

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched the country's first dedicated academic and operational department exclusively focused on military medicine.
- He virtually inaugurated the Department of Military Medicine at Command Hospital (Central Command) in Lucknow.
- The initiative aims to enhance combat medical readiness, advancing research, developing indigenous doctrines and creating specialised expertise for future battlefields and humanitarian contingencies.

Army Chief Launches Indigenous Xtreme Weather Grade Diesel



- General Dhiraj Seth, Chief of the Army Staff (COAS), launched the indigenously developed Xtreme Weather Grade (XWG) Diesel in New Delhi.
- Developed jointly by the Indian Army and Oil Marketing Companies, the specialised fuel will enhance the mobility, safety and operational availability of combat and logistics vehicles in extreme climatic conditions.
- Conventional diesel can thicken and clog fuel filters at very low temperatures, affecting the operation of vehicles in high-altitude and snow-bound areas.
- XWG Diesel overcomes this challenge and remains effective at temperatures as low as minus 42 degrees Celsius.

- Compliant with BS-VI standards and IS 1460:2025 specifications, it can be used in the Indian Army's existing vehicle fleet without any engine modification or re-homologation.

Indigenous Diving Support Vessel Nipun Delivered to Indian Navy



- Recently, the INS Nipun was delivered to the Indian Navy at Visakhapatnam. It is the second Diving Support Vessel (DSV) built by Hindustan Shipyard Limited.
- The vessel has been designed and constructed in accordance with Classification Rules of the Indian Register of Shipping (IRS).
- 'Nipun' draws her name from Sanskrit signifying 'one who is adept, capable, and well versed in a particular discipline'.
- This ship is highly specialised and is capable of undertaking deep sea dive operations and rescue operations at sea.
- The ship is installed with state-of-the-art Dive Equipment and has capability to undertake Deep Sea Saturation Diving.
- It is equipped with advanced dynamic positioning systems, saturation diving equipment, submarine rescue machinery, and deep-sea intervention tools.
- It would also serve as the Mother Ship for the Deep Submergence Rescue Vessel (DSRV), to evacuate personnel in case of an emergency in a submarine.

Science & Technology

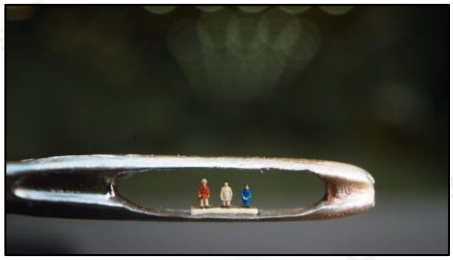
India's first private rocket Vikram-1 succeeds in maiden orbital launch



- Vikram-1, the country's first privately developed orbital-class rocket, lifted off from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota.
- Developed by Hyderabad-based space launch company Skyroot Aerospace, its maiden mission, named Mission Aagaman.
- Vikram-1 is designed to carry small satellites weighing up to 350 kg to Low Earth Orbit (LEO).
- Its inaugural flight will target a 450-km orbit with an inclination of 60 degrees.
- The seven-storey-tall, multi-stage launch vehicle has been built using an all-carbon composite structure and is powered by in-house developed solid and liquid propulsion systems.

Payloads to be launched by Vikram-1

- Vikram-1 will carry technology demonstration payloads from Grahaa Space, Cosmoserve, DCubed and Skyroot's own SCOPE.
- It will also carry Cosmos Diamonds' artwork Cosmic Bloom and a micro-art installation.
- Developed by Cosmos Diamonds, Cosmic Bloom features a diamond jewellery creation mounted on an aluminium base plate.
- **The micro-art installation, created by Ajay Kumar Mattewada, consists of an 18-carat gold rocket carrying microscopic sculptures of Sir C.V. Raman, Dr. Vikram Sarabhai and Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, alongside handwritten encouragement from Prime Minister Narendra Modi.**



- Each sculpture is smaller than a grain of rice and has been crafted inside the eye of a sewing needle.

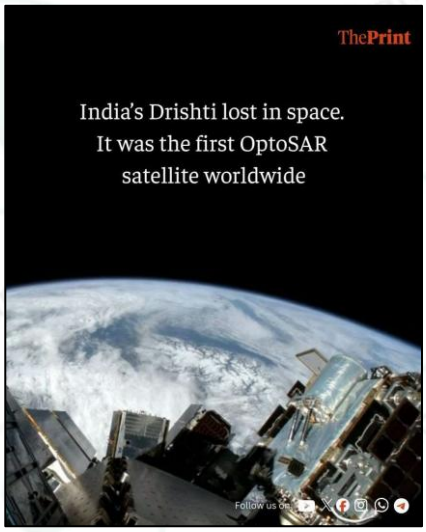
▪ The artwork pays tribute to the three visionaries whose contributions continue to inspire India's scientific and space pursuits.

▪ The mission will also carry an international payload, uD3PP and mD3RN, developed by Germany-based DCubed GmbH.

▪ During the mission, the robotic arm will remain attached to Vikram-1's payload deck while carrying out its planned demonstration.

▪ Mission Embrace aims to carry out what Cosmoserve describes as the world's first demonstration of soft robotic capture in orbit.

Mission Drishti: India's First OptoSAR Earth Observation Satellite



▪ Bengaluru-based space start-up GalaxEye announced that communication with Mission Drishti—the world's first OptoSAR satellite and India's largest privately built Earth observation satellite—has been lost.

▪ Mission Drishti is a next-generation, high-performance Earth observation satellite designed and engineered entirely within India's private sector.

▪ Weighing 190 kilograms, it represents a major technological milestone as the first operational spacecraft in global history to fuse optical and radar imaging sensors onto a single, compact satellite chassis.

▪ **Developed by GalaxEye, a deep-tech space start-up incubated out of Bengaluru.**

▪ Launch Vehicle & Site: Launched into orbit on May 3, 2026, aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket from the Vandenberg Space Force Base in California, USA.

Gaganyaan mission: ISRO successfully conducts first SOLVE ground test

▪ The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully carried out the first ground test of the Sub-Orbital Launch Vehicle for Experiments (SOLVE) solid motor was carried out successfully at the Static Test Facility, Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota.

▪ The SOLVE solid motor is a key component for conducting Gaganyaan Test Missions

▪ SOLVE a test platform to carry out Integrated Parachute Tests for validation of deceleration system of Gaganyaan's Crew Module under various test conditions.

▪ During these test missions, the Crew Module will be carried to an altitude of 10 - 17 km and separated from the vehicle.

ISRO Tests Main Parachutes for Gaganyaan Crew Module



▪ Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully conducted a critical Integrated Main parachute Airdrop Test (IMAT) for the Gaganyaan Missions at the Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (ADRDE) drop zone in Sheopur, Madhya Pradesh.

▪ The deceleration system of Gaganyaan Crew Module comprises of a total of 10 parachutes of 4 types.

▪ The objective of this test was to qualify the Main Parachute for its structural integrity & design margins under the maximum expected load conditions in the first uncrewed Gaganyaan G1 mission.

▪ The Gaganyaan Mission is India's ongoing project to send a 3-day manned mission to the Low Earth Orbit (LEO) of 400 km with a crew of 3 members and bring them safely back to Earth

BOHR (Betavoltaic Orbital High-Reliability)

▪ SpaceX has successfully launched what is being described as the world's first commercially built nuclear-powered satellite.

▪ The satellite, called BOHR (Betavoltaic Orbital High-Reliability), was developed by Florida-based company City Labs and lifted off ,aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket as part of the company's Transporter-17 rideshare mission from Vandenberg Space Force Base in California.

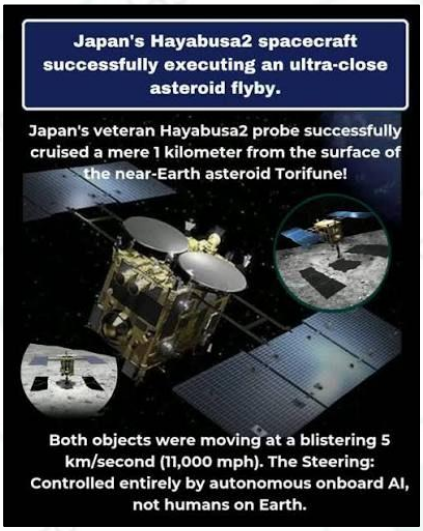
▪ BOHR is a demonstration mission designed to test City Labs' proprietary NanoTritium betavoltaic micropower source in space for the first time.

▪ NanoTritium generates electricity by using the beta particles released during the radioactive decay of tritium, a radioactive form of hydrogen.

▪ Those particles are converted directly into electrical energy using a semiconductor device.

▪ The technology differs from the radioisotope thermoelectric generators used on Nasa spacecraft such as the Voyager probes, which generate power from heat emitted by decaying plutonium.

Asteroid Torifune



▪ Japan's space agency announced that its deep-space probe, Hayabusa2, successfully performed an incredibly close flyby within 800 meters of the near-Earth asteroid Torifune.

▪ Torifune is a sub-kilometer, primitive near-Earth asteroid (NEA) that orbits the Sun in close proximity to Earth's orbital path. It serves as a high-value celestial target for both planetary science exploration and impact mitigation testing.

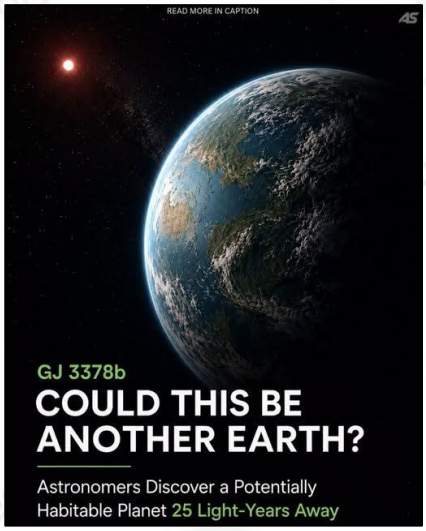
▪ It moves within a deep space trajectory that classifies it as a potentially hazardous near-Earth object (NEO).

▪ The asteroid has an estimated average diameter of approximately 450 meters.

▪ Hayabusa2 is a highly sophisticated, robotic deep-space exploration probe originally engineered for sample-return rendezvous operations.

▪ Following its successful 2020 delivery of pristine soil samples from the asteroid Ryugu, the spacecraft entered its Extended Mission phase (Hayabusa2#) to execute complex flyby missions across the solar system.

Scientists Discover Earth-Like Exoplanet GJ 3378b



▪ GJ 3378b is an exoplanet orbiting the red dwarf star Gliese 3378, which lies about 25 light-years from the Solar System in the northern constellation Camelopardalis.

▪ The planet, named GJ 3378b, is a 'super-Earth' roughly twice the size of our planet.

▪ It orbits a nearby red dwarf star within the star's habitable, or 'Goldilocks', zone - the region where temperatures are considered just right for liquid water to exist on a planet's surface.

The Long March 10B Rocket

▪ China successfully achieved its first reusable rocket landing at the Wenchang Commercial Space Launch Site, with the Long March 10B booster making a precise sea-based recovery after separation.

▪ The Long March 10B is an advanced, next-generation medium-to-heavy lift launch vehicle featuring a reusable first-stage booster.

▪ Implementing Organization: The rocket was researched, developed, and launched under the state-owned China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation (CASC).

▪ Aim: The objective of the Long March 10B program is to eliminate the economic barriers of traditional, single-use rocket launches.

Eärendil-1



▪ Recently, the U.S.Federal Communications Commission (FCC) authorized a company named Reflect Orbital to launch and operate a test satellite Eärendil-1 designed to deploy a large mirror in orbit around the earth.

▪ Its purpose is to reflect sunlight towards specific spots on the earth at nighttime.

▪ It is a single satellite in a non-geostationary orbit fit with a "deployable, highly specular thin-film reflector".

▪ The reflector will be motorised and can be steered to different orientations.

▪ It is intended to use this technology to extend the usable hours for solar panels and provide light during "critical operations" like emergency or humanitarian missions.

▪ **Orbital Profile: The satellite will operate at a LEO altitude between 600 kilometers and 650 kilometers.**

The Bundibugyo Virus Disease (BVD)

▪ The World Health Organization (WHO) has added the first molecular diagnostic test for Bundibugyo virus (BDBV) to its Emergency Use Listing (EUL).

▪ Bundibugyo virus disease (BVD) is a severe, highly infectious, and frequently fatal zoonotic disease in humans.



▪ It is caused by the Bundibugyo virus, which is one of the distinct viral species belonging to the Orthoebolavirus genus (commonly referred to as the Ebola virus group).

▪ **Fruit bats are the suspected natural reservoirs hosting the virus in wild ecosystems.**

▪ The virus spreads rapidly through direct contact with broken skin or mucous membranes coming into contact with the blood, organs, saliva, vomit, or other bodily fluids of infected individuals.

▪ It also spreads via contaminated surfaces, unsterilized medical gear, and unsafe traditional burial practices.

▪ Bundibugyo virus disease has a high mortality rate, with previous outbreaks recording 30–50% fatality.

▪ Early symptoms resemble malaria, typhoid, and other tropical fevers, making clinical diagnosis Confirmation requires PCR or antigen/antibody laboratory tests.

▪ There is no licensed vaccine or specific antiviral drug for Bundibugyo virus disease.

India Launches World's First Once-Weekly Insulin Awiqli



▪ India has launched Awiqli (insulin icodec), the world's first once-weekly basal insulin for adults with diabetes.

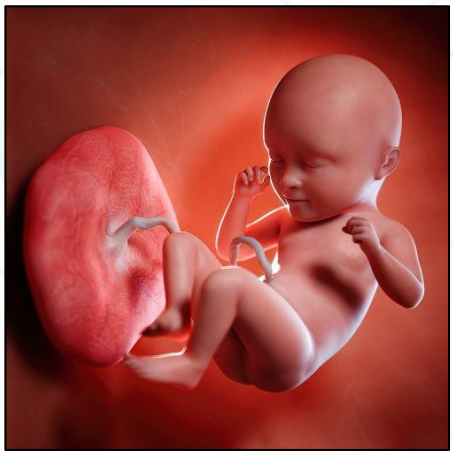
▪ Eligible patients may now need only one injection a week instead of a daily dose.

▪ Awiqli contains insulin icodec, a long-acting basal insulin designed to work over an entire week.

▪ It is a basal insulin (also known as background insulin), which helps maintain blood glucose levels between meals and overnight. However, it is not designed to manage the sharp rise in blood sugar that occurs after meals.

CDSCO Approves Wegovy for MASH Treatment

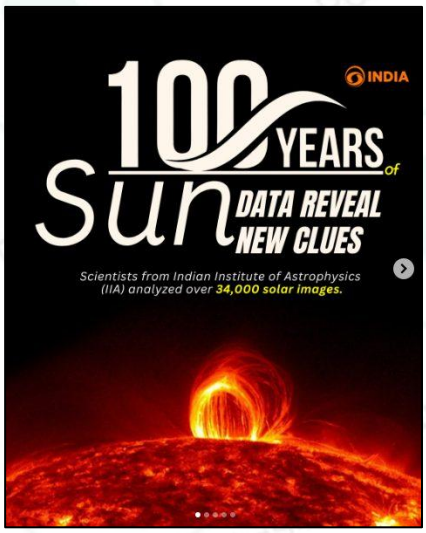
- The Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) has approved Novo Nordisk's Wegovy (semaglutide 2.4 mg) for the treatment of fatty liver disease, now called MASH (Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis).
- This is a serious, progressive form of fatty liver disease that causes chronic inflammation and liver damage.
- This is the first time an injectable GLP-1 therapy has been approved in India for this specific liver condition, in addition to its use for obesity.
- GLP-1 drugs mimic a natural gut hormone to regulate blood sugar, reduce appetite and slow digestion.



Indian scientists develop placenta-on-chip platform

- Indian researchers from Mumbai have developed a lab-grown placenta-on-chip platform that recreates key placental functions.
- The device is linked to pregnancy research, drug testing, and reduced dependence on animal models in biomedical studies.
- The work involves IIT Bombay and the Indian Council of Medical Research's National Institute for Research in Reproductive and Child Health, also known as NIRRCH, in Parel, Mumbai.
- The placenta-on-chip is a microfluidic device that models the human placenta in a controlled laboratory setting.
- The placenta is an organ that transfers oxygen and nutrients from the mother to the foetus and removes waste products from foetal blood.

AI studies 100 years of Sun images to track bright solar regions from the Kodaikanal Solar Observatory



- Researchers used Artificial Intelligence (AI) to analyse over a century-old hand-drawn solar observations.
- The data is sourced from the Kodaikanal Solar Observatory (KoSO).
- The study has created one of the longest continuous records of the Sun's magnetic activity.
- It provides new insights into the evolution of solar cycles over time.
- The study was led by Dibya Kirti Mishra from Aryabhatta Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES).
- ARIES is an autonomous institute under the Department of Science and Technology (DST).
- The research highlights the role of machine learning in converting historical astronomical data into scientific datasets.

Collaborating institutions include:

- Indian Institute of Space Science and Technology (IIST)
- Southwest Research Institute, USA
- Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA)



Kodaikanal Solar Observatory

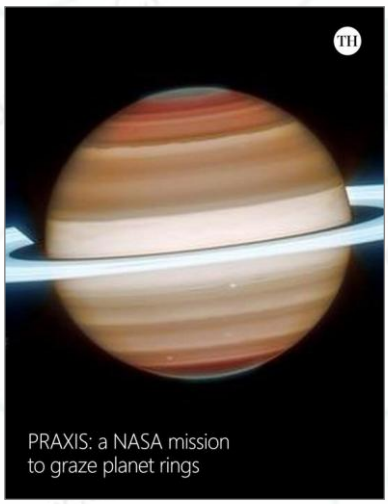
- The Kodaikanal Solar Observatory (KoSO) is India's oldest dedicated solar observatory established for the systematic study of the Sun and its influence on Earth.
- It was established in 1899 and is currently operated by the Indian Institute of Astrophysics.
- It is located at Kodaikanal on the southern tip of the Palani Hills at an altitude of over 2,000 metres.

Who is Anil Menon, the Indian-origin NASA astronaut of Malayali descent set to travel to space?



- Anil Menon, a NASA astronaut of Indian origin, is set to embark on an eight-month mission to the International Space Station (ISS).
- He will launch aboard the Soyuz MS-29 from the Baikonur Cosmodrome, Kazakhstan, along with two Russian cosmonauts.
- Dr. Menon, 49, is an emergency medicine physician and a Colonel in the U.S. Space Force.
- He has also served on the front lines in Afghanistan during Operation Enduring Freedom.

PRAXIS Mission



- NASA has just selected a mission concept called 'PRAXIS' for its Innovative Advanced Concepts (NIAC) 2026 phase I funding.
- PRAXIS is an acronym of 'Planetary Rings Autonomous EXploration with In-situ Sampling' is designed to collect and study ring particles directly.
- It is conceptualized by NASA.
- It will transform understanding of ring structure and origins for Saturn (dense), Uranus and Neptune (tenuous), rings of other objects such as Centaurs Chariklo and Chiron.
- It will consist of a bio-inspired robotic explorer driven by an AI model, and will be capable of directly sampling particles from planetary ring systems.
- It combines robotic autonomy for collision avoidance, precision sampling, and on-site analysis.
- It also uses technology inspired by sport casting to capture free-floating particles and miniaturised instruments for real-time scientific analysis.
- It currently plans to just graze the ring plane.

China Launches Gravity-1 Rocket with Nine Satellites



- Chinese commercial space company Orienspace launched nine satellites into orbit using its Gravity-1 rocket in the vehicle's first long-range sea launch mission from the East China Sea.
- Gravity-1 is a solid-fuel carrier rocket developed by Orienspace, a private Chinese commercial launch company.
- The rocket is described as the world's most powerful solid-fuel rocket.
- The Gravity-1 series completed its third successful flight with this mission.
- The nine satellites included Dongpo-13, Dongpo-14, Dongpo-17, Dongpo-18, Dongpo-19, Dongpo-20, Xiguang-2 01, Tianyi-49, and Lilac-3, which is also called Zidingxiang-3.
- The Dongpo satellites are designed for all-weather and all-time Earth observation.

India's First eVTOL Aircraft (e200X)



- Chennai-headquartered deep-tech startup The ePlane Company (incubated at IIT Madras) unveiled e200X (PT-01), India's first full-scale prototype of an electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) aircraft.
- An electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) aircraft—often termed an electric air taxi—is a zero-emission, battery-powered aircraft that lifts off and lands vertically like a

helicopter before transitioning to forward winged flight like a conventional airplane.

- Developed By: The e200X platform was engineered, designed, and assembled in-house by The ePlane Company.

QDENGA: India's first approved dengue vaccine

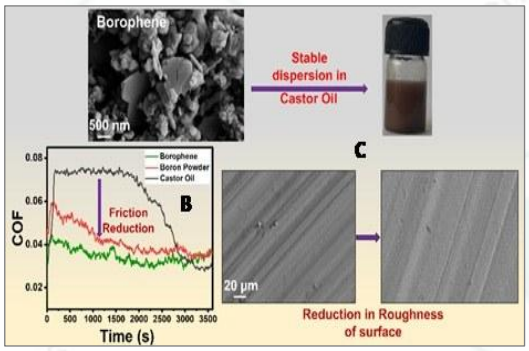


- The Drug Controller General of India (DCGI) recently granted market authorisation to Takeda Biopharmaceuticals India's QDENGA (TAK-003), making it the **first dengue vaccine to be approved in the country.**

About QDENGA (TAK-003)

- It is a dengue vaccine developed by **the Japanese pharmaceutical company Takeda.**
- It is the first dengue vaccine to be approved in India.
- The vaccine has been approved for the **prevention of dengue in individuals aged four to 60.**
- QDENGA is a live-attenuated (weakened) tetravalent vaccine designed to provide protection against all four dengue virus serotypes (DENV-1 to DENV-4).
- It is administered as a two-dose regimen, with doses given three months apart.
- The vaccine can be administered irrespective of whether an individual has had a previous dengue infection and does not require pre-vaccination screening.
- The vaccine has already been approved in more than 40 countries, including the European Union, the United Kingdom, Brazil, Indonesia, and Argentina.

Borophene



- Scientists in India recently achieved a significant breakthrough in sustainable lubrication by demonstrating, for the first time, the use of borophene as a high-performance lubricant additive in castor oil.
- It is an allotrope of boron.
- It is composed of a single-atom-thick sheet of boron atoms arranged in a two-dimensional (2D) lattice.

Properties:

- It is known for its ultra-light weight, flexibility, and exceptional strength.
- It has excellent properties, including thermal and electrical conductivity, high capacitance, metallic nature, etc.
- Borophene is mainly used in a range of applications in the fields of thin-layer electronics, optoelectronics, capacitors, and biosensors.

India Orders GitHub to Remove Bitchat App

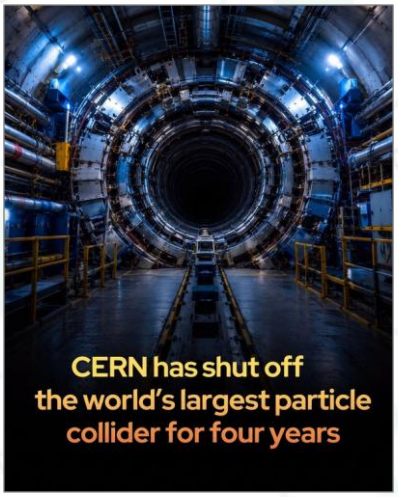


- The Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre, has ordered Microsoft subsidiary GitHub to remove Bluetooth-based messaging application Bitchat.
- The application enables anonymous communication without mandatory user registration, phone number verification, or centralised logging of communications.
- The notice comes after several users participating in a protest organised by the Cockroach Janata Party at Jantar Mantar were observed using Bluetooth-based messaging apps after the government imposed temporary restrictions on internet services around the protest site.

The Large Hadron Collider (LHC)

- CERN officially switched off the Large Hadron Collider (LHC) to begin its 4-year Long Shutdown 3 (LS3).

- The temporary pause allows engineers to perform a major $1.5 billion hardware upgrade, transforming the machine into the High-Luminosity LHC (HL-LHC).
- The Large Hadron Collider (LHC) is the world's largest, highest-energy, and most powerful particle accelerator.
- Built by the European Organization for Nuclear Research (CERN), it accelerates subatomic particles (protons or heavy lead ions) to near the speed of light and smashes them together to study fundamental physics and the origin of the universe.
- Built in a circular underground tunnel situated approximately 100 meters (328 feet) beneath the France–Switzerland border near Geneva.
- Famous for experimentally confirming the Higgs Boson (God Particle) in 2012, completing the theoretical framework of the Standard Model of particle physics.



Why It Is Shutting Down (Long Shutdown 3)?

- Over the 4-year shutdown period, engineers will replace 1.2 kilometers of the tunnel to install new superconducting niobium-tin quadrupole magnets, advanced crab cavities, and updated subdetectors.
- The upgrade will increase collision rates from 60 to up to 200 simultaneous collisions per beam crossing.
- Boosting total collision data by ten times enables physicists to study extremely rare subatomic events, measure Higgs boson properties with unprecedented accuracy, and search for dark matter particles when operations resume in 2030.

25 years of the successful operations of the Himalayan Chandra Telescope (HCT)

- 25 years of the successful operations of the Himalayan Chandra Telescope (HCT) atop Hanle in Ladakh was recently celebrated with a conference highlighting its history, engineering challenges, scientific research, and the road ahead.
- It is a 2 meter optical-infrared telescope named after Nobel laureate **Subramaniam Chandrasekhar.**
- It is located at the Indian Astronomical Observatory (IAO) in Hanle near Leh in Ladakh.
- It is currently the tenth highest optical telescope in the world, situated at an elevation of 4,500 meters.
- The cloudless skies and low atmospheric water vapour make it one of the best sites in the world for optical, infrared, sub-millimetre, and millimetre wavelengths.
- The telescope saw its 'First Light' on 26 September 2000, and was dedicated to the nation in August 2001.
- The telescope is remotely operated using a dedicated satellite communication link from the Centre for Research & Education in Science & Technology (CREST), Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), Hosakote, about 35 km northeast of Bangalore.

The Kimi K3 AI Model



- Chinese AI startup Moonshot AI unveiled Kimi K3, introducing the world's first open-source model in the 3-trillion-parameter class.
- Kimi K3 is a multimodal, open-weight reasoning large language model (LLM) designed for complex software engineering, long-horizon coding, visual reasoning, and enterprise knowledge work. Built with 8 trillion total parameters, it stands as the largest open-source AI model released to date.
- Parent Company: **Moonshot AI** (a Beijing-based artificial intelligence unicorn backed by tech giants including Alibaba, Tencent, and Meituan).

Blue Straggler Star (BSS)



- Indian astronomers from the Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), along with international collaborators, have reported the rare discovery of a Blue Straggler Star (BSS) actively forming in the binary system TIC 327546480.
- A Blue Straggler Star (BSS) is an unusually hot, luminous, blue, and massive star found within old star clusters (globular or open clusters).
- While standard theories of stellar evolution dictate that stars of such high mass should have burned through their nuclear fuel and evolved into white dwarfs or red giants long ago, these stars appear much younger than the surrounding cluster population—effectively lagging behind or straggling in their evolutionary timeline.
- First observed by Allan Sandage in 1953 in the globular cluster M3, Blue Stragglers are formed when an older star gains extra hydrogen fuel.
- Blue Straggler Stars (BSS) appear younger and hotter than other stars in the same ancient cluster, even though they formed at the same time.
- In TIC 327546480, the smaller companion star continuously transfers gas to the larger Blue Straggler Star, causing it to gain mass.
- As the BSS receives gas from its companion, it also gains angular momentum, making it spin much faster.

SHetA2 Drug Emerges as Potential Breakthrough in Blocking HPV-Induced Cervical Cancer Therapy



- Recently, a new cervical cancer SHetA2 pill showed promise by stopping Human Papillomavirus (HPV) from turning cancerous.
- SHetA2 is a small molecule therapy that is designed to stop an HPV infection from causing cancer.
- Small molecule therapies are chemically manufactured, low-weight compounds that can easily be absorbed by the body.
- It is designed to treat HPV-induced cervical dysplasia and cervical cancer.

Key Facts about Human Papillomavirus (HPV)

- HPV is the most common sexually transmitted infection (STI), and there are more than 100 types of HPV.
- However, some types of HPV infection cause skin growths called warts, and some types of HPV infection can cause cancer.
- The virus that causes HPV infection is transmitted through skin-to-skin contact.
- Most people get a genital HPV infection through direct sexual contact.
- Symptoms may include warts on the genitals or anus or cancerous growths in the mouth or throat.
- Treatment: There's no cure for HPV. HPV vaccination is the most effective way to prevent HPV-related cancers

Alanine aminotransferase

- Recently, the Union Health Ministry has urged people to monitor alanine aminotransferase (ALT) levels as an early indicator of liver injury.
- It is also known as serum glutamic-pyruvic transaminase (SGPT), is an enzyme found predominantly inside liver cells.
- It is also found in other tissues such as the kidneys, heart, and muscle cells.
- It plays a crucial role in metabolism, turning food into energy.

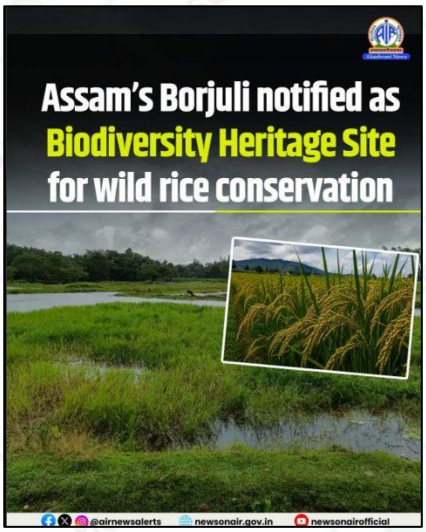
- ALT is one component of the liver function test, which includes other liver enzymes and measures of liver function.
- The ALT test is often part of an initial screening for liver disease.

What is an ALT Test?

- An ALT test is also known as a serum glutamic-pyruvic transaminase (SGPT) test or an alanine transaminase test.
- When liver cells are damaged or inflamed, ALT leaks into the bloodstream. This causes serum ALT levels to rise.
- An increase in ALT is often the first sign of a liver problem, and ALT is often elevated before other symptoms appear.
- ALT testing is performed on a blood sample

Environment

Assam: Borjuli Site in Sonitpur Notified as Biodiversity Heritage Site



- The Borjuli wetland in Assam, known for harbouring a disease and pest-resistant variety of wild rice, has been notified as a Biodiversity Heritage Site (BHS).
- The wild rice species, Oryza rufipogon, is the progenitor of present-day cultivated rice, Oryza sativa.
- It is resistant to pests and diseases and can tolerate flooding and saline conditions, making it a valuable genetic resource for developing climate-resilient crop varieties.
- The recognition follows the implementation of the project, "In-situ Conservation and Management of Wild Rice (Oryza rufipogon) in Sonitpur District of Assam," which has been underway since 2022.
- Funded by the National Rainfed Area Authority (NRAA) under the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.
- The project is being executed by the ICAR–National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (ICAR-NBPGR), New Delhi, in collaboration with the Assam State Biodiversity Board.

Mizoram's Natural History Museum notified as India's 21st Designated Repository

- The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has designated the Natural History Museum (NHM), Mizoram University, Aizawl, as a Designated Repository under Section 39 of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.
- NHM becomes India's 21st Designated Repository,
- The NHM will maintain voucher specimens of select flora, including pteridophytes and macrofungi, and fauna such as reptiles, amphibians, fishes, moths, beetles and butterflies.
- It will also serve as the designated depository for type specimens of newly discovered species from the region.
- Established in 2022 under the aegis of Mizoram University, a Central University established by an Act of Parliament.

BIS Introduces India's First Mangrove Restoration Standards



- The Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) is set to introduce an Indian standard for the restoration of mangrove ecosystems, marking the country's first such set of guidelines for the restoration of biodiversity, which will help streamline restoration efforts in the Sundarbans.
- The draft Indian Standard, titled 'Restoration of Mangrove Ecosystem — Guidelines', was made public in March and has received hundreds of inputs since then.

▪ The framework aims to shift away from simple mono-species plantations toward scientific, biodiverse recovery, improving ecological resilience in the Sundarbans and across the country

▪ BIS is India's national standards body under the BIS Act, 2016.

▪ It develops Indian Standards through technical committees, draft publication, stakeholder consultation, and final notification.

Aldrin Causes Crocodile Deaths in Kota

▪ Recently, an investigation has revealed that a banned pesticide named Aldrin was responsible for the deaths of mugger crocodiles (Crocodylus palustris) in the Chandraloi river of Rajasthan's Kota district.

What is Aldrin?

▪ It is a pesticide from the organochlorine group.

▪ It has been included in the list of banned pesticides by the Government of India because it persists in the environment for a long time and pollutes soil and water.

▪ It gradually accumulates in the food chain and can have serious adverse effects on the nervous system of humans and wildlife

Radio Telemetry



▪ Radio telemetry data helped conservationists repeatedly protect the radio-tagged White-rumped vulture Z25, but the bird was ultimately killed in a collision with a power transmission line.

▪ Radio telemetry involves using radio waves to automatically transmit data from remote or inaccessible sources to a receiving station for monitoring and analysis.

▪ It is commonly used in wildlife tracking, weather monitoring, industrial process control, and medical monitoring to gather data without needing physical access to the source

▪ Radio telemetry uses radio signals, which are made up of invisible and silent electromagnetic waves, to determine location.

▪ A radio telemetry system is made up of three parts: a radio transmitter, a radio antenna, and a radio receiver.

Transcaspian marinka

▪ The indigenous Sangno clan of Arunachal Pradesh has launched a community-led translocation drive in the East Kameng district to conserve the endangered Himalayan ray-finned fish (Schizothorax pelzami).

▪ The Himalayan ray-finned fish (Schizothorax pelzami), commonly known as the Transcaspian marinka and locally called Ngarsing in the Nyishi language, is a specialized freshwater species belonging to the carp and minnow family (Cyprinidae).



▪ Native to the high-altitude, fast-flowing mountain streams, rivers, and cold-water torrents of the sub-Himalayan and Transcaspian zones.

▪ Thrives in clean, well-oxygenated, snow-fed glacial streams at high elevations.

▪ IUCN Red List Status: Least Concern

Animal Discoveries and Plant Discoveries 2025

▪ The Union Minister for Environment, Forest, and Climate Change recently released several critical publications, notably Animal Discoveries–2025 and Plant Discoveries–2025, during the 111th Foundation Day of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) in Kolkata.

▪ The Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), the country's premier institution for faunal exploration and research, publishes Animal Discoveries every year detailing the new discoveries of fauna.

▪ Similarly, the Botanical Survey of India (BSI), the country's premier organisation for plant research and taxonomy, publishes Plant Discoveries every year detailing the new discoveries of flora.

Highlights of Animal Discoveries 2025

▪ India added 709 new species to its fauna in 2025, which includes 483 species new to science and 226 species recorded for the first time in India.

▪ India's total faunal biodiversity now reaches 105,953 species.

▪ Among the states, Kerala recorded the highest number of new species (98), followed by West Bengal (76), Karnataka (67), and Arunachal Pradesh (65).

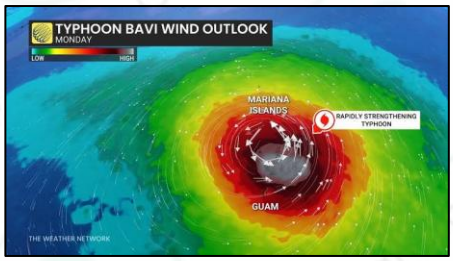
Highlights of Plant Discoveries 2025

▪ It records the addition of 353 taxa to the country's floral inventory, comprising 339 species and 14 infraspecific taxa.

▪ Of these, 221 taxa have been described as new to science, while 132 taxa represent new distributional records for India.

▪ Among the states, Arunachal Pradesh emerged as the leading contributor with 49 discoveries, followed by Uttarakhand (39) and Kerala (37).

Projected 'super typhoon' barrels towards U.S. Pacific islands



▪ Typhoon Bavi is rapidly intensifying in the western Pacific Ocean as it tracks directly toward the U.S. Mariana Islands

▪ It will escalate into a catastrophic Category 5-equivalent super typhoon.

▪ Typhoon Sinlaku hit the same region in mid-April 2026, just over two months ago.

Kutki - Picrorhiza kurroa



- Farmers in the Mandi district of Himachal Pradesh have pioneered a sustainable, stolon-based cultivation and harvesting model for Kutki (Picrorhiza kurroa).
- Kutki (botanical name: Picrorhiza kurroa Royle ex. Benth; also known in Ayurveda as Katuki or Katukarohini) is a high-value, creeping perennial medicinal herb.
- Derived from the Greek word Picros (bitter) and Rhiza (root), it is famous for its intense bitter taste and therapeutic properties.
- Native to the cold, alpine, and sub-alpine regions of the Himalayas at altitudes ranging between 2,700 and 4,500 meters above sea level.
- Thrives on moist, rocky, north-west facing slopes with well-drained, porous sandy-clay soil that allows its rhizomes to spread horizontally.
- Geographic Spread: Distributed across the Himalayan belt of India (Jammu & Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Sikkim), as well as Nepal, Bhutan, Pakistan, Tibet, Western China, and Northern Myanmar.
- IUCN Red List: Categorized as Endangered due to severe population decline caused by overexploitation and destructive wild harvesting.
- CITES Status: Listed in Appendix II, which permits international trade only under strictly regulated export permits.

Allographa



- Recently, a team of researchers has unveiled five new species of lichen-forming fungi belonging to the genus Allographa.
- The recently discovered five new Allographa species from Western Ghats are: Allographa keralensis, A. paraconsanguinea; A. persistinspersa ,A. semicarbonisata and Allographa nayakae: Honoring the prominent Indian lichenologist Dr. Sanjeeva Nayaka.

- It is a genus of script lichens or lichen-forming fungi (a fungus that teams up with algae or cyanobacteria to create a lichen) with elongated fruiting bodies in the family Graphidaceae.
- It has more than 200 species and in India these Allographa species are limited, particularly from the Western Ghats.
- These are highly sensitive to pollution, climate shifts and habitat disturbance, making them reliable indicators of ecosystem health.

What are Lichens?

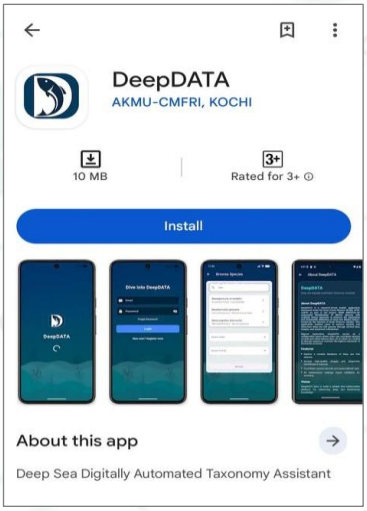
- Lichens are not just one organism but two (sometimes more) living in intimate symbiosis: a fungus that offers structure and protection, and a photobiont (usually a green alga or cyanobacterium) that captures sunlight and makes food.

A new species of ginger lily named Hedychium zubeengargianum was recently discovered in Shillong.



- It is a new species of ginger lily.
- It was identified by botanists at the Botanical Survey of India (BSI), Eastern Regional Centre, Shillong, Meghalaya.
- The species was named after Meghalaya-born Assamese music legend Zubeen Garg.
- Popularly known as ginger lilies, Hedychium species are among the Northeast's most striking flowering plants.

CMFRI Launches DeepDATA App for Deep-Sea Fish Documentation



- The ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI) launched DeepDATA as a mobile application for deep-sea fish documentation.
- The app provides scientifically verified information on deep-sea fish species and allows users to upload field observations for a national digital repository.
- It is designed as both a learning platform and a documentation tool for students, researchers, fishermen, and marine enthusiasts.
- The app includes species-level information on taxonomy, identifying features, distribution, and conservation status.
- DeepDATA was developed under the Deep Ocean Mission project with funding from the Ministry of Earth Sciences, Government of India.

Typhoon Noul makes landfall in China

- Typhoon Noul made landfall and was bringing winds and heavy rain to southern China, including Hong Kong.
- maximum sustained winds of 145 kph (90 mph) near its centre,

ANNAM.AI Smart Weather Stations Deployed in Kerala

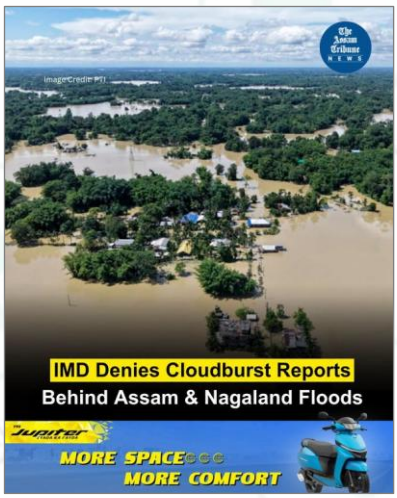
- Kerala has begun integrating ANNAM.AI smart weather stations under its 100-day action plan for climate-smart agriculture .
- The stations use artificial intelligence to provide hyper-local weather and farm data for decision-making at the field level.
- ANNAM.AI is a Centre of Excellence for Artificial Intelligence in Agriculture at IIT Ropar, which functions with support from the Ministry of Education

Malvi Camel Faces Extinction Threat

- The rare Malvi camel breed, one of the nine recognised camel breeds in India, is facing a serious threat of extinction with only 102 animals remaining
- The Malvi camel is the smallest camel breed in India and is known for its white coat.

- It is valued for milk production, and females yield about 4 to 5 kg of milk per cycle.
- The breed is mainly found in the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh and in parts of Rajasthan.
- It has been classified as endangered

Cloudburst



- Recently, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) rejected reports that Assam and Nagaland had experienced cloudbursts over the preceding few days and that they were responsible for the Upper Assam floods.
- A cloudburst is an extreme weather phenomenon characterized by an intense and sudden downpour of rain.
- It can also occur in plains, the phenomenon is most common in hilly regions.
- According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), a cloudburst occurs when a small area, around 20-30 sq. km, receives 10 cm or more of rain in an hour.
- Impact: Short spells of very heavy rainfall over a small geographical area can cause widespread destruction.
- It typically begins with convection, when warm, moist air rises rapidly into the atmosphere.
- In mountainous areas, this is called orographic lifting, where monsoon winds are forced upwards by steep slopes.
- As the air rises, it cools and condenses into towering cumulonimbus clouds, which can be up to 15 km tall.
- Water droplets begin to form inside these clouds and, as they get heavier, they would normally fall as rain.
- However, if the currents of warm air moving upwards are very strong, they can keep the raindrops suspended in the air for longer.
- Eventually, the weight of the water droplets becomes too great for gravity and the updrafts to hold, or the updrafts weaken, sending the water plummeting down like an ocean descending on the ground

Index/rankings/reports

Gujarat tops NITI Aayog's first Investment Friendliness Index 2026 among major States



- NITI Aayog launched the inaugural Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) to benchmark and promote state-level business reforms under the Viksit Bharat @2047 vision.
- The Investment Friendliness Index is a comprehensive, structured, and evidence-based macroeconomic assessment framework.
- It evaluates how effectively India's subnational governments create, enable, and sustain an environment that attracts domestic and foreign private capital.
- Published By: The index is developed and published by NITI Aayog (the National Institution for Transforming India).
- Aim: The objective of the IFI is to strengthen the spirit of competitive and cooperative federalism across subnational governance.
- Four-Tier Performance Banding: States and UTs are grouped into four clear performance cohorts based on their cumulative scores:

1. Top Performers (scores above 50)

2. Frontrunners (45–50)

3. Emerging Performers (≥40 – <45)

4. Aspiring States (below 40)

- Equitable Peer-Group Comparisons: Recognizing geography and economic scale, the index splits regions into three distinct peer groups: Large States, Hilly & North-Eastern States, and Union Territories & City States.

Key Findings:

- Top Performers: Only five states scored above 50—Gujarat (56.6), Maharashtra (53.7), Tamil Nadu (53.3), Goa (53.1), and Odisha.
- Drivers of Success: Gujarat excelled in ports and infrastructure; Maharashtra in business climate and PE/VC investment; Tamil Nadu in exports and manufacturing.
- FDI Concentration: Maharashtra, Karnataka, Gujarat, Delhi, and Tamil Nadu account for 85% of India's FDI, while the Northeast receives less than 1%.
- Investment Trends: Total investment reached 29.9% of GDP (FY2025), led by government infrastructure and household real estate spending.
- Private Capex Gap: Private capital expenditure (8.7% of GDP) continued to lag behind public investment, highlighting the need to boost private sector participation.

The leaderboard

Investment Friendliness Index: Top 10

State	Score (out of 100)	State	Score (out of 100)
Gujarat	56.6	Delhi	49.9
Maharashtra	53.7	Madhya Pradesh	48.9
Tamil Nadu	53.3	Andhra Pradesh	48.7
Goa	53.1	Karnataka	48.7
Odisha	52.4	Rajasthan	48.1

Leading large states in...

Infrastructure		Business climate	
State	Score (out of 25)	State	Score (out of 20)
Gujarat	13.7	Maharashtra	9.4
Tamil Nadu	13.6	Karnataka	9.3
Kerala	12.6	Tamil Nadu	9.2
West Bengal	12.3	Gujarat	9.2
Andhra Pradesh	12.1	Haryana	8.0

Delhi Ranks 120th in Global Liveability Index

- Recently, Global Liveability Index 2026 was released and Delhi at 120 among 173 cities.
- It is published by the Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU).
- Its purpose is to evaluate how suitable cities are for living by measuring everyday living conditions rather than economic size or tourist popularity.
- Coverage: It assesses 173 cities across the world across 30 indicators.
- **Parameters: It is grouped into five categories namely**
- Stability (25%)
- Healthcare (20%)
- Culture & Environment (25%)
- Education (10%)
- Infrastructure (20%)
- Score: It uses a 1–100 scale.



Key Highlights of Global Liveability Index

- The report finds that although the global average liveability score remained unchanged at 76.1 out of 100.
- Among the five categories, healthcare registered the strongest year-on-year improvement, increasing by an average of 0.74 points.
- Global Top Cities: Copenhagen (Denmark) remains the world's most liveable city, edging out Vienna (Austria) and Melbourne (Australia).
- India: New Delhi ranked 120, followed by Mumbai (121), Chennai (123), and Bengaluru (127).

Global Passport Index

- India's ranking in the Global Passport Index (GPI) has slipped to 125th spot, one rank drop from last year.
- The Strongest passports of this year's index are (TOP 5): Sweden, Switzerland, Finland, Germany, the Netherlands and Denmark both rank 5th
- It ranks passports not only on the ease of



international travel but also on the benefits they offer for living, working and investing in other countries.

- It is a comprehensive passport ranking that goes beyond measuring the number of countries passport holders can travel to without a visa.
- Published by: It is published by residency and citizenship advisory firm Global Citizen Solutions (GCS).
- It measures passports across three key categories: Enhanced Mobility (50 per cent), Investment (25 per cent) and Quality of Living (25 per cent).
- Namibia ranked just above India at the 124th spot, while Azerbaijan ranked one spot below India at the 126th spot.

IAF Ranks Third in WDMMA Global Air Power List



- The Indian Air Force (IAF) has retained its position as the world's third most powerful air force for the fifth consecutive year in the World Directory of Modern Military Aircraft (WDMMA) 2026 Global Air Power Rankings.
- The WDMMA evaluates 129 air services across 103 countries and analyses more than 48,000 military aircraft worldwide.
- Its proprietary True Value Rating (TVR) system assesses fleet size along with aircraft mix, technological sophistication, logistics, modernisation and overall operational capability.
- The IAF ranks third among the world's air forces and sixth overall when air arms of the Army, Navy and Air Force are considered together.
- The top overall rankings are led by the US Air Force, followed by the US Navy, Russian Air Force, US Army, US Marines and the IAF.
- China's air force is ranked seventh, followed by Japan, Israel and France.
- The Pakistan Air Force (PAF) in 18th.

Rank	Air arm	Aircraft	TVR
1	US Air Force	5,004	242.9
2	US Navy	2,504	142.4
3	Russian Air Force	3,677	114.2
4	US Army	4,333	112.6
5	US Marines	1,211	85.3
6	Indian Air Force	1,716	69.4
7	Chinese Air Force	3,733	63.8
8	Japan Air Self-Defense Force	756	58.1
9	Israeli Air Force	581	56.3
10	French Air Force	511	55.3

Performance Grading Index

- Recently, the Union Ministry of Education released the Report on Performance Grading Index 2.0 for States/UTs (PGI-S) and Performance Grading Index for Districts (PGI-D) for 2025-26.
- It is an index that measures the performance of states in school education undertaken by the Department of School Education &Literacy (DoSEL).
- PGI strives to evaluate the relative performance of all the State/UTs and districts respectively in a uniform scale to encourage them to perform better.
- The PGI 2.0 is constructed based on 73 indicators from 2 Categories containing 6 Domains

Performance Grading Index (PGI) – States/UTs

- It is devised by the Department of School Education & Literacy, Union Ministry of Education.
- It consists of 2 Categories:
- Outcome and Governance & Management; comprising six domains:

1. Learning Outcomes and Quality
2. Access
3. Infrastructure & Facilities
4. Equity
5. Governance Processes
6. Teachers Education & Training

- The framework is fully aligned with data from the Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+), PARAKH Rashtriya Sarvekshan 2024, PM POSHAN Portal, PRABAND Portal, and Vidyanjali Portal.

Performance Grading Index (PGI) – Districts

- Objective: Assessing districts on a common parameter with attention now shifting towards outcome measurement of educational policies.
- Total weightage: It comprises a total weightage of 600 points across 70 indicators, which are grouped under 6 categories viz., Outcomes, Effective Classroom Transaction, Infrastructure Facilities & Student Entitlements, School Safety & Child Protection, Digital Learning and Governance Process.

The UDISE Report 2025–26

- The Union Ministry of Education officially released the comprehensive report on the Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) for the academic year 2025-26.
- The Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) is one of the largest management information systems in the world, covering more than 14.8 lakh schools, 1.02 crore teachers, and over 26 crore students across India.
- it serves as the foundational analytical engine for the government to track educational parameters, allocate fiscal resources, and fine-tune policies in alignment with the National Education Policy (NEP).

Key Indicators and Facts in the 2025-26 Report

Decline in Dropout Rates

- The academic year 2025-26 witnessed a notable reduction in dropout rates across preparatory and secondary levels compared to previous years:
- Preparatory level: Dropout rate declined from 2.3% in 2024-25 to 1.8% in 2025-26.
- Secondary level: Dropout rate declined from 8.2% in 2024-25 to 7.0% in 2025-26.
- However, the highest dropout rates at the secondary level were recorded in Ladakh, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, and Karnataka

Improvement in Student Retention

- **Student retention has shown a positive trend at higher levels:**
- Middle level: Retention increased from 82.8% (2024-25) to 83.7% (2025-26).
- Secondary level: Retention increased significantly from 47.2% (2024-25) to 51.9% (2025-26).

Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER)

- The GER at the secondary level improved considerably:
- From 68.5% in 2024-25 to 71.7% in 2025-26.
- For the first time in any academic year, the total number of school teachers crossed 1.02 crore during 2025-26, an increase of 8.3% compared to 2022-23.
- Teacher strength has increased significantly, resulting in PTRs well below the NEP benchmark of 30:1.

- The number of single-teacher and zero-enrolment schools has declined through rationalisation, improving resource utilisation and administrative efficiency across the school system.

Ministry of Coal Releases 'AAROH': India's First Report on Scientific Mine Closure and Repurposing Practices

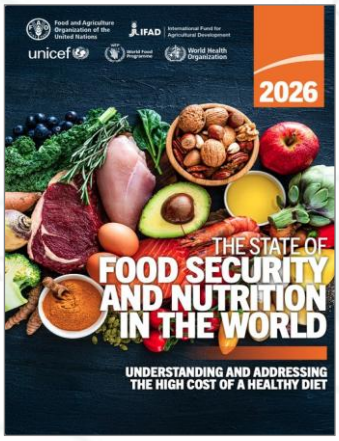
- The Ministry of Coal released ‘AAROH: Annual Report on Mine Closure’ in New Delhi.
- The AAROH, developed by the Coal Controller Organisation, presents India’s first comprehensive documentation of scientific mine closure and repurposing practices.
- The report documents the transformative journey of 42 scientifically closed coal mines,
- It captures the evolution of India’s mine closure framework and highlights key initiatives of the Ministry of Coal, including the RECLAIM Framework, L.I.V.E.S. Framework, SUVIKALP – Mine Repurposing Tool, and SUVIKALP Samvaad, which promote scientific assessment, stakeholder participation, knowledge exchange, and sustainable post-mining land use.

The UNFPA Demographic Futures Survey 2026



- The United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) published its groundbreaking global study, the Lives, Choices and Futures — Demographic Futures Survey 2026.
- The Demographic Futures Survey 2026 is a cross-national, global study designed by UNFPA to examine the aspirations, relationship patterns, and family decisions of young adults aged 18–39.
- Sampling 108,926 internet-connected young adults across 73 countries and territories, it provides comparative data on how economic, social, and institutional factors shape transitions to adulthood.
- Over two-thirds of surveyed young adults prefer a living arrangement that includes marriage—36% favoring marriage before cohabitation and 34% after cohabiting.
- Among respondents aged 25–39 who wish to marry or live with a partner, 25% are currently single and not dating, with a higher share among men (30%) than women (19%).
- Financial security is rated as the most critical consideration for entering a partnership (81%), with economic and housing barriers listed as primary obstacles (57%).
- Financial stability (88%), stable employment (87%), and emotional readiness (85%) rank as the top three non-negotiable thresholds before having children.

The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) 2026 Report



- The Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) along with IFAD, UNICEF, WFP, and WHO officially released The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) 2026 report.
- The SOFI report is the UN system's annual flagship assessment that tracks global, regional, and national progress toward ending hunger (SDG Target 2.1) and eliminating all forms of malnutrition (SDG Target 2.2).
- **Theme**-focused on Understanding and addressing the high cost of a healthy diet, the 2026 edition evaluates the cost drivers of Healthy Diet Baskets (HDB).

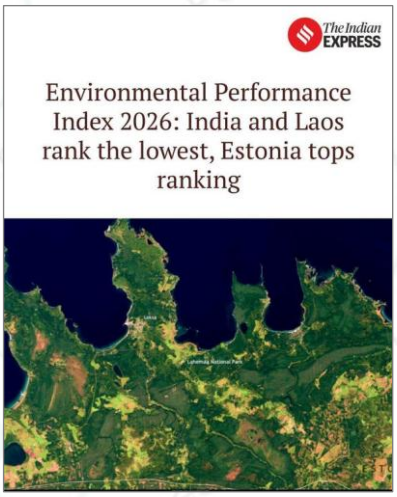
Key Findings in the Report:

- For the first time, Africa hosts the largest population facing hunger at 309 million people (20.0% rate), surpassing Asia's 292 million people (6.0% rate).
- Animal-source foods, fruits, and vegetables account for nearly 70% of the total cost of a healthy diet, whereas starchy staples contribute only one-sixth of the total cost despite providing half the calories.
- Only 30.8% of children aged 6–23 months and 62.7% of women aged 15–49 years achieved minimum dietary diversity globally.
- Projections show that 510 to 520 million people will still face chronic hunger in 2030, with 56% of them residing in Africa.

India and Report Findings:

- Southern Asia's substantial decline in undernourishment (from 13.9% in 2021 down to 9.3% in 2025) and food insecurity was largely propelled by improvements in India.
- India plays a decisive role in the global affordability metrics; excluding India from the lower-middle-income group converts the regional trend of people unable to afford a healthy diet from a decrease to an increase.
- India contributes to Southern Asia remaining on track to meet the 2030 global targets for child stunting reduction and halting child overweight.
- India faces significant hurdles in meeting the 50% reduction target for anaemia among women of reproductive age.

Environmental Performance Index 2026

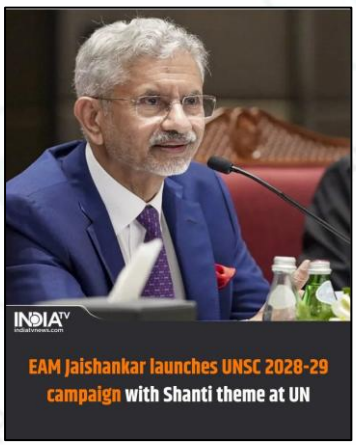


- The Environmental Performance Index (EPI) is a data-driven global benchmark developed by the Yale Center for Environmental Law & Policy, Columbia University's Center for International Earth Science Information Network (CIESIN) and Yale Center for Geospatial Solutions, Yale University with support from the McCall MacBain Foundation.
- In the 2026 Environmental Performance Index (EPI),
- Estonia claimed the No. 1 spot with an overall score of 74.79.
- Following behind, Luxembourg, United Kingdom, and Finland were positioned at No. 2, 3, and 4, respectively, while the Netherlands secured No. 5
- Five European countries ranked in the top five this year in the Environmental Performance Index.
- India ranked second from the bottom, taking the 176th position out of 177 evaluated countries.
- India's overall EPI score came out to 22.46, compared to a regional average of 31.81. Additionally, tree cover loss in key biodiversity areas recorded a score of -3.92.
- In 2022, when India ranked 180th out of 180 countries.

Rank	Country
1	Estonia
2	Luxembourg
3	United Kingdom
4	Finland
5	Netherlands

International

India Launches SHANTI Campaign for UNSC Bid



- India officially launched its campaign for election as a non-permanent member of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) for the 2028-29 term, named - 'SHANTI: Securing Holistic Advancement through Norms, Trust, Integrity.'
- The Asia-Pacific Group has one seat in the 2028-29 election cycle, and India will contest that seat against Tajikistan in elections scheduled for June 2027.
- India has served eight terms as a non-permanent member of the Security Council, including the 2021-22 term.

South China Sea Arbitral Award Marks 10 Years



- The South China Sea Arbitral Award completed 10 years on 12 July 2026.
- The award was issued on 12 July 2016 by the Permanent Court of Arbitration in The Hague under the dispute settlement framework linked to the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS).
- The arbitration case was filed by the Philippines against China under Annex VII of UNCLOS.
- The tribunal ruled that China's Nine-Dash Line claim had no legal basis under international law.
- China has rejected the 2016 award and has not participated in the arbitration.



- The Philippines marks 12 July as West Philippine Sea Victory Day

South China Sea:

- It is an arm of the western Pacific Ocean that borders the Southeast Asian mainland.
- Boundaries: It is bordered by China, Taiwan, the Philippines, Malaysia, Indonesia, Brunei, and Vietnam.
- It is connected by the Taiwan Strait with the East China Sea and by the Luzon Strait with the Philippine Sea (both marginal seas of the Pacific Ocean).
- The South China Sea and the East China Sea together form the China Sea.

Nine-dash line:

- China claims by far the largest portion of territory in an area demarcated by its so-called "nine-dash line".
- The line comprises nine dashes, which extend hundreds of miles south and east from its most southerly province of Hainan.

PM Modi's Australia Visit: Major Highlights and Outcomes



- PM Modi visited Australia from 8 to 10 July 2026 for the third Australia–India Annual Summit in Melbourne.
- The historical ties between India and Australia started immediately following European settlement in Australia in 1788.
- Australia and India upgraded their bilateral relationship from 'Strategic Partnership' in 2009 to Comprehensive Strategic Partnership (CSP) in 2020

Key outcomes:

- The finalisation of the administrative arrangement to operationalise the Civil Nuclear Agreement signed in 2014 and enable the supply of uranium from Australia to India.
- To support India's domestic renewable energy push, a joint 'Rooftop Solar Training Academy' will be established in Gujarat to build technical capacity among women and youth under the PM Surya Ghar Yojana.
- The two leaders also launched the Australia-India Partnership on Cyber, Critical Technologies and Supply Chains (PACTS).
- Pact for the repatriation of Indian artifacts, with Australia agreeing to return the sacred bull Nandi (11th–12th century, granite), a trident with Auspicious Kali (11th century, bronze), and a six-headed Skanda (12th century, basalt).
- A separate trilateral Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was also signed under the Australia-Canada-India Technology and Innovation (ACITI) umbrella, cementing a trusted technological alliance between the three Commonwealth nations.
- **India-Australia Sports Collaboration Roadmap: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese jointly unveiled the India-Australia Sports Collaboration Roadmap at the Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG).**
- One of the notable features as a part of this collaboration was the announcement of the inaugural match of the upcoming edition of the Big Bash League being played at MA Chidambaram Stadium (Chepauk) in Chennai this December.

Australia to Return Tamil Nadu Temple Antiquities



- Three antiquities from Tamil Nadu, dating back to the 11th and 12th centuries and housed at a museum in Australia, are all set to make their way back to India.
- The repatriation of the antiquities is among the outcomes of the India-Australia summit during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the island nation.

The antiquities that will return to India in due course, as per the commitment between the two sides, include:

- (i) A stone sculpture of sacred Nandi – the vehicle of Lord Shiva (11th to 12th century): Sculpted in the Tamil Shaiva temple tradition, it originates from Sri Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple, Kollumangudi village in Thiruvarur district.
- (ii) A metal trident with the image of Bhadrakali (11th century): Originating from Sri Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple in Kollumangudi.
- (iii) A six-headed Karthikeya statue in stone (12th century): Carved in the Chola-period sculptural tradition, it originates from the Naganathswamy Temple, Manambadi village of Thanjavur district.

India–New Zealand: Key Highlights of PM Modi's Visit



- During the final leg of the three-nation tour, PM Modi visited New Zealand from July 10 to July 11.
- He became the first Indian PM to visit New Zealand in 40 years.
- Both countries elevated their bilateral ties to a Strategic Partnership and signed several agreements and MoUs across key sectors.

Key outcomes:

- India and New Zealand agreed to double bilateral trade to NZ$7 billion or Rs 35,000 crore by 2030, in the context of the Free Trade agreement signed in April this year.
- They agreed to establish a regular Foreign Ministers' Dialogue and consolidate the practice of annual senior officials' meetings between India's Ministry of External Affairs and New Zealand's Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade.
- They also decided to launch the 'Kiwifruit Action Plan and Establishment of two Centres of Excellence for Kiwifruit in Nagaland and Uttarakhand'.
- The India-New Zealand Joint Action Plan on Sport will provide a framework for collaboration in sports, including high-performance sport, sports science, sports medicine and athlete development.

Maori Haka



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was welcomed with a traditional Māori Haka during his official visit to Auckland, New Zealand.
- The haka is of deep cultural significance to Maori identity and is traditionally performed by warriors on the battlefield or to welcome another tribe.
- "Haka "was a show of physical prowess but also an embodiment of cultural pride, strength, and unity."
- It is usually performed in a group and involves chanting, dramatic facial gestures, hand movements, and stamping the feet.
- The Haka traces its roots to the Maori people, the indigenous Polynesian inhabitants of Aotearoa (the Maori name for New Zealand).
- Traditionally, the haka was a ceremonial dance or challenge performed by warriors before battle.
- It was designed to intimidate opponents with synchronised movements, powerful chants, and piercing expressions.

PM Modi conferred with Indonesia's highest honour 'Bintang Adipurna' in Jakarta



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with Indonesia's highest honour 'Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia' medal for his role in strengthening the ties between both the countries.
- The Indonesian award would be his 34th international honour

- He is the second Indian prime minister to be conferred with the award, following Jawaharlal Nehru.
- Nehru was awarded the Bintang Adipurna in 1995, when Indonesia was celebrating its 50th year of Independence.
- **Instituted in 1959, the Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia is the highest honour in the Republic of Indonesia.**
- Bintang Adipurna (also known as the Star of the Republic of Indonesia, First Class)
- This award is given to individuals who have rendered exceptional service to the unity, continuity and prosperity of the Republic of Indonesia.



PM Modi visits UNESCO-listed Prambanan Temple with President Prabowo



- Prime Minister of India and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto officially launched an international conservation and restoration project at the Prambanan Temple Compounds in Yogyakarta, Indonesia.
- Prambanan (locally known as Roro Jonggrang or Loro Jonggrang) is the largest and most architecturally complex Hindu temple compound in Indonesia, and one of the largest in Southeast Asia.
- It stands as a towering masterpiece of classical Shaivite art, design, and stone-building technology.
- **Location : Java Island, Indonesia.**
- The decade-long project will focus on restoring the Pervara or subsidiary shrines, located in the temple's second courtyard.
- Originally, the Prambanan complex comprised 224 such shrines arranged in four concentric rows.
- Built in the 9th century under the Sanjaya Dynasty of the ancient Mataram Kingdom, and has been recognised as a UNESCO World Heritage Site since 1991.
- Dedicated to the Trimurti—Lord Brahma, Lord Vishnu and Lord Shiva.

PM Modi announces IIM Bangalore's first overseas campus in Indonesia

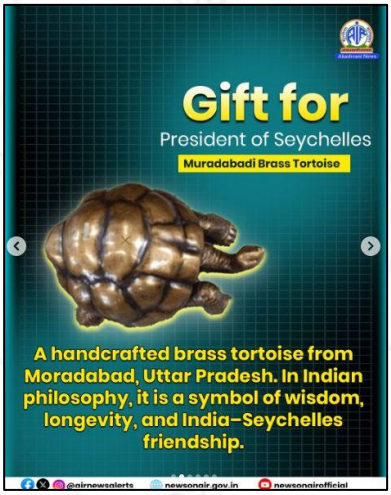


- Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the establishment of IIM Bangalore's first overseas campus in Indonesia during his visit to Jakarta.
- The campus, to be set up at the Singhasari Special Economic Zone (SEZ), will initially offer executive education programmes before expanding to degree courses.
- The IIM Bangalore (Singhasari) Campus is the first international campus of the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB).

PM Modi becomes first Indian Prime Minister to address Indonesian Parliament

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has become the first Indian Prime Minister to address the Parliament of Indonesia.
- Describing India as the "Mother of Democracy," the Prime Minister said New Delhi is committed to strengthening democratic linkages with Indonesia.

▪ He also highlighted the common ideals of “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam” (The World is One Family) and Indonesia’s national motto, “Bhinneka Tunggal Ika” (Unity in Diversity)



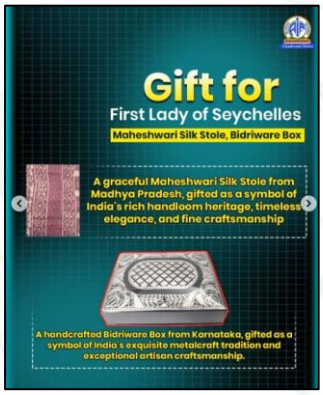
Kanchivaram, Maheshwari silk, Muradabadi brass tortoise part of PM’s gifts to Seychelles leaders

▪ Kanchivaram silk fabric, Maheshwari silk stole and Toda embroidered shawl were some of the gifts that Prime Minister Narendra Modi gave to the top leadership of Seychelles and their spouses during his just-concluded visit to the island nation.

▪ The Prime Minister gifted the Seychelles President a Muradabadi brass tortoise, an example of the renowned brassware tradition of Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh.

▪ The Prime Minister gifted,the First Lady of Seychelles, a Maheshwari silk stole and a Bidriware box.

▪ Originating in Maheshwar in Madhya Pradesh, this textile tradition is celebrated for its fine craftsmanship and harmonious blend of silk and cotton yarns.



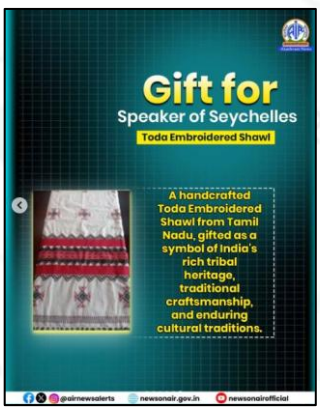


▪ Bidriware originated in Bidar, Karnataka, from which it derives its name.

▪ The craft involves casting an alloy of zinc and copper, engraving intricate patterns onto the surface, and inlaying them with silver.

▪ Mr. Modi presented the Vice President of Seychelles, an orchid painting from Sikkim.

▪ The artwork depicts India's national bird, the peacock, adorned with delicate orchid blooms amid intricate floral vine.





▪ Mr. Modi gifted the Second Lady of Seychelles, a Kanchivaram silk fabric.

▪ Originating in the historic temple town of Kanchipuram in Tamil Nadu, the textile is woven from fine mulberry silk and distinguished by its durability, lustrous finish and intricate 'zari' work.

▪ Mr. Modi also gifted the speaker of the Seychelles national Assembly a Toda embroidered shawl, a distinguished textile tradition of the Toda community, the indigenous pastoral people of the Nilgiri Hills in Tamil Nadu.

▪ **The embroidery technique, known as Pukhoor, is unique to the Toda people and is executed entirely by hand.**

India–Japan ‘Year of Shared Horizons’ 2027 Announced to Strengthen Bilateral Ties



▪ Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi visited India from July 1–3 at the invitation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

75 Years of Diplomatic Relations (2027)

▪ India and Japan will mark 75 years of diplomatic ties in 2027, will be celebrated as the India–Japan Year of Shared Horizons.

▪ The week of April 28, 2027, will be observed as India–Japan Week.

▪ PM Sanae Takaichi invited PM Modi to visit Japan next year for the annual summit.

India–Japan Initiatives (2027)

- Logo & theme competition to engage citizens in future partnership vision.
- **IMAGE-75: Promotes exchanges in anime, manga, gaming, and creative tech.**
- **Ideathon (2nd edition): Indian & Japanese students to explore innovation.**
- Policy dialogue: Experts & youth to suggest future cooperation ideas.
- RASA-75: Year-long cultural exchange in arts and traditions.
- Buddhist delegation from Japan to visit key Buddhist sites in India to promote spiritual ties and tourism.
- SPORT-75 to boost sports cooperation and people-to-people exchanges.



- India–Japan Friendship Cricket Match at Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games 2026.
- Cricket Kizuna-75: Indian coaches to train young Japanese cricketers.
- India–Japan Sports Week (Feb 2027) featuring Ekiden event (a team relay running) in Delhi-NCR.
- Business Connect-75 to strengthen India–Japan business linkages.
- Roadshows, roundtables, and business interactions to enhance economic cooperation.

India, Kyrgyzstan Launch Manas–Mahabharata Studies Centre

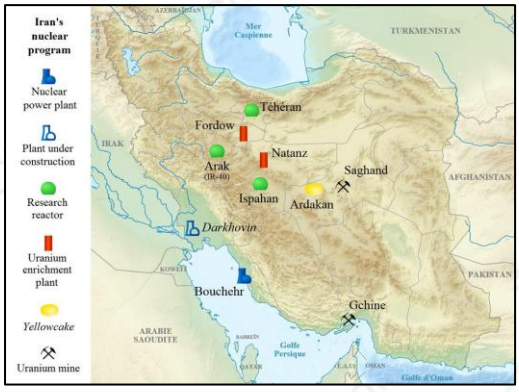
- An Indian delegation visited Kyrgyzstan from 4 July to 7 July 2026 for the inauguration of the International Centre for Civilizational Studies "Manas and Mahabharata" in Bishkek.
- The centre was established through cooperation between the Manas National Academy in Kyrgyzstan and the Centre for Studies of International Relations (CSIR) in New Delhi.
- Manas is the Kyrgyz epic tradition and one of the longest oral epics in the world.
- The Mahabharata is a Sanskrit epic from ancient India and is among the two major Sanskrit epics, the other being the Ramayana.

Greater Tunb Island



- The U.S. military's Central Command recently said that it had launched airstrikes on Greater Tunb Island in the Strait of Hormuz, targeting Iranian defence installations and missile sites.
- It is a small island in the Persian Gulf near the entrance to the Strait of Hormuz.
- The island, under Iranian control since 1971, is regarded as a strategically important location in the strait.

What is Pickaxe Mountain and strategic sites at centre of West Asia crisis?



- Tensions between the United States and Iran have intensified, with US President Donald Trump issuing fresh threats to strike Iran's nuclear site known as "Pickaxe Mountain."
- Located south of Tehran, Pickaxe Mountain is a heavily fortified facility featuring two deep underground tunnel complexes, making it extremely difficult to destroy.
- The site lies near the damaged Natanz uranium enrichment facility and is considered one of Iran's most secure nuclear-related locations.
- Originally constructed in 2007, it was later expanded and reinforced, and reportedly sealed after the June 2025 conflict.

- The complex is believed to be buried at least 100 metres beneath the mountain.

Submarine cable system project linking India, Malaysia, Singapore unveiled



- A consortium of Microsoft, Singtel, Tata Communications, and Lightstorm will build a submarine cable system.
- The project is named I-2SEA (India–Southeast Asia) cable system.
- It will connect India, Malaysia, and Singapore.

Objective: To meet rising demand from:

- Hyperscalers
- GPU infrastructure providers
- Enterprises using AI training and inference workloads

The cable will link India's east coast (Hyderabad & Chennai data hubs) with:

- **Singapore (regional AI & cloud interconnect hub)**
- **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia (emerging data centre corridor)**
- **NEC Corporation is the system supplier.**
- **ASEAN Cableship (ACPL) is the marine installation partner.**

UK Launches Storm Fighter Loyal Wingman Programme



- The United Kingdom launched the Royal Air Force's new collaborative combat aircraft programme, named Storm Fighter,
- The programme seeks to develop autonomous loyal wingman drones for operations with crewed combat aircraft such as Typhoon, F-35 and the future Tempest fighter.
- Collaborative combat aircraft, or CCA, are unmanned aircraft designed to operate with crewed fighters in combat roles.
- These aircraft can extend sensor reach, carry weapons, conduct electronic attack, or serve as decoys for manned jets.

Phu Quoc Island



- At least 15 Indian tourists were killed after a boat carrying visitors capsized off Vietnam's southern island of Phu Quoc recently.
- Phu Quoc, also known as Pearl Island, is a Vietnamese island located in the Gulf of Thailand.
- On the map, it lies closer to Cambodia than mainland Vietnam, making it the country's largest island and one of the most geographically strategic.
- A large part of the island is protected under Phú Quốc National Park, which is recognized as a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve.
- Tropical Phu Quoc has just two seasons – six months of dry, sunny weather between November and April and six rainy months between May and October.
- The island's cultural identity remains deeply rooted in its maritime heritage, with traditional fishing villages like Ham Ninh maintaining age-old customs.
- It is also famous for producing fish sauce (nước mắm) and black pepper, both of which are important local products.

Operation 'Hardball'

- The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) announced a $50,000 (Rs 47.7 lakh approx) reward for information leading to the arrest of gangster Goldy Brar, as part of Operation 'Hardball'.



- The operation 'Hardball' was a covert mission undertaken by law enforcement agencies in the U.S. shortly after Khalistani Hardeep Singh Nijjar's murder.
- The mission titled 'Operation Hardball', is a result of years-long federal investigation into Indian crime syndicates that engage in racketeering, targeted killings, shootings, extortion, trafficking of bulk quantities of narcotics across international borders.

Ireland Assumes EU Council Presidency



- Ireland assumes the Presidency of the Council of the European Union.
- President: Each EU country holds the presidency on a 6-month rotating basis
- Established in: 1958 (as Council of the European Economic Community)
- Location: Brussels (Belgium)

Codex Alimentarius Commission

- India achieved significant milestones at the 49th Session of the Codex Alimentarius Commission (CAC49) held in Geneva, Switzerland from 6th to 10th July, 2026.
- The Commission adopted seven Codex standards and guidelines developed under India's chairmanship and co-chairmanship,
- It is the international food standards-setting body.
- It was established jointly by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) and the World Health Organization (WHO) in May 1963.
- Objective: Protecting consumer's health and ensuring fair practices in the food trade.
- Headquarters: It has its headquarters in Rome.
- Currently the CAC has 189 Codex Members made up of 188 Member Countries and 1 Member Organization (The European Union).
- **India became a member of CAC in 1964.**

India to chair UNCTAD's 9th session of Intergovernmental Group of Experts on Consumer Protection in Switzerland

- India will chair the Ninth Session of the Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE) on Consumer Protection Law and Policy, organised by the United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD) at the Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland, from 06 to 08 July 2026.
- The Intergovernmental Group of Experts (IGE), constituted under the United Nations Guidelines for Consumer Protection, is the principal intergovernmental platform for cooperation and dialogue on consumer protection law and policy.
- The Government of India will be represented by Smt. Nidhi Khare, Secretary, Department of Consumer Affairs,



Geneva to Host Global AI Summit in 2027

- Switzerland has announced that the Geneva AI Summit 2027 will take place on June 21-22, 2027, at Palexpo in Geneva,
- The Geneva summit is planned as a platform for stable and effective processes for global discussions on AI governance.

Two-Thousand-Year-Old Indian Gold Rings Found in Thailand

- A 2,000-year-old gold ring discovered beside a human skeleton in Thailand has given archaeologists fresh evidence of ancient India's deep connections with Southeast Asia.

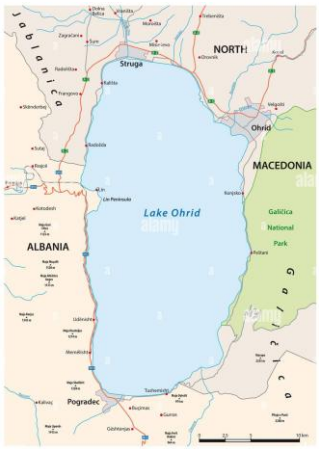
- The remarkable find, made at the Don Yai Thong archaeological site.
- It features an inscription in the ancient Indian Brahmi script.
- The text reads "pusarakhitasa," which translates to "the one protected by Pushya."
- Pushya is regarded as one of the most auspicious lunar constellations in Indian astronomy and continues to hold religious significance for many Hindus.

President Murmu's first Moldova visit



- President Droupadi Murmu arrived on a historic visit to Moldova, first by any Indian Head of State, as part of her three-nation tour of European countries aimed at boosting ties in trade, technology and tourism sectors among others.
- India and Moldova have shared warm and friendly relations since the establishment of diplomatic ties in 1992,
- President Murmu will hold delegation-level talks with her Moldovan counterpart, President Maia Sandu.
- She will also meet the President of the Parliament of the Republic of Moldova, Igor Grosu.
- The President is scheduled to hold discussions with members of the Moldova-India Parliamentary Friendship Group, address a Business Forum and interact with the members of the Indian Community.
- Moldova, officially the Republic of Moldova, **is a landlocked country in Eastern Europe.**
- It is bordered by Romania to the west and Ukraine to the north, east, and south.
- **Capital: Chișinău**
- Currency: Moldovan Leu (MDL)
- Language: Romanian is the official language.

President Murmu Unveils Gandhi Bust in North Macedonia





- President Droupadi Murmu unveiled a bust of Mahatma Gandhi at the Museum of the City of Skopje during her state visit to North Macedonia.
- The President will also visit Lake Ohrid with her Macedonian counterpart and the Mayor of Ohrid.
- A World Heritage Site, Lake Ohrid is one of Europe's deepest and oldest lakes, featuring a unique aquatic ecosystem with more than 200 endemic species.

President Murmu holds talks with Romanian counterpart



- Recently, the President of India held bilateral talks with the Romanian President during her State Visit to Romania.
- India and Romania have signed three agreements for cooperation in the fields of Science and Technology, Education and Sports.
- The agreements were signed after delegation-level talks between President Droupadi Murmu and her Romanian counterpart, President Nicușor Dan, in Bucharest
- President Murmu will visit the Romanian Parliament, where she will

interact with President of the Senate Mircea Abrudean and President of the Chamber of Deputies Sorin Grindeanu.

- She will also pay homage at the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier by laying a wreath.
- About Romania : It is located in **South Eastern Europe.**
- Bordering Countries: It is bordered by Ukraine in the north; Moldova in the northeast; Bulgaria in the south, Serbia in the southwest and Hungary in the west.
- Maritime Border: It is bounded by the Black Sea in the southeast.
- Capital City: Bucharest
- It joined NATO in 2004 and the European Union in 2007
- It is dominated by the Carpathian Mountains.
- Major rivers: Danube, Arges, Tisza, Prut, etc.

Four more international sites added to UNESCO World Heritage List

- The UNESCO World Heritage List has grown once again, with four more internationally important sites receiving recognition during the 48th session of the World Heritage Committee in Busan, South Korea.



Mount Olympus, Greece

- Greece's highest mountain, known in Greek mythology as the home of the Olympian gods, has also been added to the UNESCO World Heritage List.
- Mount Olympus is recognised for its rich biodiversity and unique natural landscape.



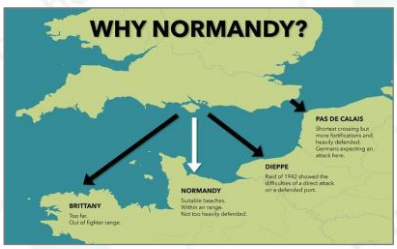
Asuka and Fujiwara, Japan

- Japan's ancient capitals of Asuka and Fujiwara have earned UNESCO recognition for their role in shaping the country's earliest centralised state.
- The archaeological remains preserve evidence of Japan's political and cultural development between the sixth and eighth centuries.

Boma-Badingilo Migratory Landscape, South Sudan

- The Boma-Badingilo Migratory Landscape has **become South Sudan's first-ever UNESCO World Heritage Site.**
- The vast protected landscape is known for one of the world's largest seasonal migrations of land mammals and its rich biodiversity.



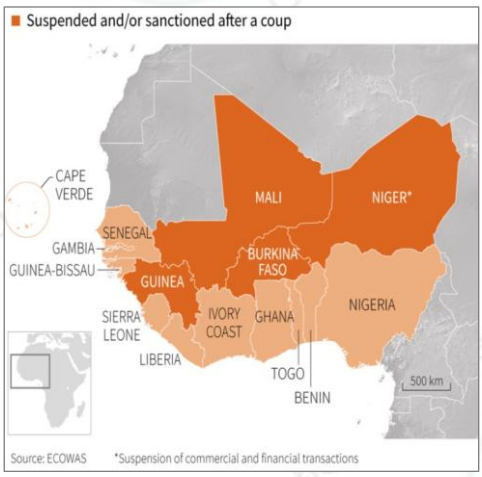


D-Day landing beaches, France

- The beaches of Normandy, where Allied forces landed on June 6, 1944, during World War II, have been recognised for their historic importance.
- The inscription honours the role these beaches played in the liberation of Europe during the war.

Senegal's President Bassirou Faye elected as new Chairman of ECOWAS

- Senegal's President, **Bassirou Faye**, has been elected as the new Chairman of the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS), succeeding Sierra Leone's President, Julius Maada Bio.



- Faye emerged as the new chairman during the 69th Ordinary Session of the Authority of Heads of State and Government of the ECOWAS in Sierra Leone
- Established: Established on 28 May 1975 by 15 West African countries through the **Treaty of Lagos.**
- **Headquarter: Abuja, Nigeria.**

France Bans Social Media for Children Under 15

- France banned children under 15 from using social media, becoming the first country in the European Union to pass a ban on the platforms .
- The bill also bans the use of mobile phones in high schools.
- The ban won't cover online encyclopedias, or educational or scientific directories.

Okinotori Island

- A Chinese navy destroyer, alongside Russian vessels, recently conducted live-fire drills near Japan's Okinotori Island, marking the first such disclosure by Japan.



- Okinotori, also known as Parece Vela, is a tiny, uninhabited island that belongs to Japan.
- It's located far out in the Philippine Sea, which is part of the big Pacific Ocean.
- It's actually an atoll, which is a ring-shaped coral reef with a lagoon in the middle.
- This atoll is part of a long underwater mountain range called the Palau-Kyushu Ridge.
- It is the only Japanese territory south of the Tropic of Cancer and lies to the south of Hong Kong and Taiwan.
- Japan says that the waters around Okinotori are its Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).
- It sits about halfway between Taiwan and Guam (island territory of the United States).
- This makes its location strategic in the Pacific Ocean.

Nepal has redesigned its Re 1 coin, removing the controversial map that included Kalapani, Lipulekh, and Limpiyadhura.

- Nepal has approved a redesign of one of its most commonly used coins, removing a politically sensitive
- Nepal's cabinet approved minting a newly designed Re 1 coin, replacing the controversial political map that included the disputed territories of **Kalapani, Lipulekh, and Limpiyadhura with an image of the ancient Lo Ghyakar Monastery.**



What is the India-Nepal border dispute?

- The dispute centres on a roughly 370-square-kilometre area located near the India-Nepal-China tri-junction in Uttarakhand's Pithoragarh district.
- At the heart of the disagreement lies differing interpretations of the 1816 Sugauli Treaty signed between British India and the Kingdom of Nepal.
- Nepal argues that the Mahakali, also known as the Kali River, originates from Limpiyadhura, which lies further west.
- Based on that interpretation, Kathmandu maintains that Limpiyadhura, Lipulekh and Kalapani fall within Nepalese territory.
- New Delhi maintains that the Kali River begins near springs located close to Kalapani village and therefore considers all three areas to be part of Indian territory.
- India has also maintained administrative control and a security presence in the region through the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) since the 1962 war.

NATO Ankara Summit 2026



- The NATO Ankara Summit (2026) concluded with major commitments on higher

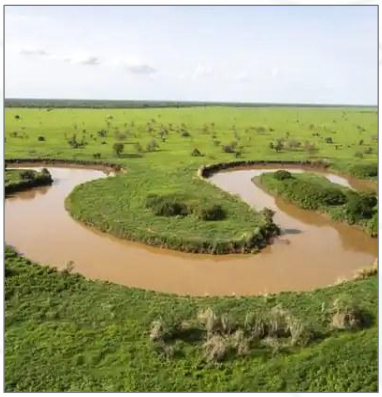
defence spending, support for Ukraine, and strengthening Europe's defence industrial base.

- A high-level politico-military conference where leaders of NATO's 32 ally nations review defense progress, align alliance-wide security priorities, and convert political commitments into active operational capabilities.
- Host Country: Hosted in Ankara, Türkiye.

United Nations Commission on International Trade Law

- Recently, India's External Affairs Minister addressed the inaugural session of the international conference of 60th anniversary commemoration of the United Nations Commission on International Trade Law (UNCITRAL).
- It is a **subsidiary body of the UN General Assembly established in 1966.**
- It is the core legal body of the U.N,'s system in the field of international trade law.
- Function: The organization is responsible for helping to facilitate international trade and investment.
- There are five regional groups represented within the Commission: African States; Asian States; Eastern European States; Latin American and Caribbean States; Western European and Other States.
- **Term of Members:** The General Assembly elects members for terms of six years; every three years the terms of half of the members expire.
- India is a founding member of this organization.
- Headquarter: It is in New York with annual sessions held alternatively in Vienna

UNESCO's List of World Heritage in Danger



- At the 48th World Heritage Committee session in Busan, South Korea, UNESCO inscribed new cultural and natural sites on the World Heritage List and **added six vulnerable sites to the List of World Heritage in Danger.**
- It highlights World Heritage properties threatened by severe risks—such as armed conflict, natural disasters, rapid urbanization, poaching, or pollution—enabling UNESCO to allocate emergency technical assistance, mobilize global conservation resources, and urge member states to take corrective action.

Six New Sites Added to UNESCO's List of World Heritage in Danger:

▪Boma-Badingilo Migratory Landscape:



▪ Location: **South Sudan**

▪ Key Features: A vast East African savanna ecosystem that hosts the world's largest terrestrial mammal migration. It reflects rich cultural and herding traditions across diverse local ethnic groups.

▪Mount Amel Castles:

▪Location: **Southern Lebanon**

▪Key Features: A network of five hilltop fortresses—including Beaufort, Toron, Dubieh, Maron, and Chama'—illustrating the evolution of regional defensive systems from the Crusades and Islamic dynasties through the 19th century.



▪ Sebastia:

▪Location: State of Palestine (near Nablus, West Bank)

▪Key Features: Preserves continuous archaeological layers from the 9th century BCE (when Samaria-Sebaste was the capital of the northern Kingdom of Israel) through Hellenistic, Roman, Byzantine, Crusader, and Ottoman Throne Village periods.

Ancient City of Tauric Chersonese and its Chora:

▪Location: Autonomous Republic of Crimea, Ukraine

▪Key Features: An ancient Greek city and its agricultural hinterland (Chora) along the Black Sea coast.

Historic Inner City of Paramaribo:

▪Location: Suriname

▪Key Features: A former Dutch colonial trading town featuring a distinct blend of European architecture and native South American materials.

Tyre:

▪Location: Lebanon

▪Key Features: An ancient Phoenician island-city famed for its historic harbor, Roman hippodrome, and monumental ruins.

India, Nepal Restore Lalitpur Heritage Sites

- India and Nepal jointly inaugurated the restored Shree Gusthal Mahavihar and Agam of Prathamshree Mahavihar at Guita Tole in Patan, Lalitpur.
- The project was funded by a Government of India grant of about NPR 12 crores and was executed by Nepal's Central Level Project Implementation Unit under the Department of Urban Development and Building Construction.
- Shree Gusthal Mahavihar and Agam of Prathamshree Mahavihar are Buddhist heritage structures located in Lalitpur Metropolitan City in the Kathmandu Valley.
- The sites suffered severe damage in the 2015 earthquake in Nepal.

Appoint Polar Ambassador, become full member of Arctic Council

- Recently, the Parliamentary committee on External Affairs has recommended that India should appoint a Polar Ambassador and urged the government to seek "full-fledged membership" of the Arctic council.
- It was established by the Ottawa Declaration in 1996.
- It is an intergovernmental forum for addressing issues related to the Arctic Region.



- It is not a treaty-based international organization but rather an international forum that operates on the basis of consensus, echoing the peaceful and cooperative nature of the Arctic Region.
- Member Countries: Canada, Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, the Russian Federation, and the United States
- It has six Permanent Participants (PP) groups representing the indigenous people of the Arctic.
- Observer States: Observer status in the Arctic Council is open to non-arctic states, inter-governmental and inter-parliamentary organizations, global and regional and non-governmental organizations.
- India is currently one of the 13 observer countries (France, Germany, Netherlands, Poland, Spain, U.K., India, China, Japan, Singapore, South Korea, Italy and Switzerland) of the Arctic Council.
- The observer countries do not have decision making powers. They also can't make financial contributions or undertake research in the arctic directly.

Sports

Khelo India Games

Telangana to Host 8th Khelo India Youth Games 2026

- Telangana will host the 2026 edition of Khelo India Youth Games,
- The KIYG is likely to take place in November.
- Bihar had hosted the previous edition in May last year.
- Maharashtra topped the medal table in 2025, followed by Haryana and Rajasthan.

National/ International Championships

India bags 20 medals at Under-20 Asian Wrestling Championships

- Indian wrestlers finished with an impressive haul of 20 medals, including four gold, seven silver and nine bronze at the Under-20 Asian Wrestling Championships 2026.
- In women's wrestling, India finished second on the podium
- The Indian men's freestyle team finished third overall in the team standing



Esha Singh wins Gold, Manu Bhaker bags Bronze in ISSF World Cup 25m pistol in Hangzhou

- In Shooting, India's Esha Singh grabbed the gold medal in the women's 25 metre pistol event of the ISSF World Cup (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun) in Hangzhou, China.
- Manu Bhaker won the bronze to complete a double-podium finish for India.

ISSF World Cup 2026 Hangzhou: India finish with four medals

- India finished the ISSF World Cup in Hangzhou with four medals - one gold, one silver and two bronze.
- Sonam Maskar and Himanshu Dhillon won bronze in the 10m air rifle mixed team event,
- Sainyam Vij had secured silver in the women's 10m air pistol event, while Esha Singh and Manu Bhaker won gold and bronze, respectively, in the women's 25m pistol event.



India wins one silver and two bronze medals at U17 World Wrestling Championships

- India's women wrestlers delivered strong podium finishes at the 2026 U17 World Championships in Baku, Azerbaijan, bringing home a silver and two bronze medals
- In U17 World Championships, Indian wrestler Nikita Sehrawat settled for a silver medal while Kamna Babal and Garima bagged bronze medals in the women's event in Baku, Azerbaijan
- In the 49kg category, Kamna Babal showcased excellent resilience to claim the bronze medal.
- Consolidated results:
- 57kg: Nikita Sehrawat (India) vs. Epenesa Elison (USA); 0-6
- 49kg: Kamna Babal (India) vs. Irina Tsydeeva (Russia); 3-2
- 73kg: Garima (India) vs. Paula Benaixa Perez (Spain); 10-0, VSU.

Commonwealth Games

Commonwealth Games 2026: Mirabai Chanu, Lovlina Borgohain to be India's flag and baton bearer



- Olympic medallists Mirabai Chanu and Lovlina Borgohain were named India's flag bearer and baton bearer, respectively, for the Commonwealth Games 2026 Opening Ceremony.
- The pair will lead India's CWG 2026 contingent during the opening ceremony at The Hydro in Glasgow on July 23,
- The Commonwealth Games 2026 will be held from July 23 to August 2.

Union Sports Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya Leads 'Cheer for Bharat' Cycling Initiative with Indian Diaspora in Glasgow

- Union Sports Minister Dr Mansukh Mandaviya led the "Cheer for Bharat" cycling rally in Glasgow, Scotland, alongside members of the Indian diaspora to boost the morale of the Indian contingent participating in the 2026 Commonwealth Games.
- The 2026 Commonwealth Games are being held in Scotland (United Kingdom), hosted in the city of Glasgow
- Finnie is the official mascot of the Commonwealth Games 2026.



Commonwealth Games 2026: Lovlina assures India its first medal

- Lovlina Borgohain assured India of their first medal at the Commonwealth Games after the boxer received a direct entry into the semifinals of the women's 75kg event, which also guaranteed her at least a bronze.
- Lovlina will take on Tuvalu's TKBP Taafaki in the semifinal on July 3
- This is the first Commonwealth Games medal for her.
- She has already won medals at the Olympic Games, World Championships, Asian Games and Asian Championships.

Mirabai Chanu, Rishikanta Singh Win CWG 2026 Medals

- The Commonwealth Games 2026 are being held in Glasgow, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026.
- Mirabai Chanu won gold in the women's 48kg weightlifting event, and Rishikanta Singh won silver in the men's 60kg category.
- Mirabai Chanu won her third consecutive Commonwealth Games gold medal and her fourth overall Commonwealth Games medal.
- She total lift of 190kg (85kg snatch + 105 clean and jerk)
- Rishikanta Singh delivered India's first silver medal in men's 60kg weightlifting
- Weightlifting: Raja Muthupandi in men's 65kg weightlifting won Silver



Sarvesh Kushare wins silver in high jump

- National record holder Sarvesh Kushare scripted history as he became the first Indian to win a silver medal in the men's high jump event of the Commonwealth Games, clearing 2.25 meters
- His first national level gold came in 2018 Indian Open where he jumped 2.24m.
- Tejaswin Shankar was the lone Indian to have won a high jump medal -- a bronze in the 2022 Birmingham Games.



Ajaya Babu wins silver, India's 6th weightlifting medal at 2026 CWG

- Fast-rising Indian weightlifter Valluri Ajaya Babu win the silver medal in the men's 79kg category .
- He is from Andhra Pradesh's Vizianagaram district
- lifted a Games record 149kg in snatch and 181kg in clean and jerk for a total of 330kg to win the second prize,

Sharmila wins historic gold in para athletics as India shines with multiple medals



- Sharmila Dhankar scripted history by becoming India's first-ever Commonwealth Games para-athletics gold medallist,
- winning the women's shot put F57 title with a season-best effort of 9.81m, becoming the first Indian to win a gold medal in para-athletics at the Games
- The last para-athletics medal in CWG was won by Ranjith Kumar Jayaseelan in the men's seated Discus Throw event in the 2006 edition.
- Indian para-athlete Shilpa K. Shyla clinched the bronze medal in the women's shot put F57 event at the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games
- Shilpa registered a personal-best throw of 7.26m

Gyaneshwari Yadav Wins Silver in Commonwealth Games 2026



- Indian weightlifter Gyaneshwari Yadav won the silver medal in the women's 53kg weightlifting event at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow, Scotland.
- lifted a personal best total of 199kg, with 88kg in the snatch and 111kg in the clean and jerk.

Weightlifter, Bindyarani Devi Sorokhaibam on winning Bronze at Commonwealth Games 2026



- Indian weightlifter Bindyarani Devi Sorokhaibam won the bronze medal in the women's 58kg weightlifting event at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow.
- in the Women's 58kg event
- Bindyarani finished third with a total lift of 199kg, comprising 87kg in the snatch and 112kg in the clean and jerk.

Gulveer Singh, Harjinder Kaur for CWG 2026 silver medals



- Indian athletes Harjinder Kaur and Gulveer Singh secured silver medals at the ongoing Commonwealth Games in Glasgow
- Gulveer Singh secured the **silver medal** in the men's **10,000 metres** event, registering a time of 27 minutes 49.78 seconds
- Harjinder Kaur earned the **silver medal** in the **women's 69 kg** weightlifting category - **total lift of 227 kg**, comprising 101 kg in the snatch and 126 kg in the clean and jerk.

Commonwealth Games: Gavit, Basil script historic 1-2 finish for India in men's 100m T47 final

- India scripted history in para athletics at the Commonwealth Games by securing a historic one-two finish in the men's 100m T47 final, with Dilip Mahadu Gavit winning gold and Mohammed Basil Morssinganakath claiming silver.
- Gavit clocked a Games record and season-best time of 10.71 seconds to take the top spot
- Basil produced a season-best 10.83 seconds to finish second
- The men's 100m T47 is a para athletics sprint event for athletes with a unilateral arm impairment or absence, affecting strength, movement or coordination on one side.

Commonwealth Games: Sreeshankar leaps into history with second straight silver for long jump; Tajay Gayle wins gold

- Murali Sreeshankar won the silver medal in the men's long jump at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, Scotland,
- His jump measured 8.09 metres,
- He became the first Indian male long jumper to win two Commonwealth Games medals after his silver medal in Glasgow and his earlier silver medal at the Birmingham 2022 Commonwealth Games.

Seema Kaliramna Wins Discus Bronze; Lovepreet Singh Bags Weightlifting Silver at CWG 2026



- Seema Kaliramna won the bronze medal in women's discus throw at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow , a best mark of 58.66m
- India's Lovepreet Singh came within touching distance of the Commonwealth Games title before settling for silver in the men's +110kg weightlifting event, finishing just 1kg behind New Zealand's David Liti in Glasgow
- Lovepreet registered a combined lift of 388kg, while Liti clinched gold with 389kg.

Tennis

The 139th Wimbledon Championships 2026: All results and scores

- Wimbledon 2026 took place from 29 June to 12 July.
- **Jannik Sinner defended his men's singles title.**
- **Linda Nosková claimed her first Grand Slam women's singles title.**

Category	Winner
Men's singles	Jannik Sinner (ITA)
Women's singles	Linda Noskova (CZE)
Men's doubles	Haari Heliovaara (FIN)/Henry Patten (GBR)
Women's doubles	Guo Hanyu (CHI)/Kristina Mladenovic (FRA)
Mixed doubles	Marcelo Avelaro (SLV)/Jelena Ostapenko (LAT)



- Wimbledon, French Open, US Open, and Australian Open are the most prestigious events on the annual tennis calendar, bestowed with the moniker of "Grand Slam", a term that has been in use for almost a century.
- **Wimbledon is the only one to still be played on grass. Of the other three, the Australian Open and the US Open are both played on hard courts, and the French Open is played on clay.**

Table Tennis

Delhi unveils Mayur mascot for Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships

- Chief Minister Smt. Rekha Gupta unveiled 'Mayur', the official mascot of the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships 2026.



- Inspired by India's national bird, the "peacock",
- It features feathers representing the flags of participating Commonwealth nations, symbolising unity, friendship, and sportsmanship.
- The championship, which will be held at the Thyagraj Stadium from July 27 to August 2.

India Sweep Commonwealth Table Tennis Team Titles



- India won both the men's and women's team titles at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships 2026 after beating Malaysia in the respective finals at the Thyagraj Stadium in New Delhi
- The championships run from July 27 to August 2,
- The Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships returned for the first time since the 2019 edition in Cuttack.
- Malaysia finished as runners-up in both the men's and women's team finals

Badminton

Vintage Sindhu win maiden Japan Open title



- Two-time Olympic medallist P.V. Sindhu clinched her maiden Super 750 title at the Japan Open in Tokyo.
- The 31-year-old became the first Indian to win the Japan Open,
- Sindhu's previous title came at the Syed Modi International in 2024.
- The Japan Open victory is her biggest title win since lifting the World Championships crown in 2019.

Squash

Anahat Singh becomes 1st Indian Squash World Jr Champion

- Top-seed Anahat Singh has scripted history by becoming the country's first squash player to win the junior world title after defeating Egypt's Ruqayya Salem
- in the girls' singles final of the World Squash Junior Championships 2026 at Niagara-on-the-Lake, Canada.
- Anahat, currently ranked No. 20 in the world on the senior PSA Tour,

Cricket

Australia thrash England by 7 wickets to win Women's T20 World Cup Title

- Australia was crowned champion of this year's T20 World Cup, clinching their seventh title.
- The tournament had a record prize pool on offer after the International Cricket Council (ICC) increased the total prize money for the 2026 edition to $8.76 million (approximately Rs 73.1 crore), the highest ever for a Women's T20 World Cup.
- The final was held between Australia and England.



Kranti Gaud etches her name on Lord's honours board

- India's Kranti Gaud becomes the first woman to have her name etched on the Lord's Honours Board after claiming a five-wicket haul in the one-off Test against England

- Kranti also became the youngest Indian female pacer to take a 5-wicket haul in Tests.

The First-Ever Mixed Disability Ashes 2027

- England will host Australia in the first-ever Mixed Disability Ashes in 2027, marking a historic milestone in the international expansion of disability cricket.

- The series will be played as part of England's 2027 Ashes summer.
- The Mixed Disability Ashes is the first bilateral Ashes cricket series between England and Australia featuring mixed disability men's teams.
- It extends the iconic Ashes rivalry to elite cricketers with disabilities, promoting inclusive participation in international cricket.
- It will be played alongside the Men's and Women's Ashes, making all three Ashes formats part of the same season.
- The contest will be played in the T20 International format.

Ajinkya Rahane retires from international cricket



- Ajinkya Rahane has officially announced his retirement from international cricket and all formats with immediate effect on July 30, 2026.
- The 36-year-old represented India in all three formats during his international career.
- He played 85 Test matches, 90 ODIs and 20 T20Is.
- The right-handed batter scored 5,077 runs in Tests at 38.46 with 12 centuries and 26 fifties, while in 90 ODIs, he made 2,962 runs at 35.26 including three tons and 24 fifties.
- In 20 T20Is, Rahane made 375 runs.

Hockey

7th Edition Of Marshal Of The Air Force Arjan Singh Memorial Hockey Tournament-2026

- 7th edition of Marshal of the Air Force Arjan Singh Memorial Hockey Tournament was conducted from 23 Jun to 03 Jul 26 at Amit Singh Bakshi Hockey Stadium, Air Force Station Jalahalli.
- Indian Air Force Hockey team won the final match.
- Sgt Anand Lakra (Air Force) and AGV (S) Agyapal (Air Force) were declared as Man of the match and player of the tournament respectively.
- The medals and trophies were presented to winner and runner up teams along with cash award for Rs 10,00,000/- and 8,00,000/- respectively.

Indian sub-junior men's team beat Pakistan 3-1 to clinch Gold at FIH Youth Hockey5s Asian Championship



- Indian sub-junior men's hockey team clinched the gold medal at the FIH Youth Hockey5s Asian Championship after delivering a dominant performance against arch-rivals Pakistan.
- Each player of the gold medal-winning Indian men's team will be rewarded with 2 lakh rupees, while each member of the support staff will receive 1 lakh rupees.

Chess

Tamil Nadu's Aswath Becomes India's 98th Grandmaster



- The 17-year-old Aswath S from Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu, become the country's 98th Grandmaster after clinching his final GM norm at the 2026 Pune International Grandmaster Round Robin.

Chess Legend Viswanathan Anand Becomes FIDE Interim President

- Viswanathan Anand, a five-time world chess champion, took over as the interim president of the International Chess Federation (FIDE)

- He assumed the post after Arkady Dvorkovich suspended his duties as FIDE president following European Union and Swiss sanctions.
- FIDE is the global governing body for chess and organises world championship events, title regulations, and international rating systems.



Rithvik Wins Silver, Rohith Krishna Takes Gold at Menuires Chess 2026

- The Menuires International Chess Championship was held in Menuires, France.
- Grandmaster S. Rohith Krishna of Tamil Nadu won the gold medal, and Grandmaster Raja Rithvik of Telangana won the silver medal in the open event.
- The tournament was part of the 1st Open International d'Échecs des Menuires, which took place from 11 July to 18 July 2026 at Le Break des Menuires in the French Alps.

Football

President Droupadi Murmu flags off trophies of Durand Cup tournament 2026 in New Delhi



- The Durand Cup (officially the IndianOil Durand Cup) is Independent India's premier football cup competition.
- Managed by the Durand Football Tournament Society (DFTS) under the aegis of the three Indian Armed Forces (Army, Navy, and Air Force).
- It serves as the prestigious, official season-opener for the Indian footballing pyramid, uniting clubs from the Indian Super League (ISL), the I-League, and the Armed Forces.

The Three Unique Trophies: Unlike standard sports tournaments where a single prize is awarded, the victorious team of the Durand Cup receives three distinct rolling trophies:

- **The Durand Cup: The original prize created in 1888.**
- **The Shimla Trophy: A spectacular piece presented by the residents of Shimla in 1904.**
- **The President's Cup: A permanent keep first introduced by India's inaugural President, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, in 1956.**
- Founded by Sir Henry Mortimer Durand (then the Indian Foreign Secretary) in Annadale, Shimla, to encourage physical fitness among British Indian troops.
- It holds the rank of Asia's oldest and the world's third-oldest surviving football tournament.

- The inaugural edition took place in Shimla in 1888, when it started off as an Army Cup, open only to the British Indian Army troops in India.

Spain Wins FIFA World Cup 2026 Final

- Spain are the new FIFA World Cup 2026 champions after edging Argentina 1-0 in extra time .
- **Host Nations:**
- The 2026 tournament was co-hosted across **16 cities in three North American nations**:
- **Canada:** Toronto, Vancouver
- **Mexico:** Guadalajara, Mexico City, Monterrey
- **United States:** Atlanta, Boston, Dallas, Houston, Kansas City, Los Angeles, Miami, New York/New Jersey (MetLife Stadium), Philadelphia, San Francisco Bay Area, Seattle



Award	Winner	Nation
Golden Ball (Best Player)	Rodri	Spain
Golden Boot (Top Scorer)	Kylian Mbappé	France
Golden Glove (Best GK)	Unai Simón	Spain
Best Young Player	Pau Cubarsí	Spain
Fair Play Award	Netherlands	Netherlands
Silver Ball and Silver Boot	Lionel Messi	Argentina

Wrestling



Sangram Singh becomes first Indian to win Asian Championship title after defeating Pakistani fighter

- Sangram Singh, who successfully transitioned from wrestling to MMA, scripted history by becoming the first Indian to win the Asian Championship title.
- He defeated Pakistani fighter Mohammad Abid Ali in just 1 minute and 20 seconds, registering his second victory over a Pakistani opponent and his fourth overall in MMA

Miscellaneous

Manipur CM inaugurates 19th Governor's Taekwondo Cup 2026

- Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh inaugurated the 19th Governor's Taekwondo Cup, Manipur 2026.
- It is is organised by the All Manipur Taekwondo Association at Khuman Lampak Indoor Stadium, Imphal.
- The championship which will continue till July 15.

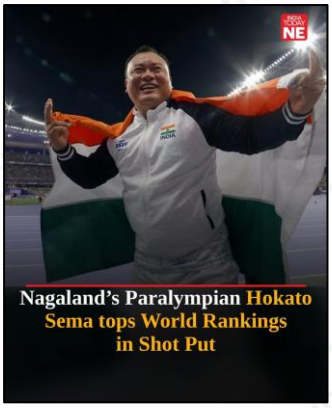
India bags five gold medals at International Physics Olympiad 2026

- Five Indian students have won gold medals at the 56th International Physics Olympiad (IPhO) 2026, held in Bucaramanga, Colombia, from the 4th to the 12th July.
- India secured the joint first position along with Russia, China, Kazakhstan, South Korea and Taiwan among 381 students from 87 countries.
- India's Olympiad programme, spearheaded by the Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education, a National Centre of the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research.

India win four gold medals at the International Chemistry Olympiad

- The Indian team that participated in the 58th International Chemistry Olympiad (IChO) in Uzbekistan bagged four gold medals.
- The country also secured joint Rank 1 alongside China, Vietnam and the Individual Participant (Russia)*,
- The International Chemistry Olympiad 2026 was held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, from July 10 to 19

Hokato Hotozhe Sema Tops Men's Shot Put F57 Rankings



- Hokato Hotozhe Sema, a Paralympian from Nagaland, has achieved World No. 1 rank in the men's Shot Put F57 category.
- He serves as a Subedar in the 9 Assam Rifles.
- Indian athletes Rana Soman and Juyal Shubham ranked 2nd and 3rd respectively.

Achievements and Awards

- First Paralympian to be awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM).
- Recipient of the Arjuna Award.
- Won bronze medal in men's Shot Put F57 at the Paris Paralympics 2024.

Banking / Finance

Indian team bags 2 gold, 4 silver medals at Mathematics Olympiads in China

- India concluded its International STEM Olympiad season with a six-member team winning 2 gold and 4 silver medals at the 67th International Mathematical Olympiad (IMO) 2026 in Shanghai.
- This placed India at a global country rank of seven with 166 points.

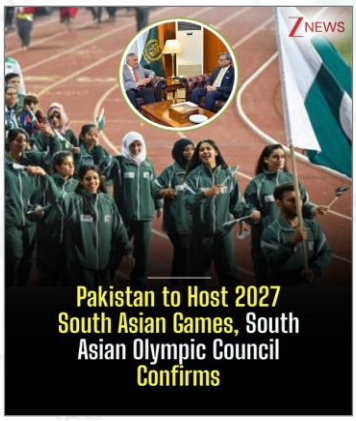


India wins 1 gold, 3 silver medals at 37th International Biology Olympiad 2026 in Lithuania

- India has won one gold and three silver medals at the 37th International Biology Olympiad (IBO) 2026 held in Vilnius, Lithuania.
- Bhavyaa Gunwal from Haryana won the gold medal while Soumil Maity from West Bengal, Nishit Kalani from Rajasthan and Anmol Kumar from Punjab won silver medals.

Josh Kerr of Britain breaks the men's mile world record that stood since 1999

- Josh Kerr, the British runner ,added a new chapter by running the mile in 3 minutes, 42.66 seconds to break the 27-year-old record for the distance , At a Diamond League meet in London.
- Kerr broke Moroccan great Hicham El Guerrouj's mark of 3 minutes, 43.13 seconds, set in Rome in 1999.



Pakistan to Host 2027 South Asian Games

- Pakistan will host the 14th South Asian Federation Games, officially called the XIV South Asian Games, from 23 March to 31 March 2027.
- The multi-sport event will be held in Lahore, Islamabad, and Faisalabad, and more than 3,500 athletes from eight South Asian nations are expected to compete in 27 sports.
- The South Asian Games are a regional multi-sport event for countries of South Asia.
- Pakistan will host the South Asian Games for the third time after the 1989 and 2004 editions.

MoS Bandi Sanjay inaugurates All India Police Judo Cluster 2026 sports competitions in Hyderabad

- The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), under the aegis of the All India Police Sports Control Board (AIPSCB), will host the 11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship 2026 at the GMC Balayogi Indoor Stadium, Gachibowli, Hyderabad, from 23 to 30 July 2026.
- More than 1,600 sportspersons representing 36 State Police and Central Armed Police Force (CAPF) organisations will participate in the championship, competing in Judo, Wushu, Taekwondo, Karate and Pencak Silat.
- The championship mascot, "VIRA", inspired by Telangana's State Animal, the Spotted Deer (Chital).



Ladakh Scouts Regimental Centre Wins 6th LG Cup Horse Polo Tournament in Drass

- In Ladakh, the 6th Lieutenant Governor's Cup Horse Polo Tournament concluded at the Goshan International Polo Stadium in Drass.
- Eighteen teams, including three women's teams, participated in the tournament,
- The Ladakh Scouts Regimental Centre of the Indian Army emerged as champions, defeating the Animal Husbandry Department team
- the winning prize money has been increased from 50,000 to 1 lakh rupees for this year's tournament.
- From next year, the winning team will receive 2 lakh rupees, while the runners-up will be awarded 1 lakh rupees.

11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship concludes

- The 11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship 2026 concluded on 30 July 2026 at Hyderabad in Telangana.
- The event was held from 23 July to 30 July 2026 at the GMC Balayogi Indoor Stadium in Gachibowli and was hosted by the Central Industrial Security Force under the aegis of the All-India Police Sports Control Board.
- The championship included five disciplines: Judo, Wushu, Taekwondo, Karate, and Pencak Silat.
- Sashastra Seema Bal finished as the overall champion with 24 gold, 20 silver, and 23 bronze medals for 203 points.
- The Central Industrial Security Force finished second with 25 gold, 16 silver, and 25 bronze medals for 198 points.
- The Indo-Tibetan Border Police finished third with 10 gold, 21 silver, and 26 bronze medals for 139 points.

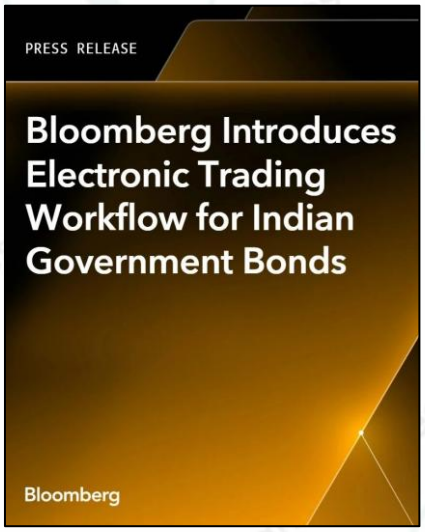
Shorts news

- Arunachal Pradesh's Sonam Zomba has become the first-ever Karma Fight League (KFL) World Strawweight Champion, scripting history at KFL 8 in Colombo, Sri Lanka.

Banking / Finance

Negotiated Dealing System-Order Matching

- Bloomberg has introduced the first electronic trade in Indian government bonds (IGBs) through its terminal by directly connecting to the Negotiated Dealing System-Order Matching (NDS-OM).
- It was launched in 2005 by the Reserve Bank of India.
- It is a screen based electronic anonymous order matching system for secondary market trading in Government securities owned by RBI.
- Presently the membership of the system is open to entities like Banks, Primary Dealers, Insurance Companies, Mutual Funds etc.
- All central government securities, state government securities and treasury bills are tradable on the NDS-OM Web Module.
- Additionally, it allows members to negotiate bilaterally through the "Request for Quote" segment.
- The system is designed to bring transparency to secondary market transactions while enabling members to place bids and offers directly on the NDS-OM screen.



There are two types of NDS-OM members, including

- Direct Members: Direct members have current accounts with the RBI and can directly settle trades on NDS-OM.
- Indirect Members: Indirect members do not have current accounts with the RBI and must settle through NDS-OM members that have direct accounts.

- Most foreign institutional investors have indirect access, while resident entities may have direct access.
- Trade Settlement: Under this trades are settled at T+1 and guaranteed by Clearing Corporation of India Limited (CCIL).

EPFO Launches "VISHWAS, 2026" for Amicable Settlement of Damages/Penalty/-Related Disputes



- The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO), under the Ministry of Labour & Employment, Government of India, has launched "VISHWAS, 2026",
- A one-time dispute resolution initiative to facilitate amicable settlement of disputes relating to levy of damages /penalty under Section 14B of the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 and Section 128 of the Code on Social Security, 2020.
- The Scheme has been come into force with effect from 29 June 2026.
- It will remain operational for a period of six months from the date of notification.
- VISHWAS, 2026 has been introduced with the objective of promoting voluntary compliance, reducing litigation, and enabling speedy resolution of long-pending disputes relating to penalty/damages while safeguarding the interests of employees.
- The Scheme provides employers with an opportunity to settle eligible cases through a transparent, fully digital and time-bound process.

The Scheme covers four broad categories of cases:

- cases where orders for penalty/damages are under challenge before judicial forum;
- final damages/penalty orders where recovery is pending or only partly made, including Recovery Certificate (RRC) cases;
- cases where notices have been issued but final orders for damages/penalty are yet to be passed; and
- cases where notices for penalty/damages are yet to be issued

Boss Scam



- SEBI recently cautioned regulated entities and listed firms against a 'Boss Scam', wherein fraudsters impersonate chief executives or senior officials to trick finance teams into transferring funds.
- It is an emerging cyber fraud where fraudsters impersonate Chief Executive Officers (CEOs), Managing Directors (MDs) and other senior officials to trick finance executives into transferring funds.
- Cyber criminals are using two major methods to carry out the fraud.
- Under the first method, fraudsters use deepfake technology, including AI-generated voice cloning, fake video calls and false social media groups to impersonate top executives.
- Finance officials are then instructed to transfer money to a specified bank account.
- In some cases, they are also told not to disclose the transaction by claiming that it relates to Unpublished Price Sensitive Information (UPSI).
- Another method involves sending compressed ZIP files containing malicious executable programs.
- Once opened, these files can compromise systems and hijack the active WhatsApp Web sessions.
- The fraudster gets access to the finance officer's WhatsApp account and then contacts accounts or finance employees, instructing them to make immediate payments to specified bank accounts

EnKash Launches India's First UPI-Enabled Meal Card

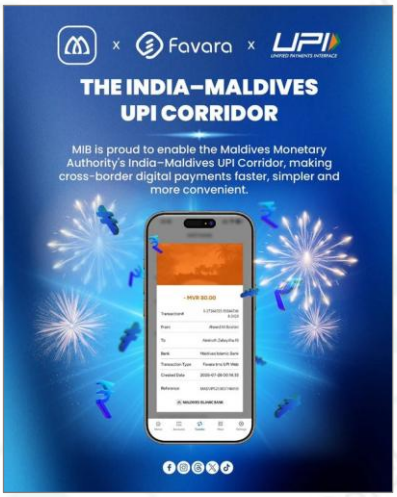
- EnKash, India's leading business payments and spend management platform, announced the launch of UPI-based payments on its Meal Card.
- With this addition, employees can make payments directly from their meal card balance by scanning eligible UPI QR codes at food and grocery merchants.
- This makes EnKash the first provider in India to enable UPI payments directly from a meal benefit balance.
- The new capability extends the UPI infrastructure that EnKash already offers across its Prepaid Payment Instrument portfolio.
- EnKash is India's first full-stack payments and spend management platform

FinMin launches Protection & Indemnity Insurance product under Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool

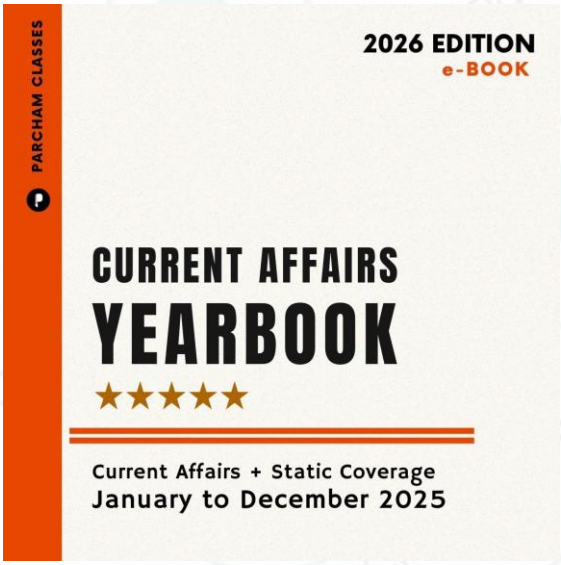
- The Department of Financial Services under the Ministry of Finance launched India's first sovereign-backed Protection and Indemnity insurance product under Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP), designed by the New India Assurance Company.
- The insurance provides financial protection against third-party liabilities, including Crew & Cargo liability, pollution liability, wreck removal, 24x7 port correspondent network with an indemnity limit up to $1.5 billion, through the combined capacity of the pool.

Maldives-India Favara-UPI Transfers Begin

- The Maldives has launched real-time cross-border fund transfers to India through the integration of its instant payment system, Favara, with India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI).
- under the new facility, individuals in the Maldives can transfer money in real time to beneficiaries in India.
- It added that transactions are initiated in Maldivian Rufiyaa and are credited directly in Indian Rupees to UPI-enabled bank accounts.
- In the initial phase, the service is available to customers of Bank of Maldives Plc and Maldives Islamic Bank Plc.
- Users can make person-to-person transfers through their mobile banking applications using the Favara payment platform.




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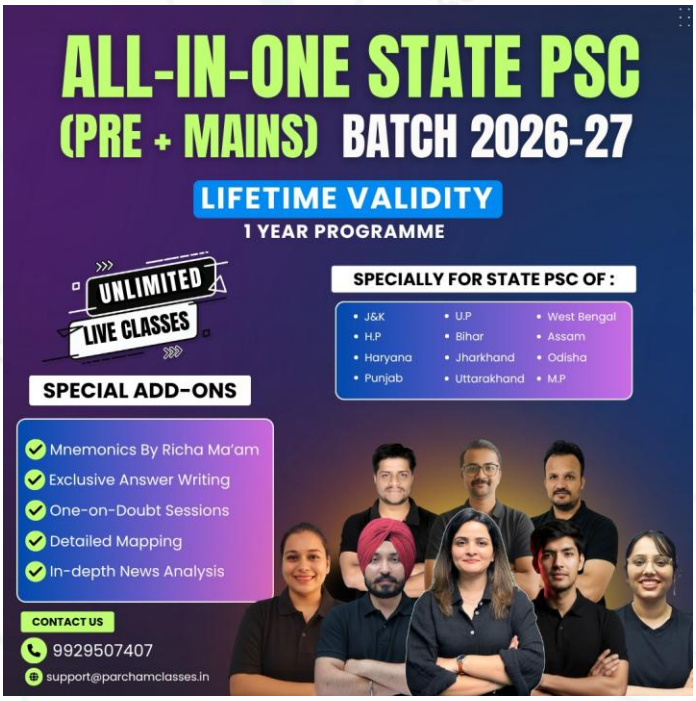

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